Uyuni 2026.10

Specialized Guides



UYUNI

Chapter 1. Preface

Specialized Guides
Uyuni 2026.10

This guide provides an overview of specialized topics and functionalities within Uyuni.

It is designed to help users with basic, routine, and advanced tasks, explaining each step's purpose and outlining the various options available to customize your approach.

For more in-depth information, refer to the following specialized guides:

- **Specialized Guides › Kubernetes Guide › Kubernetes Guide**
- **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Guide**
- **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Large Deployments Guide**
- **Specialized Guides › Qs Sap › Quick Start: SAP**

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Chapter 2. Kubernetes Guide

This guide shows you how to deploy Uyuni on Kubernetes.

- Server Deployment on Kubernetes
- Proxy Deployment on Kubernetes

2.1. Server Deployment on Kubernetes

Uyuni can be deployed on Kubernetes using a Helm chart. This guide covers deploying Uyuni 2026.10 on RKE2.

2.1.1. Pre-Deployment Checklist

Before proceeding, ensure your environment meets these requirements:

- [ ] **Kubernetes Distribution:** RKE2 (other distributions are not supported).
- [ ] **Ingress Controller:** Traefik (RKE2 defaults to nginx, which is not supported).
- [ ] **Tools:** Helm v3 and kubectl configured with access to the cluster.
- [ ] **Permissions:** cluster-admin privileges (or access to someone who has them).
- [ ] **Node-Level Access:** Root access to RKE2 nodes to apply AppArmor/SELinux policies and configure Traefik.
- [ ] **Storage:** A StorageClass supporting ReadWriteOnce volumes.



If you do not have node-level access to apply security policies, or if your environment is not RKE2, you may want to consider a standard installation on a virtual machine or bare-metal instead. Deploying on a Kubernetes cluster is still possible, but would require to run the main container as super privileged.

Several personas are involved in the installation of Uyuni on Kubernetes:

- the Kubernetes administrator manages the cluster, its users and accesses,
- the infrastructure administrator takes care of wiring the network access to the cluster,
- the PKI administrator is responsible for the TLS certificates generation and deployment infrastructure,
- the Uyuni administrator controls the application itself and its deployment.

In some cases those personas can be merged into a single person or team, but keeping them in mind explains why the installation is not a one-shot script. Kubernetes clusters can vary a lot between organizations, so the Uyuni core installation is designed to be as agnostic as possible of those specifics.

2.1.2. Supported configuration

Component	Supported
Kubernetes distribution	RKE2. Other distributions are not tested and not supported.
RKE2 version	Refer to the Uyuni release notes for the minimum supported RKE2 version.
Ingress controller	Traefik. The nginx ingress controller shipped with RKE2 is deprecated and will be removed in a future RKE2 release; it is not documented here, nor tested.
Gateway API	Supported from version 1.4, but requires experimental CRDs not included in RKE2 by default. Not recommended for production use.
Storage	Any storage class providing ReadWriteOnce volumes. RKE2 ships without any provisioner. The local-path provisioner is suitable for testing but provides no redundancy and is not recommended for production.
CNI	No special requirements. Canal (the RKE2 default) is supported.
Required tools	Helm v3 and kubectl, configured to access the target cluster.



Because the main server container runs systemd, Uyuni on Kubernetes is not fully cloud-native. Running it requires elevated security permissions that standard Kubernetes security profiles do not allow by default. See Security framework setup for details.

2.1.3. Preparation



This guide assumes the reader knows how to work with Kubernetes: the concepts will not be explained here as they are extensively documented in the official Kubernetes documentation.

The Uyuni administrator needs to deploy the server-helm Helm chart. However, this chart requires preparing:

- TLS certificates chain for the server and database,
- ConfigMaps for the server and database root CA certificates,
- persistent volumes for the claims the chart will create or a storage class automatically creating them,
- credentials secrets for the database users and the administrator,
- Load balancers or other mechanisms to expose the Salt, report database and optionally TFTP ports.

Run the following command to read the full details on how to use the server Helm chart:

```
helm show readme --version 2026.10.0 \
    oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/server-helm
```



Helm requires the version to be semver2 compatible when using OCI repositories. This is why the version (2026.10.0) is formatted differently from the release number (2026.10).

For older versions, the Helm chart is located in a snapshot repository like: oci://registry.opensuse.org/systemsmanagement/uyuni/snapshots/<version>/opensuse_tumbleweed/uyuni/server-helm.

2.1.3.1. Namespace

Install Uyuni into a dedicated namespace named uyuni-server. This keeps the server workload clearly separated from other workloads on the cluster, and allows support tooling to collect logs without requiring manual input. The companion proxy guide uses uyuni-proxy by the same convention.



If you choose a different namespace, use it consistently throughout all commands in this guide.

Create the namespace and set the variable used throughout this guide:

```
kubectl create namespace uyuni-server
NAMESPACE=uyuni-server
```

2.1.3.2. User permissions



If the Uyuni administrator already holds cluster-admin permissions, the RBAC setup below can be skipped.

The user installing the Uyuni server Helm chart needs to have permissions on the namespace. The following Role and RoleBinding grant the minimum rights required to deploy server-helm with Traefik:

```
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: Role
metadata:
  name: uyuni-server-manager
  namespace: uyuni-server
rules:
- apiGroups: [""]
  resources: ["pods", "pods/log", "services", "secrets", "configmaps",
"persistentvolumeclaims"]
  verbs: ["*"]
- apiGroups: ["apps"]
  resources: ["deployments"]
  verbs: ["*"]
- apiGroups: ["networking.k8s.io"]
  resources: ["ingresses"]
  verbs: ["*"]
- apiGroups: ["traefik.io", "traefik.containo.us"]
  resources: ["ingressroutetcps", "middlewares"]
  verbs: ["*"]
---
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
```

```
kind: RoleBinding
metadata:
  name: uyuni-server-manager-binding
  namespace: uyuni-server
subjects:
- kind: User
  name: REPLACE_WITH_USERNAME
  apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io
roleRef:
  kind: Role
  name: uyuni-server-manager
  apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io
```

Replace with your namespace if you chose a different name.

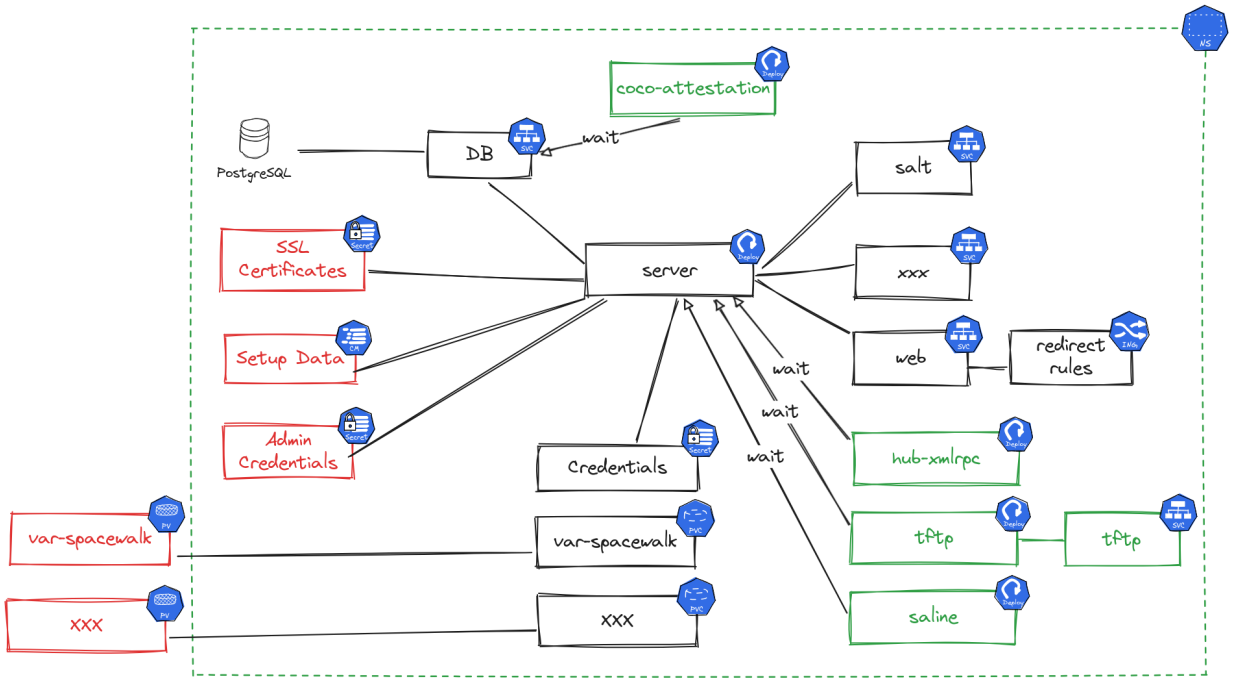
Replace with the actual Kubernetes username of the Uyuni administrator.

Save this to a file such as uyuni-server-rbac.yaml, then apply it as the cluster administrator:

```
kubectl apply -f uyuni-server-rbac.yaml
```

2.1.3.3. Global architecture

This diagram shows the components deployed by the server-helm chart and the ones expected to be created before hand.



- Red items are required,
- Green items are optional and can be enabled using the chart values,
- Black components are the core components.



Even if there are values to disable the internal database, using an external one is not supported yet. Those properties are only present for testing purpose.

The next sections will explain the resources that are expected.

2.1.3.4. Credentials

The deployment requires four specific secrets of kubernetes.io/basic-auth type, each containing a username and a password key. The following commands use the $NAMESPACE variable set in the Namespace section. Replace supersecret with actual passwords before running them.



Using --from-literal for the passwords is not a secure practice, read the command help to use --from-file or --from-env-file. If using declarative YAML definitions instead of these commands, make sure these files are encrypted before pushing them to a remote version control.

```
kubectl create secret generic -n $NAMESPACE --type 'kubernetes.io/basic-auth' \
    --from-literal=username=dbadmin \
    --from-literal=password=supersecret \
    db-admin-credentials
kubectl create secret generic -n $NAMESPACE --type 'kubernetes.io/basic-auth' \
    --from-literal=username=dbuser \
    --from-literal=password=supersecret \
    db-credentials
kubectl create secret generic -n $NAMESPACE --type 'kubernetes.io/basic-auth' \
    --from-literal=username=reportdb \
    --from-literal=password=supersecret \
    reportdb-credentials
kubectl create secret generic -n $NAMESPACE --type 'kubernetes.io/basic-auth' \
    --from-literal=username=admin \
    --from-literal=password=supersecret \
    admin-credentials
```

2.1.3.5. TLS setup

The chart expects two TLS secrets and two ConfigMaps holding the corresponding root CA certificates.

uyuni-cert

TLS certificate for the Ingress rule. Must include the public FQDN as a Subject Alternate Name.

db-cert

TLS certificate for the report database. Must include the public FQDN if the report database is accessed from outside the cluster. It can be the same certificate as uyuni-cert.



The certificate file must start with the server certificate followed by any intermediate CA certificates. Do not include the root CA in the uyuni-cert secret — root CAs go into ConfigMaps (see below).

Create the server ingress certificate secret:

```
kubectl create secret tls uyuni-cert \
    -n $NAMESPACE \
    --cert=/path/to/server.crt \
    --key=/path/to/server.key
```

The report database secret requires an additional ca.crt key that kubectl create secret tls does not produce. Create it as a generic secret instead:

```
kubectl create secret generic db-cert \
    -n $NAMESPACE \
    --from-file=tls.crt=/path/to/db.crt \
    --from-file=tls.key=/path/to/db.key \
    --from-file=ca.crt=/path/to/db-ca.crt
```



For self-signed certificates where the certificate is also its own CA, pass the same file for both tls.crt and ca.crt.

Create ConfigMaps for the root CA certificates:

```
kubectl create configmap uyuni-ca \
    -n $NAMESPACE \
    --from-file=ca.crt=/path/to/server-ca.crt

kubectl create configmap db-ca \
    -n $NAMESPACE \
    --from-file=ca.crt=/path/to/db-ca.crt
```



If you want to automate certificate issuance and renewal, cert-manager together with trust-manager can manage all of the above automatically. See Example helm charts for links to example charts that demonstrate this approach.

2.1.3.6. Storage

The server chart defines volumes as Persistent Volume Claims (PVCs).

Before proceeding, verify that a StorageClass is available on the cluster:

```
kubectl get storageclass
```

If the output shows no resources, a provisioner must be installed before the chart can be deployed. For testing, the local-path provisioner is a simple option:

```
kubectl apply -f https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rancher/local-path-
provisioner/master/deploy/local-path-storage.yaml
```



The local-path provisioner stores data on the node's local filesystem and provides no redundancy. It is suitable for testing only. For production, use a StorageClass backed by a proper storage system.



- The creation of the underlying PVs is the responsibility of the cluster administrators.
- The PVCs use the ReadWriteOnce access mode.

The created PVCs can be tuned using Helm chart values. Each of the PVCs can have the following values:

- size: to set the requested size of the PVC.
- storageClass: can be used to select the storage class to use for the PVC. This can be useful to select faster storage for the database or the packages storage.
- extraLabels: can be used to add custom labels to the PVC.
- annotations: can be used to set custom annotations on the PVC.
- volumeName: can be used to hard code which volume the PVC should be bound to.
- selector: is the YAML fragment of the PVC selector to use to find the PV to bind to.

Refer to https://kubernetes.io/docs/concepts/storage/persistent-volumes/ for more information on persistent volumes and their claims.

The following PVCs will be created by the chart:

PVC	Default size
var-pgsql	50Gi
var-spacewalk	100Gi
var-cache	10Gi
var-log	2Gi
var-search	10Gi
srv-www	100Gi
srv-tftpboot	300Mi
ca-certs	10Mi
etc-apache2, etc-cobbler, etc-postfix, etc-rhn, etc-salt, etc-sssd, etc-systemd-multi, etc-systemd-sockets, etc-tomcat	1Mi each
etc-sysconfig	20Mi

PVC	Default size
run-salt-master, srv-formulametadata, srv-pillar, srv-salt, srv-spacewalk, srv-susemanager, var-cobbler, var-salt	1–10Mi each



The default sizes for var-spacewalk and srv-www (100Gi each) are a starting point only. Size them based on the number of distributions and packages you plan to synchronize. For more information see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › General Requirements**.

Override PVC settings in a values file rather than on the command line. The following example increases the package and database volumes and pins them to a faster storage class:

```
volumes:
  var-spacewalk:
    size: 500Gi
    storageClass: fast-ssd
  srv-www:
    size: 500Gi
    storageClass: fast-ssd
  var-pgsql:
    size: 80Gi
    storageClass: fast-ssd
```

Pass the file to helm install with -f values.yaml.

2.1.3.7. Installing Traefik

RKE2 ships with nginx as the default ingress controller. The server-helm chart requires Traefik, so nginx must be disabled and Traefik installed before proceeding. This is a task for the Kubernetes cluster administrator.

Set the ingress controller to be Traefik by adding the following to /etc/rancher/rke2/config.yaml on each RKE2 server node (create the file if it does not exist):

```
ingress-controller: traefik
```

Restart RKE2 to apply the changes:

```
systemctl restart rke2-server
```

Wait for Traefik to become ready before continuing

2.1.3.8. Exposing ports

Uyuni requires some TCP and UDP ports to be routed to its services. Refer to the server-helm README for the list of ports to be exposed.



The server-helm chart supports Gateway API version 1.4. Since this requires experimental CRDs which are not shipped with RKE2 by default, it is not recommended for production use.

There are multiple ways to expose the ports, but this documentation will only cover how to configure RKE2's Traefik for this. This is a task for the Kubernetes cluster administrator, not the Uyuni administrator.

To set Traefik to expose and route the needed ports, create /var/lib/rancher/rke2/server/manifests/uyuni-traefik.yaml on RKE2 server node (control plane node) with the following content. Agent (worker) nodes do not have this directory and do not need the file. Traefik takes a few seconds to be reconfigured after the file is saved.

```
apiVersion: helm.cattle.io/v1
kind: HelmChartConfig
metadata:
  name: rke2-traefik
  namespace: kube-system
spec:
  valuesContent: |-
    ports:
      reportdb-pgsql:
        port: 5432
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 5432
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 5432
        containerPort: 5432
      salt-publish:
        port: 4505
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 4505
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 4505
        containerPort: 4505
      salt-request:
        port: 4506
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 4506
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 4506
        containerPort: 4506
```

When using the server as a TFTP server there are a few issues to consider. TFTP is complex to expose from a Kubernetes pod due to the nature of the protocol: the TFTP server receives requests on port 69, but negotiates another random port to continue. This port also needs to stay the same through the whole session for the server to recognize the client as being the same. This means that there are only two possible ways to use the TFTP server:

- using a load balancer compatible with TFTP,

- using the host network for the TFTP pod. This can be achieved by setting the tftp.hostNetwork helm chart value to true.

2.1.3.9. Security framework setup

The main container of the server runs systemd, which requires elevated privileges that the default Kubernetes security profiles do not allow. There are two ways to handle this:

Super-privileged mode

Set the server.superPrivileged helm value to true. This disables all Linux security module enforcement (SELinux, AppArmor) for the container and grants it broad host access.



Super-privileged mode is the simplest option but significantly reduces the security posture of the node. Use it only for testing and development, not for production deployments.

Custom AppArmor or SELinux profile (recommended for production)

Create a custom policy or profile that grants only the specific permissions systemd requires. This maintains security module enforcement while allowing the container to function correctly.

2.1.3.9.1. AppArmor

Obtain the profile content from the server-helm chart README, which includes a ready-to-use profile named k8s-systemd-uyuni. Deploy it on each cluster node, then load it:

```
cp /path/to/k8s-systemd-uyuni /etc/apparmor.d/k8s-systemd-uyuni
apparmor_parser -r /etc/apparmor.d/k8s-systemd-uyuni
```

Then reference it in the helm values:

```
server:
  apparmorProfile: k8s-systemd-uyuni
```

2.1.3.9.2. SELinux

Obtain the policy file (systemdcontainerpolicy.te) from the server-helm chart README. Copy it to each cluster node, then compile and install it:

```
checkmodule -M -m -o systemdcontainerpolicy.mod systemdcontainerpolicy.te
semodule_package -o systemdcontainerpolicy.pp -m systemdcontainerpolicy.mod
semodule -i systemdcontainerpolicy.pp
```

Then configure the custom SELinux type in the helm values (using uyuni_container_t if using the recommended

policy from the README):

```
server:
  selinuxType: uyuni_container_t
```

2.1.4. Installation

The server-helm chart requires one value to be set: global.fqdn. The other values have sensible defaults, refer to the server-helm chart README for more details on those.

The server can be installed with a command like the following.

```
helm install uyuni-server \
     oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/server-helm \
     -n $NAMESPACE \
     --description "Server installation" \
     --set "global.fqdn=the.server.fqdn" \
     --set tag=2026.10 \
     --version 2026.10.0
```

When setting multiple values, using a YAML values file is recommended instead of passing several --set parameters. Refer to the helm command help for more details.

2.1.5. Upgrade

The server is upgraded by running helm upgrade against a newer chart version. The values and the persistent volume claims of the existing release are kept.



The server deployment uses the Recreate strategy: the running server pod is stopped before the new one starts. The server is unavailable during the upgrade. The database schema is upgraded automatically when the new server pod starts. Back up the server and its database before upgrading.

Procedure: Upgrading the server on Kubernetes

1. Check the values of the current release:

```
helm get values uyuni-server -n $NAMESPACE
```

2. Run helm upgrade against the new chart version:

```
helm upgrade uyuni-server \
     oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/server-helm \
     -n $NAMESPACE \
     --reset-then-reuse-values \
     --set tag=2026.10 \
```

```
    --version 2026.10.0
```



The --reset-then-reuse-values option requires Helm 3.14 or later. With an older Helm version, check helm upgrade --help for alternatives.

3. Watch the rollout:

```
kubectl rollout status deploy/uyuni -n $NAMESPACE
```

4. Verify that the server is working, as described in Verifying the installation or upgrade.

2.1.6. Verifying the installation or upgrade

After running helm install or helm upgrade, the server pod starts systemd and multiple services inside it. This takes longer than a typical container startup — allow a few minutes before expecting the pod to be fully ready.

Watch the pods come up:

```
kubectl get pods -n uyuni-server -w
```

All pods should eventually reach Running status with all containers ready. If a pod is stuck in Pending, CrashLoopBackOff, or Error, check its events:

```
kubectl describe pod -n uyuni-server <POD_NAME>
kubectl logs -n uyuni-server <POD_NAME>
```

Once all pods are ready, open a browser and navigate to https://<your-fqdn>. After an installation, the Uyuni setup wizard should appear. After an upgrade, the login page of the existing server should appear.

To get a terminal inside the server container (equivalent to mgrctl term used elsewhere in the documentation):

```
SERVER_POD=`kubectl get pod -n uyuni-server -lapp.kubernetes.io/part
-of=uyuni,app.kubernetes.io/component=server -o "jsonpath={.items[0].metadata.name}"`
kubectl exec -ti -n uyuni-server $SERVER_POD -- bash
```

2.1.7. Example helm charts

Some helm charts using the server-helm chart can be found in the main branch of the uyuni-charts git repository. They showcase how the TLS certificates can be generated using cert-manager and trust-manager. Those examples may assume to have Kubernetes cluster administrator permissions.

The community repository demonstrates an alternative approach using Rancher Fleet to deploy Uyuni automatically into downstream RKE2 clusters, with dynamic FQDN configuration driven by cluster labels. This

covers a GitOps-style deployment path not described elsewhere in this documentation.



This is a personal lab repository, not an official Uyuni resource. It is not supported and may not be maintained long-term. It is provided here as inspiration only.

2.1.8. Troubleshooting

Start by checking the overall pod status and recent events:

```
kubectl get pods -n uyuni-server
kubectl get events -n uyuni-server --sort-by='.lastTimestamp'
```

2.1.8.1. Pod stuck in Pending

A pod stays in Pending when it cannot be scheduled. The most common cause is an unbound PVC — the storage class has not provisioned a volume yet.

```
kubectl get pvc -n uyuni-server
kubectl describe pvc -n uyuni-server <PVC_NAME>
```

Check that the storage class exists and is available, and that the PVC size does not exceed what the provisioner can provide.

2.1.8.2. Pod in CrashLoopBackOff

A pod that crashes immediately after starting is often caused by a missing secret or a security profile blocking systemd.

Check the pod logs:

```
kubectl logs -n uyuni-server <POD_NAME> --previous
```

If the log shows permission denied errors related to cgroup or mount operations, the AppArmor or SELinux profile is not applied correctly. See Security framework setup for setup instructions.

If the log shows secret or credential errors, verify that all required secrets exist in the namespace:

```
kubectl get secrets -n uyuni-server
```

2.1.8.3. Web UI not reachable

If all pods are running but the web interface is not accessible, the ingress or port exposure is likely

misconfigured.

Verify the Ingress resource was created:

```
kubectl get ingress -n uyuni-server
```

Check that the FQDN in the Ingress matches the value passed to global.fqdn during installation, and that DNS resolves to the cluster. Also confirm that the Traefik configuration was applied on the RKE2 server nodes as described in Exposing ports.

2.1.8.4. 502 Bad Gateway

A 502 Bad Gateway error means Traefik received the request but could not reach a healthy backend. There are several possible causes.

The server pod is still starting up. The main container runs systemd and takes several minutes to become fully ready. A 502 during this window is normal — wait for all containers to report ready before investigating further:

```
kubectl get pods -n uyuni-server -w
```

Traefik is not routing to the correct service. Verify that the Ingress resource exists and that its ingressClassName is traefik:

```
kubectl get ingress -n uyuni-server -o yaml
```

If the ingressClassName does not match the IngressClass created by the Traefik Helm release, Traefik silently ignores the rule. See Installing Traefik for the correct naming requirement.

Firewalld is blocking traffic between internal cluster networks. If the pod is ready and Traefik routing looks correct, firewalld on the node may be dropping packets between the pod and service CIDRs. Add both networks to the trusted zone:

```
firewall-cmd --zone=trusted --add-source=10.42.0.0/16 --permanent
firewall-cmd --zone=trusted --add-source=10.43.0.0/16 --permanent
firewall-cmd --reload
```



The addresses above are the RKE2 defaults. If the cluster was configured with custom pod or service CIDRs, use those instead.

2.1.8.5. Salt minions cannot connect

If the server is running but Salt minions cannot reach it, the TCP ports 4505 and 4506 are not exposed correctly. Verify the Traefik configuration was applied on the RKE2 server nodes and that no firewall is blocking

those ports between the minions and the cluster.

2.2. Uyuni Proxy Deployment on Kubernetes

2.2.1. Proxy on Kubernetes changes

There were multiple changes in how to install Uyuni proxies running on Kubernetes:

- mgrpxy is no longer handling proxies on Kubernetes, helm and the proxy-helm chart need to be used instead.
- The TLS certificates have to be in secrets, rather than in the configuration tarball. This aims at allowing cloud-native TLS certificates management for the proxies.
- The proxy queries the server at the start of the container to verify that the versions are compatible.
- The needed persistent volume claims has been reduced to the squid cache only.

2.2.2. Prerequisites

Installing the Kubernetes cluster and configuring it is out of the scope of this document.

The cluster is assumed to be ready to be used with a user having rights on a namespace dedicated to Uyuni.

Create Role and RoleBinding if they do not exist already. The minimum rights required to deploy proxy-helm are defined as:

```
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: Role
metadata:
  name: example-resource-manager
  namespace: uyuni-proxy
rules:
- apiGroups: [""]
  resources: ["pods", "pods/log", "services", "secrets", "configmaps",
"persistentvolumeclaims"]
  verbs: ["*"]
- apiGroups: ["apps"]
  resources: ["deployments"]
  verbs: ["*"]
- apiGroups: ["networking.k8s.io"]
  resources: ["ingresses"]
  verbs: ["*"]
---
apiVersion: rbac.authorization.k8s.io/v1
kind: RoleBinding
metadata:
  name: example-resource-manager-binding
  namespace: uyuni-proxy
subjects:
- kind: User
  name: $USERNAME
  apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io
```

```
roleRef:
  kind: Role
  name: example-resource-manager
  apiGroup: rbac.authorization.k8s.io
```



This guide assumes the reader knows how to work with Kubernetes: the concepts will not be explained here as they are extensively documented in the official Kubernetes documentation.

The Uyuni administrator needs to deploy the proxy-helm Helm chart. However, this chart requires to prepare:

- TLS certificates chain for the proxy,
- a ConfigMap for the proxy root CA certificate,
- a persistent volumes for the claim the chart will create or a storage class automatically creating it,
- Load balancers or other mechanisms to expose the Salt, SSH and TFTP ports.



The TLS certificate and the root CA ConfigMap are optional inputs: the proxy-helm chart can create proxy-cert and uyuni-ca itself from the values carried in the configuration tarball. See the TLS setup section below for the trade-offs and the adoption procedure for pre-existing objects.

Run the following command to read the full details on how to use the proxy Helm chart:

```
helm show readme --version 2026.10.0 \
    oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/proxy-helm
```



Helm requires the version to be semver2 compatible when using OCI repositories. This is why the version (2026.10.0) is formatted differently from the release number (2026.10).

For older versions, the Helm chart is located in a snapshot repository like: oci://registry.opensuse.org/systemsmanagement/uyuni/snapshots/<version>/opensuse_tumbleweed/uyuni/proxy-helm.

2.2.2.1. TLS setup

The proxy needs the following objects in its namespace:

- A TLS secret named proxy-cert containing the proxy server certificate and key, with the public FQDN as Subject Alternate Name.
- A ConfigMap named uyuni-ca containing the root CA in the ca.crt key.

In a cloud-native setup the certificates are typically managed externally (for example by cert-manager); create the objects beforehand:

```
kubectl create secret tls proxy-cert -n uyuni-proxy \
    --cert=proxy.crt --key=proxy.key

kubectl create configmap uyuni-ca -n uyuni-proxy \
    --from-file=ca.crt=/path/to/uyuni-ca.crt
```

The certificate file passed to kubectl create secret tls needs to start with the server certificate followed by the chain of intermediary CA certificates if any. The root CA is not needed in this secret as it is expected in the uyuni-ca ConfigMap.

Both objects can also be created by the proxy-helm chart itself from the values in the configuration tarball, with no manual kubectl create step:

- proxy-cert is rendered from the server_crt and server_key fields of httpd.yaml.
- uyuni-ca is rendered from the ca_crt field of config.yaml.

This requires the configuration tarball to actually contain those fields. If the proxy configuration was generated with the SSL part skipped (for example via the SSL certificate selection list in the Web UI, or with spacecmd proxy_container_config_nossl), the tarball carries no certificates and the auto-render path produces nothing — proxy-cert and uyuni-ca must then be created manually as shown above.



When proxy-cert or uyuni-ca already exist in the namespace (created manually or by a previous tool), the chart leaves them alone and the proxy uses the values already present. To switch a pre-existing object over to helm management from the tarball values, set the cert.takeOwnership chart value to true and pass helm install --take-ownership (Helm 3.14+) once:

```
helm upgrade --install uyuni-proxy \
    --take-ownership \
    --set cert.takeOwnership=true \
    ...
```

The toggle is required because the default skip-if-exists behavior leaves nothing for --take-ownership to adopt. After adoption the objects carry the helm managed-by label and the chart treats them as helm-managed: value changes are applied on subsequent upgrades, and they are removed on helm uninstall like any other chart resource. On later upgrades cert.takeOwnership can be left at true or dropped back to false — the default render condition already covers helm-managed objects.

2.2.2.2. Storage

The proxy chart defines a volume as a Persistent Volume Claim (PVC).



- The creation of the underlying PV is the responsibility of the cluster administrators.
- The PVC use the ReadWriteOnce access mode.

The created PVC can be tuned Helm chart values, it can have the following values:

- size: to set the requested size of the PVC.
- storageClass: can be used to select the storage class to use for the PVC.
- extraLabels: can be used to add custom labels to the PVC.
- annotations: can be used to set custom annotations on the PVC.
- volumeName: can be used to hard code which volume the PVC should be bound to.
- selector: is the YAML fragment of the PVC selector to use to find the PV to bind to.

Refer to https://kubernetes.io/docs/concepts/storage/persistent-volumes/ for more information on persistent volumes and their claims.

Refer to the proxy-helm README for the list of persistent volume claims which will be created and will need to be bound to persistent volumes.



While the default sizes are provided, it is highly recommended to change them based on the distributions you plan to synchronize.

For more information on storage requirements see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › General Requirements**.

2.2.2.3. Exposing ports

Uyuni proxy requires some TCP and UDP ports to be routed to its services. Refer to the proxy-helm README for the list of ports to be exposed.



RKE2 ships with nginx as the default ingress controller. However, as this is deprecated and soon to be unsupported, the proxy-helm chart defaults to use Traefik as ingress controller. Using the nginx ingress controller might work and will not be documented, use at your own risk.

K3S ships Traefik by default, so no controller swap is needed.



The proxy-helm chart supports Gateway API version 1.4. Since this requires experimental CRDs which are not shipped with RKE2 1.35 or the bundled K3S Traefik, it is not recommended to be used in production.

There are multiple ways to expose the ports, but this documentation will only mention how to configure the

bundled Traefik on RKE2 and K3S. This is not a task for the Uyuni administrator, but the Kubernetes cluster administrator as it requires configuration to be set on the cluster nodes.

2.2.2.3.1. On RKE2

Create /var/lib/rancher/rke2/server/manifests/uyuni-traefik.yaml on each node with the following content. Note that Traefik takes a few seconds to be reinstalled after saving the file.

```
apiVersion: helm.cattle.io/v1
kind: HelmChartConfig
metadata:
  name: rke2-traefik
  namespace: kube-system
spec:
  valuesContent: |-
    ports:
      ssh:
        port: 8022
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 8022
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 8022
      salt-publish:
        port: 4505
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 4505
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 4505
        containerPort: 4505
      salt-request:
        port: 4506
        expose:
          default: true
        exposedPort: 4506
        protocol: TCP
        hostPort: 4506
        containerPort: 4506
```

2.2.2.3.2. On K3S

K3S ships Traefik in the kube-system namespace. Create /var/lib/rancher/k3s/server/manifests/uyuni-traefik.yaml on each node with the following content. The HelmChartConfig name is traefik and hostPort /containerPort are not required:

```
apiVersion: helm.cattle.io/v1
kind: HelmChartConfig
metadata:
  name: traefik
  namespace: kube-system
spec:
  valuesContent: |-
    ports:
      ssh:
```

```
      port: 8022
      exposedPort: 8022
      protocol: TCP
      expose:
        default: true
    salt-publish:
      port: 4505
      exposedPort: 4505
      protocol: TCP
      expose:
        default: true
    salt-request:
      port: 4506
      exposedPort: 4506
      protocol: TCP
      expose:
        default: true
```



On a vanilla K3S install, the bundled Traefik picks up every Ingress regardless of class. Set ingress.class: "" in the proxy-helm values so the chart does not emit a class annotation that would be ignored. If the Traefik install is customized to filter by class (for example via --providers.kubernetescrd.ingressclass=traefik), keep ingress.class: "traefik".



K3S's built-in load balancer (klipper-lb / serviceLB) does not support the TFTP protocol. Expose TFTP via the host network instead by setting tftp.hostNetwork: true in the chart values.



The Traefik entryPoint names (ssh, salt-publish and salt-request) must match the ingress.entryPoints values configured in the proxy-helm chart (the names above are the chart defaults). If the surrounding Traefik installation uses different entryPoint names, override the chart defaults via the ingress.entryPoints value:

```
ingress:
  entryPoints:
    ssh: "uyuni-ssh"
    saltPublish: "uyuni-publish"
    saltRequest: "uyuni-request"
```

If Traefik is used as the Ingress controller, the user needs access to additional resources. Add the following to the rules of the previously defined role:

```
- apiGroups: ["traefik.io", "traefik.containo.us"]
  resources: ["ingressroutetcps"]
  verbs: ["*"]
```

If Gateway API is used instead, add the following to the rules of the previously defined role:

```
- apiGroups: ["gateway.networking.k8s.io"]
  resources: ["gateways", "httproutes", "tcproutes"]
  verbs: ["*"]
```

TFTP is complex to expose from a Kubernetes pod due to the nature of the protocol: the TFTP server receives requests on port 69, but negotiates another random port to continue. This port also needs to stay the same through the whole session for the server to recognize the client as being the same. This means that there are only two possible ways to use the TFTP server:

- using a load balancer compatible with TFTP,
- using the host network for the TFTP pod. This can be achieved by setting the tftp.hostNetwork helm chart value to true.

2.2.2.4. DNS configuration

The dnsConfig chart value is a passthrough to the pod's Kubernetes PodDNSConfig. It is unset by default so the pod inherits the cluster's normal DNS behavior.

If external FQDN lookups from the proxy hang for around 10 seconds (the default urlopen timeout), the cluster's default ndots:5 is likely expanding the name through several cluster search domains before falling back to the bare lookup. Override with:

```
dnsConfig:
  options:
    - name: ndots
      value: "1"
```

2.2.3. Configuration generation

Before deploying the Uyuni proxy, a configuration archive needs to be generated.

2.2.3.1. Generate the Proxy Configuration with Web UI

Procedure: Generating a Proxy Container Configuration Using Web UI

1. In the Web UI, navigate to **Systems › Proxy Configuration** and fill the required data:
2. In the Proxy FQDN field type fully qualified domain name for the proxy.
3. In the Parent FQDN field type fully qualified domain name for the Uyuni Server or another Uyuni Proxy.
4. In the Proxy SSH port field type SSH port on which SSH service is listening on Uyuni Proxy. Recommended is to keep default 8022.

5. In the Max Squid cache size [MB] field type maximal allowed size for Squid cache. Recommended is to use at most 80% of available storage for the containers.



2 GB represents the default proxy squid cache size. This will need to be adjusted for your environment.

6. In the SSL certificate selection list choose if a new server certificate should be generated for Uyuni Proxy, an existing one should be used, or the SSL part should be skipped entirely. You can consider generated certificates as Uyuni builtin (self signed) certificates. If Uyuni server runs on Kubernetes, the generated certificate option is not possible and replaced with no SSL certificate as they are managed outside the containers.

   Depending on the choice then provide either path to signing CA certificate to generate a new certificate or path to an existing certificate and its key to be used as proxy certificate. If the SSL part is skipped, the resulting configuration archive does not carry server_crt, server_key or ca_crt; the deployment is then responsible for providing the proxy certificate and root CA out-of-band (for Kubernetes deployments this means creating proxy-cert and uyuni-ca manually — see the TLS setup section of the Kubernetes proxy deployment page).

   The CA certificates generated by the server are stored in the /var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/root/_data/ssl-build directory.

   For more information about existing or custom certificates and the concept of corporate and intermediate certificates, see **Administration Guide › Ssl Certs Imported**.

7. Click **[Generate]** to register a new proxy FQDN in the Uyuni Server and generate a configuration archive (config.tar.gz) containing details for the container host.

8. After a few moments you are presented with file to download. Save this file locally.

2.2.3.2. Generate Proxy Configuration With spacecmd and Self-Signed Certificate

You can generate a Proxy configuration using spacecmd. This is only possible if Uyuni server runs on podman and has a self-signed root CA certificate.

Procedure: Generating Proxy Configuration with spacecmd and Self-Signed Certificate

1. SSH into your container host.
2. Execute the following command replacing the Server and Proxy FQDN:

```
mgrctl exec -ti 'spacecmd proxy_container_config_generate_cert -- dev-
pxy.example.com dev-srv.example.com 2048 email@example.com -o
/tmp/config.tar.gz'
```

3. Copy the generated configuration from the server container:

```
mgrctl cp server:/tmp/config.tar.gz .
```

2.2.3.3. Generate Proxy Configuration With spacecmd and Custom Certificate

You can generate a Proxy configuration using spacecmd for custom certificates rather than the default self-signed certificates.

Procedure: Generating Proxy Configuration with spacecmd and Custom Certificate

1. SSH into your Server container host.
2. Execute the following commands, replacing the Server and Proxy FQDN:

```
for f in ca.crt proxy.crt proxy.key; do
  mgrctl cp $f server:/tmp/$f
done
mgrctl exec -ti 'spacecmd proxy_container_config -- -p 8022 pxy.example.com
srv.example.com 2048 email@example.com /tmp/ca.crt /tmp/proxy.crt
/tmp/proxy.key -o /tmp/config.tar.gz'
```

3. If your setup uses an intermediate CA, copy it as well and include it in the command with the -i option (can be provided multiple times if needed) :

```
mgrctl cp intermediateCA.pem server:/tmp/intermediateCA.pem
mgrctl exec -ti 'spacecmd proxy_container_config -- -p 8022 -i
/tmp/intermediateCA.pem pxy.example.com srv.example.com 2048 email@example.com
/tmp/ca.crt /tmp/proxy.crt /tmp/proxy.key -o /tmp/config.tar.gz'
```

4. Copy the generated configuration from the server container:

```
mgrctl cp server:/tmp/config.tar.gz .
```

2.2.3.4. Generate Proxy Configuration With spacecmd and no Certificate

You can generate a Proxy configuration using spacecmd with no TLS certificates. This is needed for Uyuni running on Kubernetes as the certificates are handled outside of the containers.

Procedure: Generating Proxy Configuration with spacecmd and no Certificate

1. SSH into your Server container host.
2. Execute the following commands, replacing the Server and Proxy FQDN:

```
for f in ca.crt proxy.crt proxy.key; do
  mgrctl cp $f server:/tmp/$f
done
mgrctl exec -ti 'spacecmd proxy_container_config_nossl -- -p 8022
pxy.example.com srv.example.com 2048 email@example.com -o /tmp/config.tar.gz'
```

3. Copy the generated configuration from the server container:

```
mgrctl cp server:/tmp/config.tar.gz .
```

2.2.4. Deploying the Uyuni Proxy Helm Chart

Copy and extract the generated configuration tar.gz file and then install using helm:

The values have sensible defaults, refer to the proxy-helm chart README for more details on those.

```
helm install uyuni-proxy \
    oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/proxy-helm \
    -n uyuni-proxy \
    --description "Proxy installation" \
```

```
    --set-file global.config=path/to/config.yaml \
    --set-file global.ssh=path/to/ssh.yaml \
    --set-file global.httpd=path/to/httpd.yaml \
    --set tag=2026.10 \
    --version 2026.10.0
```

When setting multiple values, using a YAML values file is recommended instead of passing several --set parameters. Refer to the helm command help for more details.

2.2.5. Example helm charts

Some helm charts using the proxy-helm chart can be found in the main branch of the uyuni-charts git repository. They show case how the TLS certificate can be generated using cert-manager and trust-manager. Those examples may assume to have Kubernetes cluster administrator permissions.

2.2.6. Uyuni Proxy Upgrade on Kubernetes

Proxies deployed via the proxy-helm chart (on either RKE2 or K3S) are upgraded by re-running helm upgrade --install against a newer chart version. The chart values and the existing PVC binding are preserved between releases.



This is the supported Kubernetes upgrade path. The legacy mgrpxy install kubernetes / mgrpxy upgrade kubernetes flow on K3S is replaced by the direct chart-based deployment; if you are still on that path, follow the one-time migration in kubernetes-guide/migrate-proxy-mgrpxy-to-helm.pdf before the procedure below applies.

Procedure: Upgrade the proxy on Kubernetes

1. Run helm upgrade against the new chart version, reusing the values from the previous release:

```
helm upgrade uyuni-proxy \
    oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/proxy-helm \
    --version 2026.10.0 \
    --set tag=2026.10 \
    --namespace uyuni-proxy \
    --reuse-values
```



--reuse-values keeps the values from the previous release intact (global.config/global.httpd/global.ssh, ingress.class, tftp.hostNetwork, volumes.squid.volumeName, dnsConfig, registrySecret, etc.), so no --set / --set-file flags need to be re-passed for a routine version bump.

If the proxy configuration tarball changed since the last install (TLS certificate rotation, server FQDN change, re-registration), re-extract the files and overlay them on top of --reuse-values:

```
mkdir -p /root/proxy-config
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c httpd -- cat
/etc/uyuni/config.yaml > /root/proxy-config/config.yaml
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c httpd -- cat
/etc/uyuni/httpd.yaml > /root/proxy-config/httpd.yaml
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c ssh   -- cat
/etc/uyuni/ssh.yaml   > /root/proxy-config/ssh.yaml
```

Then add the matching --set-file global.config=... / --set-file global.httpd=... / --set-file global.ssh=... flags to the helm upgrade command above. The same pattern applies to any other value that needs to change: keep --reuse-values and overlay the override with --set.

2. Watch the rollout and verify the pods come back up:

```
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy rollout status deploy/uyuni-proxy
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy get pod
```

On Kubernetes the image cleanup is handled automatically, or it depends on the Kubernetes distribution.

2.2.7. Migrating the Uyuni Proxy on K3s from mgrpxy to proxy-helm

2.2.7.1. Introduction

This document describes how to migrate a Uyuni Proxy deployed on K3s via mgrpxy install kubernetes (the legacy path) to a deployment using the proxy-helm chart directly.

The legacy path used mgrpxy as a thin wrapper around helm and installed the proxy with selector labels app: uyuni-proxy. The new path uses the proxy-helm chart directly with selector labels app.kubernetes.io/component: proxy. Since spec.selector is immutable in Kubernetes, the old deployment must be removed before the new one can be created. This causes a short downtime (approximately 30 to 60 seconds). The squid cache PVC can be preserved across the migration.

For the destination install procedure and chart values reference, see kubernetes-guide/proxy-kubernetes-

deployment.pdf.

2.2.7.1.1. Prerequisites

- The proxy is installed and running on a K3s cluster via mgrpxy install kubernetes.
- helm (3.x) and kubectl are available on the K3s node.
- The proxy is registered with the Uyuni Server.

2.2.7.2. Preparation (while the legacy install is still running)

Procedure: Preserve state and prepare the new namespace

1. Preserve the squid PVC by switching the PV reclaim policy to Retain.

```
PV=$(kubectl -n <namespace> get pvc squid-cache -o jsonpath
='{.spec.volumeName}')
kubectl patch pv $PV -p '{"spec":{"persistentVolumeReclaimPolicy":"Retain"}}'
```

   Replace <namespace> with the namespace where the legacy proxy is installed (often default for mgrpxy install kubernetes deployments).

2. Extract the configuration files from the running proxy.

```
mkdir -p /root/proxy-config
kubectl -n <namespace> exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c httpd -- cat
/etc/uyuni/config.yaml > /root/proxy-config/config.yaml
kubectl -n <namespace> exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c httpd -- cat
/etc/uyuni/httpd.yaml > /root/proxy-config/httpd.yaml
kubectl -n <namespace> exec deploy/uyuni-proxy -c ssh   -- cat
/etc/uyuni/ssh.yaml   > /root/proxy-config/ssh.yaml
```

3. Prepare the namespace for the new install.

```
kubectl create namespace uyuni-proxy
```

   The proxy-helm chart creates the proxy-cert TLS secret and the uyuni-ca ConfigMap automatically from the tarball values at install time.

2.2.7.3. Update Traefik (no downtime)

The legacy mgrpxy install configured the bundled K3s Traefik with entryPoint names uyuni-ssh, uyuni-publish and uyuni-request. The proxy-helm chart defaults to ssh, salt-publish and salt-request. Replace the Traefik

HelmChartConfig so the new entryPoints exist before the cutover:

```
cat > /var/lib/rancher/k3s/server/manifests/uyuni-traefik-config.yaml << 'EOF'
apiVersion: helm.cattle.io/v1
kind: HelmChartConfig
metadata:
  name: traefik
  namespace: kube-system
spec:
  valuesContent: |-
    ports:
      ssh:
        port: 8022
        exposedPort: 8022
        protocol: TCP
        expose:
          default: true
      salt-publish:
        port: 4505
        exposedPort: 4505
        protocol: TCP
        expose:
          default: true
      salt-request:
        port: 4506
        exposedPort: 4506
        protocol: TCP
        expose:
          default: true
EOF

kubectl -n kube-system rollout restart deploy/traefik
kubectl -n kube-system rollout status deploy/traefik
```



Until the cutover step below, the legacy proxy is still routed through the old entryPoint names that are no longer exposed; if its IngressRouteTCP objects reference them, traffic to the legacy proxy may already be interrupted. If continuous service is required, defer this step until immediately before the cutover.

2.2.7.4. Cutover (downtime starts here)

Procedure: Replace the legacy deployment with the proxy-helm chart

1. Uninstall the legacy release.

   ```
   helm -n <namespace> uninstall <release-name>
   ```

   The release name created by mgrpxy install kubernetes is typically uyuni-proxy.

2. Release the PV from its old claim so the new chart can bind to it.

```
kubectl patch pv $PV --type=json \
  -p '[{"op":"remove","path":"/spec/claimRef"}]'
```

3. Install the proxy-helm chart, binding to the existing squid PV.

```
helm upgrade --install uyuni-proxy \
    oci://registry.opensuse.org/uyuni/proxy-helm \
    --version 2026.10.0 \
    --namespace uyuni-proxy \
    --set "registrySecret=the-scc-secret" \
    --set-file global.config=/root/proxy-config/config.yaml \
    --set-file global.httpd=/root/proxy-config/httpd.yaml \
    --set-file global.ssh=/root/proxy-config/ssh.yaml \
    --set ingress.type=traefik \
    --set ingress.class=traefik \
    --set tftp.hostNetwork=true \
    --set volumes.squid.volumeName=$PV
```

+



The example uses ingress.class=traefik for the case where the surrounding Traefik filters by class (for example --providers.kubernetescrd.ingressclass=traefik). On a vanilla K3S install the bundled Traefik picks up every Ingress regardless of class; set ingress.class="" instead.

2.2.7.5. Verify

```
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy get pod -w
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy get pvc          # squid-cache should be Bound to the old PV
kubectl -n uyuni-proxy logs deploy/uyuni-proxy -c httpd --tail=20
```

2.2.7.5.1. Migration complete

The proxy is now managed by the proxy-helm chart directly, reusing the legacy squid cache volume.

Chapter 3. Salt Guide Overview

Salt is a remote execution engine, configuration management and orchestration system used by Uyuni to manage clients.

In Uyuni, the Salt master runs on the Uyuni Server, allowing you to register and manage Salt clients.

This book is designed to be a primer for using Salt with Uyuni.

For more information about Salt, see the Salt documentation at https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/contents.html.

The current version of Salt in Uyuni is 3006.0.

3.1. Security and execution boundary

Uyuni protects the Salt master and the Salt API from direct external access. External user requests must go through the Uyuni Web UI or API, where Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) verifies permissions before running Salt commands.

For detailed information about native Salt access controls, loopback API restrictions, and command-line execution, see salt/salt-access-control.pdf. For more information about RBAC permissions and Salt namespaces, see **Administration Guide › Role Based Access Control**.

3.2. Terminology

Beacon

Beacons allow you to use the Salt event system to monitor non-Salt processes. Clients can use beacons to connect to various system processes for constant monitoring. When a monitored activity occurs, an event is sent on the Salt event bus that can then trigger a reactor.



To use beacons on SUSE Linux Enterprise Server Salt clients, install the python-pyinotify package. For Red Hat Enterprise Linux systems, install the python-inotify package.

For more information on beacons, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/beacons/

Broker

The Salt broker allows clients to pass commands to each other. The broker acts like a switch, therefore peer communication will only work for clients on the same network, or connected to the same proxy.

For more information on Salt and peer communication, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/

peer.html.

Environment

Uyuni implements Salt with a single environment. Multiple Salt environments are not supported.

Formulas

Formulas are collections of Salt States that contain generic parameter fields. Formulas are used within Uyuni to assist with configuring Salt clients. Some formulas have extensive configuration options, and use forms to help organize them in the Uyuni Web UI.

For more information about formulas, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formulas Intro**.

Grains

Grains provide information about the hardware of a client. This includes the operating system, IP addresses, network interfaces, and memory. When you run a Salt command any modules and functions are run locally from the system being called.

For more information on grains, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/grains/.

Highstate

This term is used when you apply all outstanding states to all targeted clients at the same time. The highstate must be applied when doing changes to systems, including enabling and disabling formulas.

Key Fingerprints

Key fingerprints are exchanged between the Uyuni Server and Salt clients to verify the identity of the server and the client. This prevents Salt clients from connecting to the wrong server. You can see the fingerprints of your Salt clients by navigating to **Salt › Keys**.

Master

The Salt master issues commands to its attached clients. In Uyuni, the Salt master must be the Uyuni Server.

Minions

Salt clients that are connected to and controlled by the Salt master on the Uyuni Server. In Uyuni, these are sometimes referred to as Salt clients. This is a difference in terminology only.

Modules

Functions within Salt are stored in modules. Salt modules are stored on clients and the Uyuni Server within the /usr/lib/python*/site-packages/salt/ directory. There are many types of Salt modules, including state and execution modules. You can write your own Salt modules using Python.

For a complete list of available Salt modules, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/

index.html.

Pillars

Pillars are created on the Uyuni Server. They contain information about a client or group of clients. Pillars allow you to send confidential information to a targeted client or group of clients. Pillars are useful for sensitive data, configuration of clients, variables, and any arbitrary data.

For more information on pillars, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/tutorials/pillar.html.

States

States are configuration templates. They allow you to describe what each of your systems should look like, including the applications and services that are installed and running. States are applied to the target client. This automates the process of bringing a large number of systems into a known state, and then maintaining them.



Do not update the salt package using states. Update all other system packages using states. You can then update the salt package from the Uyuni Web UI as a separate step.

For more information on states, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/tutorials/starting_states.html.

For more Salt terminology, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/glossary.html.

3.3. Salt Command

Salt commands have three main components: target, function, and arguments. The calls are constructed in this format:

```
salt 'target' <function> [arguments]
```

The target defines the client, or group of clients, on which to run the function.

The function is the particular task to be run.

Arguments provide any extra data required by the function.

3.3.1. Salt Targets

Salt command targets allow you to specify a client or group of clients. There are several different targets you can use.

General Targeting

List available grains on all clients:

```
salt '*' grains.ls
```

Target a specific client:

```
salt 'web1.example.com' test.ping
```

Glob Targeting

Target all clients using a particular domain:

```
salt '*example.com' test.ping
```

Target all clients using a particular label:

```
salt 'label*' test.ping
```

List Targeting

Specify a flat list of clients, using their IDs:

```
salt -L 'client_ID1, client_ID2, client_ID3' test.ping
```

Regular Expression Targeting

You can also define targets with PCRE-compliant regular expressions:

```
salt -E '(?!web)' test.ping
```

IP Address Targeting

List available client IP addresses:

```
salt '*' network.ip_addrs
```

Target a specific client IP address:

```
salt -S '172.31.60.74' test.ping
```

Target all clients on a subnet:

```
salt -S 172.31.0.0/16 test.ping
```

For more on targeting, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/targeting/.

3.3.2. Salt Execution Modules

When you have specified a target, provide the module and function to execute on the target.

Find which modules can be executed on the target:

```
salt '*' sys.doc
```

For a full list of callable modules, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/modules/all/index.html.

3.3.3. Salt Function Arguments

Functions accept arguments for any extra data.

For example, the pkg.install function requires an argument specifying which package to install:

```
salt '*' pkg.install yast2
```

You can provide more than one argument to a function, with spaces between them. For example:

```
salt '*' cmd.run 'echo "Hello: $FIRST_NAME"' env='{FIRST_NAME: "John"}'
```

3.4. Often Used Salt Commands

This section contains the most commonly used Salt commands. For a complete list of available Salt commands, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/cli/index.html.

salt-run

Display all clients that are running:

```
salt-run manage.up
```

Display all clients that are not running:

```
salt-run manage.down
```

Display the current status of all Salt clients:

```
salt-run manage.status
```

Check the version of Salt running on the Uyuni Server and active clients:

```
salt-run manage.versions
```

salt-cp

Copy a file to a client or set of clients:

```
salt-cp '*' foo.conf /root
```

salt-key -l

List public keys:

```
salt-key -l all
```

salt-key -a my-minion

Accept pending key for a minion:

```
salt-key -a my-minion
```

salt-key -A

Accept all pending keys:

```
salt-key -A
```

salt grains

List all available grains:

```
salt '*' grains.ls
```

List collected grain system data:

```
salt '*' grains.items
```

3.5. Salt Access Control

This section describes access control mechanisms for Salt in Uyuni. It covers the distinction between Uyuni Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) and native Salt access controls.

3.5.1. Architectural boundaries

Uyuni separates access control into two distinct layers:

Uyuni RBAC (gateway layer)

Users interact with Salt features through the Uyuni Web UI or API. Uyuni verifies user identity and evaluates RBAC permissions before performing any Salt action. For example, running a command through **Salt › Remote Commands** requires the salt.remote_commands namespace permission. For more information, see **Administration Guide › Role Based Access Control**.

Native Salt access control (engine layer)

Salt provides built-in access control mechanisms, including external authentication (external_auth or eauth) and Publisher ACLs (publisher_acl). These mechanisms govern direct interactions with the Salt master daemon or the Salt API service.

3.5.2. External authentication (eauth)

The Salt API service (salt-api) runs on the Uyuni Server. By default, the service listens for HTTPS connections on port 9080, bound strictly to the local loopback interface (127.0.0.1). Direct network access from external clients is blocked.

The Salt API uses the external_auth file authentication module:

- Authentication credentials are stored in /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager-users.txt.
- A dedicated internal administrative account is generated during server setup.
- Only local system services (Tomcat and Taskomatic) use these credentials to communicate with the Salt API.

Individual Uyuni users do not possess personal credentials for salt-api. When a user initiates an action in the Web UI or API, Uyuni authenticates the user, enforces RBAC checks, and executes the necessary Salt commands through the internal loopback connection.

3.5.3. Publisher ACLs

Upstream Salt provides Publisher ACLs (publisher_acl) to permit non-root system users to execute Salt commands from the Uyuni Server command line.

publisher_acl maps individual system user names to the Salt execution modules they are permitted to run. Users listed in publisher_acl can then publish those commands to Salt clients without root privileges.

As a filesystem prerequisite for this configuration, Uyuni maintains group-read permissions (0640, group salt) on master configuration files such as /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager_engine.conf. This configuration prevents

permission denied errors when users in the salt group execute the salt command.



Salt commands run directly on the command line bypass Uyuni RBAC checks. They are not tracked as Uyuni actions and do not appear in the action history or the RBAC audit trail. Resulting changes on the client may not be reflected in the Uyuni database until the next system refresh. For standard operations, execute Salt tasks through the Web UI or the Uyuni API.

3.5.4. Recommended access model

For all multi-user management and delegation, use Uyuni RBAC instead of native Salt ACLs:

- Create custom roles (access groups) in **Admin › Access Control**.
- Grant granular permissions such as salt.remote_commands or salt.keys.
- Assign users to access groups to enforce least privilege and preserve complete auditability.

For detailed instructions on configuring custom roles, see **Administration Guide › Role Based Access Control**.

3.6. Salt States and Pillars

States are configuration templates. They allow you to describe what each of your systems should look like, including the applications and services that are installed and running. Salt state files are referred to as SLS (SaLt State) files.

States are applied to the target systems by matching relevant state data to clients. The state data comes from Uyuni in the form of package and custom states.

You can target clients at three specific levels of hierarchy and priority: individual clients, system groups, and organization. Individual clients have priority over groups, and groups have priority over the organization.

For example:

- The Organization requires that version 1 is installed. All clients are part of the same Organization.
- Group A requires that version 2 is installed. Client1, Client2, and Client3 are part of Group A.
- Group B requires any version installed. Client4 is part of Group B.

Leading to these possible scenarios:

- Client1 wants package removed, package is removed (Client Level)
- Client2 wants version 2, gets version 2 (Client Level)

- Client3 wants any version, gets version 2 (Group Level)
- Client4 wants any version, gets version 1 (Organization Level)

For more information on Salt states, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/states/.

You can create custom Salt states with Uyuni. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Custom States**.

3.6.1. Group States

Pillar data can be used to perform bulk actions, like applying all assigned states to clients within the group. This section contains some examples of bulk actions that you can take using group states.

To perform these actions, you will need to determine the ID of the group that you want to manipulate. You can determine the Group ID by using the spacecmd command:

```
spacecmd group_details
```

These examples use an example Group ID of GID.

To apply all states assigned to the group:

```
salt -I 'group_ids:GID' state.apply custom.group_GID
```

To apply any state (whether or not it is assigned to the group):

```
salt -I 'group_ids:GID' state.apply `state`
```

To apply a custom state:

```
salt -I 'group_ids:2130' state.apply manager_org_1.`customstate`
```

Apply the highstate to all clients in the group:

```
salt -I 'group_ids:GID' state.apply
```

3.6.2. Salt Pillars

Uyuni exposes a small amount of internal data as pillars which can be used with custom states. Pillars are created on the Uyuni Server, and contain information about a client or group of clients. For custom information in pillars, see **Client Configuration Guide › Custom Info**. Pillars are useful for sensitive data, configuration of clients, variables, and any arbitrary data.

Pillars are managed either automatically by Uyuni, or manually by the user.



If you change pillar data on the server (Salt master) the actual pillar data on the client (minion) is updated only after calling saltutil.refresh_pillar for the client.

Otherwise it could happen that pillar.items and pillar.get calls would produce different results with different values of pillars that were not refreshed.

To avoid hard-coding organization IDs within SUSE Linux Enterprise Server files, a pillar entry is added for each organization:

```
org-files-dir: relative_path_to_files
```

The specified file is available for all clients which belong to the organization.

This is an example of a pillar located at /etc/motd:

```
file.managed:
    - source: salt://{{ pillar['org-files-dir']}}/motd
    - user: root
    - group: root
    - mode: 644
```

For more information on Salt pillars, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/pillar/.

3.6.3. Download Endpoint

By default, Uyuni assumes that the download endpoint to use is the FQDN of the Uyuni Server or Proxy. However, there are some cases where you might like to use a different FQDN as the download endpoint. The most common example is if you need to use load balancing, caching proxies, or in environments with complicated networking requirements.

To change the package download endpoint, you can manually adjust three Salt pillars: * pkg_download_point_protocol, defaults to https. * pkg_download_point_host, defaults to the FQDN of the Uyuni Server (or Proxy, if in use). * pkg_download_point_port, defaults to 443.

If you do not adjust these pillars directly, Uyuni will fall back to the default values.

Procedure: Changing the Package Download Endpoint Pillar

1. Navigate to /srv/pillar/ and create a file called top.sls with these contents:

```
base:
  '*':
    - pkg_download_points
```

This example directs Salt to look at the pkg_download_points.sls file to determine the base URL to use. You can adjust this file to target different clients or groups, depending on your environment.

2. Remain in /srv/pillar/ and create a file called pkg_download_points.sls with the base URLs you want to use. For example:

```
pkg_download_point_protocol: http
pkg_download_point_host: example.com
pkg_download_point_port: 444
```

3. OPTIONAL: If you want to use external pillars, for example Group IDs, open the master configuration file and set the ext_pillar_first parameter to true. You can then use Group IDs to set conditional values, for example:

```
{% if pillar['group_ids'] is defined and 8 in pillar['group_ids'] %}
  pkg_download_point_protocol: http
  pkg_download_point_host: example.com
  pkg_download_point_port: 444
{% else %}
  pkg_download_point_protocol: ftp
  pkg_download_point_host: example.com
  pkg_download_point_port: 445
{%- endif %}
```

4. OPTIONAL: You can also use grains to set conditional values, for example:

```
{% if grains['fqdn'] == 'client1.example.com' %}
    pkg_download_point: example1.com
{% elif grains['fqdn'] == 'client2.example.com'' %}
    pkg_download_point: example2.com
{% else %}
    pkg_download_point: example.com
{% endif %}
```

3.7. GPG Encrypted Pillars

Salt has support to transparently decrypt GPG-encrypted Pillar data built-in. The decryption happens on the Salt Master during Pillar rendering.

3.7.1. Generate GPG keyring for Salt Master

The GPG keyring can be specified in /etc/salt/master or in its own file under /etc/salt/master.d/, for example /etc/salt/master.d/gpg-pillar.conf.

Always create a separate keyring for the Salt Master.

Procedure: Generating key pair

1. On the Salt Master create GPG home directory and restrict its permissions:

```
mkdir /etc/salt/gpgkeys
chmod 700 /etc/salt/gpgkeys
```

2. Generate a key pair interactively.



The password must be empty.

```
gpg --gen-key --homedir /etc/salt/gpgkeys
```

3. Salt does not run with root permissions on SUSE Linux Enterprise and openSUSE distributions.

```
chown -R salt:salt /etc/salt/gpgkeys
```

4. Configure Salt Master to use the new GPG home directory

```
echo 'gpg_keydir: /etc/salt/gpgkeys' >/etc/salt/master.d/gpg-pillar.conf
systemctl reload-or-restart salt-master
```

3.7.2. Use GPG for encrypting Pillar secrets

Salt's GPG renderer decrypts GPG encrypted contents that are ASCII-armored. To use the GPG renderer in a single Pillar YAML file, change

```
#!jinja|yaml
```

to

```
#!jinja|yaml|gpg
```

To use Salt's GPG renderer globally, including for **Client Configuration Guide › Custom Info**, configure Salt Master as follows

```
cat >/etc/salt/master.d/z-gpg-pillar.conf <<EOF
ext_pillar:
  - gpg: True
EOF
```



The filename should have a z- prefix to ensure the GPG renderer runs after other configured pillar renderers.

Encrypting pillar secrets can be done anywhere as long as the GPG and the public key generated in Procedure:

Generating key pair are available.

In this example, "MLM Salt Master" is the GPG key's UID created earlier.

```
echo 't0ps3cr3t' | gpg --armor --batch --encrypt --recipient "MLM Salt Master"
```

When the GPG encrytped contents are created and available as ASCII-armored output, this output can be used as a multi-line string in a pillar YAML file:

```
#!yaml|gpg

secret:
  my-secret: |
    -----BEGIN PGP MESSAGE-----

    hQEMA3OrmRaWrqgqAQf/ej8xV+nO3HVbQRCeJgCmt5ZjnogT++HHeFzXymfr1SgT
    XySyAqpIZB2N6MjZXtupO2sCmG6fzqtmnW+vRsZhQG8PAqzRtAekFuVbXzgkigBk
    338yOdyltVBtMONnkHFQ+7EP1tfJnWLCVrJ1I42vGFLZf2AD1xhbjewCcoaK82J4
    f8u9U/dxgV0N6na28WG5m6YU5Reu1Ca37PXHuqA/0XZl65DY63xaMPMDHZEi1wkU
    GXU7OsiL1dO0/sST1Awo5i99kVt/kA6DCGDuxTNpLrauNLOKUbtwcxvavtNZGwdQ
    yI9zWVx8qerWE0aO3M7zVDJftv77faV2ENiqzaadvtJHAZynW4GW7rSuP1RXFzlB
    DOAmzdRuIJwiLC9R2BKu3x+avReQb6xoz7eF7WthC0H0dz4mYakwPlVZ5yqYa/+G
    83i951rqAGI=
    =g+ji
    -----END PGP MESSAGE-----
```

When the pillar is assigned to a system with top.sls, the GPG encrypted pillar data is available in a decrypted format.



The client's in-memory cache is only updated on startup or when running execution module functions that trigger a cache refresh such as saltutil.refresh_pillar, pillar.items, or state.apply.

```
MLM-sles15sp1.tf.local:
    ----------
    my-secret:
        t0p s3cr3t!
```

3.7.3. Export the GPG key

To export the GPG key, use the command:

```
gpg --export 'MLM Salt Master' --homedir /etc/salt/gpgkeys --output MLM-salt-master.gpg
```

Here 'MLM Salt Master' is the name used during key generation.

The MLM-salt-master.gpg public key can be freely shared.

3.8. Custom Salt States

You can create your own custom Salt states with Uyuni as centrally managed configuration channels. Custom states are stored as Salt state files on the Uyuni Server with a .sls extension.

3.8.1. Create a New Custom Salt Channel

You can use the Uyuni Web UI to create and edit custom Salt state files. You must create a state channel first, with an initial state named init.sls. The init.sls file is used to reference all other state files within the channel. The custom states that you create using the Web UI are stored on the Uyuni Server in the /srv/susemanager/salt/<organization>/ directory.

After the channel is created with an init.sls file, you can write additional state files in the Web UI. Alternatively, you can upload existing state files to use within your state channel, or import them from other channels or clients.

Procedure: Creating a Custom Salt Channel and Initial State

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Configuration › Channels**.
2. Click **[Create State Channel]**.
3. In the Name field, type a name for your state.
4. In the Label field, type a label. Use alphanumeric characters, hyphens, and underscores. Do not use spaces.
5. In the Description field, type a short description of the configuration your state performs.
6. In the SLS Contents field, type the contents of your init.sls state. If you want to reference file templates in this configuration channel, ensure your file starts by specifying the source of the managed file, using this syntax:

```
file.managed:
  - source: salt://<org_name>/<channel_name>/etc/<ID>/<filename>
```

```
 Example custom state files are given later in this section.
. Click btn:[Update Channel] to save your state.
```

Procedure: Adding Additional Files to a Custom State Channel

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Configuration › Channels**. . Click the name of the channel you want to add files to.
2. To create a new file, click **[Create configuration file]** and type the contents of the file.
3. To upload an existing file, click **[Upload Configuration Files]** and select the file to upload.

4. To copy an existing file, click **[Import a File from Another Channel or System]** and select the file to copy.

Procedure: Editing a Custom Salt State

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Configuration › Channels**.
2. Click **[View/Edit <filename>.sls File]**.
3. Make your changes to the file.
4. Click **[Update Configuration File]** to save your state.

You can also manage revisions, compare the state to others in your organization, and download the .sls file from this dialog.

Procedure: Assigning a Client to a Custom Salt State

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Configuration › Channels**.
2. Click the name of the state you want to assign a client to.
3. Navigate to the **Systems › Target Systems** tab.
4. Check the clients you want to assign.
5. Click **[Subscribe systems]**.

For more information about Salt state modules, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/states/all/index.html.

3.8.2. Example Custom State Files

This section contains some example custom state files. Use these as a basis for writing your own custom states.

Listing 1. Example: Manage a File

```
my_config_change_id:
  file.managed:
    - name: /etc/my.conf
    - source: salt://example_org/example_channel/etc/my.conf
    - user: root
    - group: root
    - mode: 644
    - template: jinja
```

Listing 2. Example: Package Management

```
my_pkg_id:
  pkg.installed:
    - refresh: True
    - pkgs:
      - glibc
```

```
      - kernel-default
      - hello: 1.0-42
```

Listing 3. Example: Remote Command

```
ip_forward-on:
  cmd.run:
    - name: echo "1" > /proc/sys/net/ipv4/ip_forward
    - onlyif:
      - test `cat /proc/sys/net/ipv4/ip_forward` -eq 0
```

Listing 4. Example: Service Management

```
time_service_id:
  service.running:
    - name: chronyd
    - enable: True
```

3.8.3. Custom State to Trust a GPG Key

By default, operating systems trust only their own GPG keys when they are installed, and do not trust keys provided by third party packages. The clients can be successfully bootstrapped without the GPG key being trusted. However, you cannot install new third party packages or update them until the keys are trusted.

Salt clients are set to trust SUSE tools channels GPG keys when they are bootstrapped. For all other clients and channels, you need to manually trust third party GPG keys.

If you are bootstrapping Salt clients from the Uyuni Web UI, you can use a custom Salt state to trust the GPG key.

Procedure: Trusting a GPG Key With a Custom Salt State

1. Locate the key that you need to trust. Ensure you have the correct key, and that you also have the fingerprint used to verify the key. This information is available from the vendor or, in some cases, from a key server.
2. Copy the key to a file location where the client can access it. We recommend saving it in the /srv/www/htdocs/pub/ directory, where all user public files must be saved.
3. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Configuration › Channels**.
4. Click **[Create State Channel]**.
5. In the Name field, type a name for your state. For example, GPG Key Trusts.
6. In the Label field, type a label. For example, GPG_Key_Trusts.
7. In the Description field, type a short description of the configuration your state performs. For example, Trusts GPG Keys for CentOS.

8. In the SLS Contents field, create a state to retrieve the appropriate key from the Uyuni Server and trust it on the client. The exact contents of your state varies depending on your client operating system. For example:

```
rpm_trust_gpg_key:
  cmd.run:
    - name: rpm --import https://{{ salt['pillar.get']('mgr_server') }}/pub/<third-
party-gpg>.key
    - unless: rpm -q gpg-pubkey-<key_id>

deb_trust_gpg_key:
  mgrcompat.module_run:
    - name: pkg.add_repo_key
    - path: https://{{ salt['pillar.get']('mgr_server') }}/pub/<third-party-gpg>.key
```

```
  Alternatively, you can add GPG keys to a configuration channel, using a managed
file to deploy them directly on the client.
  In this case, you would use a local path to the key, rather than a URL.
. Click btn:[Update Channel] to save your state.
. Navigate to menu:Configuration[Channels] and click the name of the state you want
to assign a client to.
. Navigate to the menu:Systems[Target Systems] tab and check the clients you want to
assign.
. Click btn:[Subscribe systems].
 When the configuration file is next run on the client, the GPG key is trusted.
```

Alternatively, you can manage your GPG keys from your own repository hosted on an external file management system.

3.8.4. Apply a custom state at highstate

To apply a custom state at highstate create a mapping in /srv/salt/top.sls. This short example maps the test state to the system group 12:

```
# /srv/salt/top.sls
base:
  'group_ids:12':
    - match: pillar
    - test
```

3.9. Salt File Locations and Structure

There are several ways to set up the Salt file structure. This section describes how Salt is supported and set up as part of Uyuni Server. The main configuration file is /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf.



Do not edit the /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf configuration file. This file belongs to the spacewalk-setup package and is marked as %config. When SUSE updates the spacewalk-setup package, the susemanager.conf file is overwritten, and any customization is lost. Instead, add your own configuration file to the /etc/salt/master.d/ directory. This

prevents the update process from deleting your settings from the main susemanager.conf configuration file.

Some settings from /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf that can help with finding configuration options:

```
# Configure different file roots. Custom salt states should only be placed in
# /srv/salt.
# Users should not touch other directories listed here.
file_roots:
  base:
    - /usr/share/susemanager/salt
    - /usr/share/salt-formulas/states
    - /usr/share/susemanager/formulas/states
    - /srv/susemanager/salt
    - /srv/salt

# Configure different pillar roots. Custom pillar data should only be placed
# in /srv/pillar.
# Users should not touch other directories listed here.
pillar_roots:
  base:
    - /srv/pillar
```

When you are working with /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf, be aware that:

- Files listed are searched in the order they appear
- The first matching file found is called

The Uyuni Server reads Salt state data from five root directories:

/usr/share/susemanager/salt

This directory is shipped and updated with Uyuni and includes certificate setup and common state logic to be applied to packages and channels.



Do not edit or add custom Salt data to this directory.

/usr/share/salt-formulas/states

/usr/share/susemanager/formulas/states

These directories are shipped and updated with Uyuni or additional extensions. They include states for Salt formulas.



Do not edit or add custom Salt data to this directory.

/srv/susemanager/salt

This directory is generated by Uyuni, based on assigned channels and packages for clients, groups, and organizations. This directory will be overwritten and regenerated. It is the Salt equivalent of the Uyuni database.



Do not edit or add custom Salt data to this directory.

Within this directory, each organization has a sub-directory.

Listing 5. Example: SLS File Directory Structure

```
├──── manager_org_<org id>
│    ├──── files
│    │    ... files needed by states (uploaded by users)...
│    └──── state.sls
         ... other SLS files (created by users)...
For example:
├──── manager_org_TESTING
│    ├──── files
│    │    └──── motd     # user created
│    │    ... other files needed by states ...
│    └──── motd.sls     # user created
           ... other SLS files ...
```

/srv/salt

This directory is used for custom state data, modules, and related data. Uyuni does not operate or use this directory directly. The state data in this directory is used by the client highstate, and is merged with the total state result generated by Uyuni. Use this directory for custom Salt data.

The Uyuni Server reads Salt pillar data from two root directories:

/usr/share/susemanager/pillar

This directory is generated by Uyuni. It is shipped and updated together with Uyuni.



Do not edit or add custom Salt data to this directory.

/srv/pillar

By default, Uyuni does not operate or use this directory directly. The custom pillar data in this directory is merged with the pillar result created by Uyuni. Use this directory for custom Salt pillar data.



You can use the gitfs fileserver backend to serve Salt data from git repositories. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Gitfs**.

3.10. The gitfs Fileserver Backend

In Uyuni, pygit2 is the supported Python interface to git. When pygit2 is installed the gitfs fileserver backend is available and it is a supported feature.

Configuration options are set in the /etc/salt/master file, or in a separate configuration file in the /etc/salt/master.d/ directory. The basic settings are:

fileserver_backend

List of fileserver backends that the Salt master checks for files in the order they are defined. Options:

- roots: Files local on the Salt master (Uyuni Server). roots is required to keep the product running. You can only enable gitfs optionally. Additionally, SUSE strongly recommends to prefer roots (local files) over gitfs. The standard backend.
- gitfs: Files stored in one or more git repositories. The repositories are defined with gitfs_remotes.

  Example:

```
fileserver_backend:
  - roots
  - git
```

gitfs_remotes

List of git repositories. git://, https://, file://, or ssh:// URLs can be configured. For SSH remotes, a scp-like syntax is also supported; for example: gitlab@gitlab.example.com:universe/setup.git. Then you can also specify options for credentials, file locations, or branches such as pubkey, privkey, root,base.

Example:

```
gitfs_remotes:
  - https://example.com/myformulas/formula.git
  - gitlab@gitlab.example.com:universe/setup.git:
    - pubkey: /var/lib/salt/.ssh/id_rsa_gitlab.pub
    - privkey: /var/lib/salt/.ssh/id_rsa_gitlab
    - root: srv/salt
    - base: master
```

ext_pillar

List of external pillar interfaces. Salt can also serve pillar data from one or more git repositories. For syntax and options, also see the gitfs_remotes setting.

Example:

```
ext_pillar:
  - git:
    - master gitlab@gitlab.example.com:universe/setup.git:
      - root: srv/pillar
      - pubkey: /var/lib/salt/.ssh/id_rsa_gitlab.pub
      - privkey: /var/lib/salt/.ssh/id_rsa_gitlab
```

For more information, see:

- https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/tutorials/gitfs.html

- https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html

3.11. Install Using Yomi

Yomi (yet one more installer) is an installer for SUSE and openSUSE operating systems. Yomi is designed as a Salt state, and can be used for installing SUSE operating systems on new systems.

In Uyuni, Yomi can be used as part of provisioning new clients, as an alternative to AutoYaST.

Yomi consists of two components:

- The Yomi formula, which contains the Salt states and modules required to perform the installation.
- The operating system image, which includes the pre-configured salt-minion service.

Both components can be used independently of Uyuni, or integrated with it. This section describes how to use it with Uyuni.

- For more information about using Yomi independently, see https://github.com/openSUSE/yomi.
- For build assets, see https://build.opensuse.org/project/show/systemsmanagement:yomi.

To use Yomi for installing a client operating system, follow this process:

- Install the yomi-formula package.
- Prepare the Salt pillar for the new installation.
- Boot the new client using the PXE boot image for Yomi.



To use Yomi with Uyuni, ensure you have enough available memory. To boot from USB or DVD image, you need at least 512 MB. To boot from a PXE server, you need at least 2 GB.

3.11.1. Install the Yomi Formula

Before you begin, you need to install the Yomi formula, which is available as a package in Uyuni.

The yomi-formula package contains the Salt states and modules that describe the Yomi state, and the formulas with forms to create the pillar. It also contains documentation about the different sections of the pillar, and some examples about how to parameterize installations based on openSUSE, MicroOS, or SLE.

The formula package performs these actions:

- Adds a new configuration file called yomi-formula.conf in the /etc/salt/master.d/ directory. This configuration file defines the Python module and Salt states required by Yomi.

- Installs the Yomi Salt states in the /usr/share/salt-formulas/states/ directory.
- Provides some example configuration files in the /usr/share/yomi/ directory.
- Installs the required forms and sub-forms in the /usr/share/salt-formulas/metadata/ directory.
- Provides some pillar examples in the /usr/share/yomi/pillar/ directory.

Procedure: Installing the Yomi Formula

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, install the yomi-formula package:

```
zypper in yomi-formula
```

2. Restart services:

```
systemctl restart salt-master.service
```

For more information about the Yomi formula, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formula Yomi**.

3.11.2. Install the PXE Image

To provision a new client, you need an operating system image to boot from. You can use any image that contains a salt-minion service enabled, together with a minimal set of tools that are required during the installation, for example parted or btrfstools.

Yomi provides an already prepared image, based on openSUSE Tumbleweed, openSUSE Leap (for Uyuni), or SLE (for SUSE Multi-Linux Manager). For Uyuni, the image is packaged as an RPM. This is done in a similar way to how pxe-default-image is distributed.

The package installs a standard PXE OEM image generated by Kiwi, the initial kernel and initrd in the /srv/pxe-yomi-image/ directory, and the second stage kernel, initrd and image in the /srv/pxe-yomi-image/image directory.

Procedure: Installing the PXE Image

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, install the pxe-yomi-image service:

```
zypper in pxe-yomi-image-opensuse15
```

When you have the package installed, you can register Yomi in Cobbler.

3.11.3. Register Yomi in Cobbler

Uyuni uses Cobbler to manage the PXE boot service, so you will need to register the image in Cobbler.

Procedure: Registering the Yomi Image in Cobbler

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, create a directory for the Yomi image:

```
mkdir /srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-image
```

2. Define a distribution in Cobbler, including the path to install the second stage kernel and initrd, the location of the full image, and any further kernel options. Adjust this command to include the correct version of the product, and the TFTP server address:

```
cobbler distro add \
  --name=pxe-yomi-image \
  --kernel=/srv/pxe-yomi-image/linux \
  --initrd=/srv/pxe-yomi-image/initrd \
  --boot-files='/srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-image/image.initrd=/srv/pxe-yomi
-image/image/pxe-yomi-image-opensuse15.x86_64-1.0.0.initrd /srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-
image/image.kernel=/srv/pxe-yomi-image/image/pxe-yomi-image-opensuse15.x86_64-
1.0.0.kernel /srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-image/image.md5=/srv/pxe-yomi-image/image/pxe-
yomi-image-opensuse15.x86_64-1.0.0.md5 /srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-
image/image.config.bootoptions=/srv/pxe-yomi-image/image/pxe-yomi-image-opensuse15-
x86_64-1.0.0.config.bootoptions /srv/tftpboot/pxe-yomi-image/image.xz=/srv/pxe-yomi-
image/image/pxe-yomi-image-opensuse15.x86_64-1.0.0.xz' \
  --kernel-options='rd.kiwi.install.pxe rd.kiwi.install.image=tftp://<server-
address>/pxe-yomi-image/image.xz rd.kiwi.ramdisk ramdisk_size=2097152 net.ifnames=1'
```

By default, the salt-minion service in pxe-yomi-image is configured to find the Salt master under the salt address. If the DNS server is not able to resolve this address, you need to adjust the kernel-options parameter from the Cobbler command that register the distribution, and add a new kernel command line of ym.master=master_address. This will override the default configuration for the salt-minion.

Procedure: Registering the Yomi Profile in Cobbler

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, define a profile in Cobbler based on the image.

```
cobbler profile add \
  --name pxe-yomi-profile \
  --distro=pxe-yomi-image
```

2. OPTIONAL: Create a system in Cobbler. If you know the MAC address for the new client to be provisioned, you can have it boot directly from the Yomi image.

```
cobbler system add \
   --name=yomi \
   --mac=00:11:22:33:44:55 \
   --profile=pxe-yomi-profile
```

3. When the new node has been provisioned, remove the temporary Cobbler system:

```
cobbler system remove --name=yomi
```

3.11.4. Example Salt Pillar Preparation

The parameters of the new installation are defined with a Salt pillar. The pillar includes parameters that the Yomi state requires during the installation, including the partitions, file systems, repositories, packages installed, and services enabled.

The pillar is defined using the formulas with forms. In this example, we prepare the pillar for a minimal openSUSE Tumbleweed installation. You can find examples for MicroOS or SLES in the example directory /usr/share/yomi/pillar/.

To begin, boot the client that you want to provision using the Yomi PXE boot image, using the Cobbler procedures described earlier in this section.

When the salt-minion service is running on the new client, accept the key by navigating to **Salt › Keys**. When the key is accepted, you can view and manage the client by navigating to **Systems › Overview**. Navigate to the Formulas tab, and add all the Yomi Installer formulas to the client. When you have added all the formulas, complete the forms and sub-forms. This section outlines each form and provides example settings for a minimal installation. For a detailed explanation of every option, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formula Yomi**.

Yomi

The Yomi form contains some general configuration options. For example, the keyboard language and layout, the locale information, and the option to perform a full reset of the system after provisioning.

For this example, set the Reboot parameter to yes.

Yomi Storage

This sub-form provides information about the devices, partitioning, file system (including the BtrFS subvolumes, for example), and LVM and RAID configuration.

For this example, we assume that the new client has a single device named /dev/sda, and that it belongs to a non-UEFI system. In this case, we have only three partitions: one for the boot loader, one for swap and one for the system. We also expect to have an ext4 file system for the root directory.

Device 1:

- Device: /dev/sda
- Label: GPT
- Initial Gap: 1 MB

Create three partitions:

- Partition 1:
  - Partition Number: 1
  - Partition Size: 1 MB
  - Partition Type: boot
- Partition 2:
  - Partition Number: 2
  - Partition Size: 1024 MB
  - Partition Type: swap
- Partition 3:
  - Partition Number: 3
  - Partition Size: rest
  - Partition Type: linux

Create two file systems:

- Filesystem 1:
  - Partition: /dev/sda2
  - Filesystem: swap
- Filesystem 2:
  - Partition: /dev/sda3
  - Filesystem: ext4
  - Mountpoint: /

Yomi Bootloader

This sub-form provides details required for GRUB.

Set these parameters:

- Device: /dev/sda
- Theme: selected

The Kernel parameter can be used for the GRUB append section.

Yomi Software

This form provides the different repositories and packages to install. You can also register the product in

this form, using SUSEConnect, and install the different modules after registering.

For this example we are going to install a very minimal openSUSE Tumbleweed distribution, using publicly available repositories. For production deployments, you will need to provide a local repository.

Add a new repository: * Repository Name: repo-oss * Repository URL: http://download.opensuse.org/tumbleweed/repo/oss/

Add these packages: * pattern:enhanced_base * glibc-locale * kernel-default

You can also add patterns and products, together with packages, by using the correct prefix.

Yomi Services

By default Yomi is installed with the salt-minion service, but you must enable it.

Add a new enabled service:

- Service 1:
  - Service: salt-minion

    Yomi Users

    This form sets out the system users. In this example, we have a single root user. To provide a password, you must use the hashed version of the password, not the plain text. This behavior is set to be changed in future versions of Yomi.

- User 1:
  - Username: root
  - Password Hash: 1wYJUgpM5$RXMMeASDc035eXNbYWFl0

3.11.5. Monitor the Installation

You can monitor the installation as it progresses, using the monitor tool from Yomi. You can continue monitoring as the highstate is applied to the new client. To use the tool, you will need to have enabled Events in the Yomi formula, and have the salt-api service activated.

For more information about the salt-api service, and how to use the monitor tool, see https://github.com/openSUSE/yomi.

3.12. Salt Formulas

Formulas are collections of Salt States that contain generic parameter fields. Formulas allow for reliable reproduction of a specific configuration. Some formulas are supplied by SUSE, or you can install formulas from

RPM packages or an external git repository.

Formulas work best for large, non-trivial, configurations. For smaller tasks, use a state rather than a formula. Formulas and states both act as a kind of configuration documentation. When you have written and stored the configuration, they provide a snapshot of your infrastructure.

Formula data can be managed using the XMLRPC API.

You can use the Uyuni Web UI to apply Uyuni formulas. The most commonly used formulas are documented in this section.

Alternatively, you can use pre-written formulas as a starting point for your own custom formulas. Pre-written formulas are available from https://github.com/saltstack-formulas.

For more information on custom formulas, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formulas Custom**.

3.12.1. Formulas Provided by Uyuni

Some formulas are installed by default with Uyuni. Other official formulas can be installed as RPM packages. When the formula is installed, you can activate them using the Uyuni Web UI.

For information about writing custom formulas, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formulas Custom**.

3.12.1.1. Install Formulas with Zypper

Formulas are provided in the Uyuni pool software channel.



If a formula uses the same name as an existing Salt state, the two names will collide, and could result in the formula being used instead of the state. Always check states and formulas to avoid name clashes.

Procedure: Installing Formulas with Zypper

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, search for available formulas:

```
zypper se --type package formula
```

2. Get more information about a formula:

```
zypper info <formula_name>
```

3. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, install the formula:

```
zypper in <formula_name>
```

3.12.1.2. Activate Formulas from the Web UI

Formulas provided by Uyuni, or formulas that you have installed, can be activated using the Uyuni Web UI.

Procedure: Activate Formulas from the Web UI

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › List**, select the client you want to activate the formula for.
2. Navigate to the **Systems › Formulas** tab, and check the formula you want to activate.
3. Click **[Save]**.
4. Navigate to the new subtab for the formula, and configure the formula as required.
5. Apply the highstate.

3.12.2. Bind Formula

The Bind formula is used to configure the Domain Name System (DNS) on the branch server. POS terminals will use the DNS on the branch server for name resolution of Saltboot specific hostnames.

When you are configuring the Bind formula for a branch server with a dedicated internal network, check that you are using the same fully qualified domain name (FQDN) on both the external and internal branch networks. If the FQDN does not match on both networks, the branch server will not be recognized as a proxy server.



The following procedure outlines a standard configuration with two zones. Adjust it to suit your own environment.

Zone 1 is a regular domain zone. Its main purpose is to resolveSaltboot hostnames such as TFTP, FTP, or Salt. It can also resolve the terminal names if configured.

Zone 2 is the reverse zone of Zone 1. Its main purpose is to resolve IP addresses back to hostnames. Zone 2 is primarily needed for the correct determination of the FQDNs of the branch.

Procedure: Configuring Bind with Two Zones

1. Check the Bind formula, click Save, and navigate to the **Formulas › Bind** tab.
2. In the Config section, select Include Forwarders.
3. In the Configured Zones section, use these parameters for Zone 1:
    - In the Name field, enter the domain name of your branch network (for example: branch1.example.com).

- In the Type field, select master.

4. Click Add item to add a second zone, and set these parameters for Zone 2:
   - In the Name field, use the reverse zone for the configured IP range (for example: com.example.branch1).
   - In the Type field, select master
5. In the Available Zones section, use these parameters for Zone 1:
   - In the Name field, enter the domain name of your branch network (for example: branch1.example.org).
   - In the File field, type the name of your configuration file.
6. In the Start of Authority (SOA) section, use these parameters for Zone 1:
   - In the Nameserver (NS) field, use the FQDN of the branch server (for example: branchserver.branch1.example.org).
   - In the Contact field, use the email address for the domain administrator.
   - Keep all other fields as their default values.
7. In the Records section, in subsection A, use these parameters to set up an A record for Zone 1:
   - In the Hostname field, use the hostname of the branch server (for example: branchserver).
   - In the IP field, use the IP address of the branch server (for example, 192.168.1.5).
8. In the Records section, subsection NS, use these parameters to set up an NS record for Zone 1:
   - In the input box, use the hostname of the branch server (for example: branchserver).
9. In the Records section, subsection CNAME, use these parameters to set up CNAME records for Zone 1:
   - In the Key field, enter tftp, and in the Value field, type the hostname of the branch server (for example: branchserver).
   - Click Add Item. In the Key field, enter ftp, and in the Value field, type the hostname of the branch server.
   - Click Add Item. In the Key field, enter dns, and in the Value field, type the hostname of the branch server.
   - Click Add Item. In the Key field, enter dhcp, and in the Value field, type the hostname of the branch server.
   - Click Add Item. In the Key field, enter salt, and in the Value field, type the FQDN of the branch server (for example: branchserver.branch1.example.org).
10. Set up Zone 2 using the same parameters as for Zone 1, but ensure you use the reverse details:
    - The same SOA section as Zone 1.

- Empty A and CNAME records.
- Additionally, configure in Zone 2:
  - Generate Reverse field by the network IP address set in branch server network formula (for example, 192.168.1.5/24).
  - For Zones should specify the domain name of your branch network (for example, branch1.example.org).

11. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.
12. Apply the highstate.



Reverse name resolution on terminals might not work for networks that are inside one of these IPv4 private address ranges:

- 10.0.0.0/8
- 172.16.0.0/12
- 192.168.0.0/16

If you encounter this problem, go to the Options section of the Bind formula, and click **[Add item]**:

- In the Options field, enter empty-zones-enable.
- In the Value field, select No.

3.12.3. Branch Network Formula

The Branch Network formula is used to configure the networking services required by the branch server, including DHCP, DNS, TFTP, PXE, and FTP.



The formula is used only for connecting Uyuni Proxy 4.3. with Uyuni Server 2026.10. Do not use this formula if you want to connect Uyuni Proxy 2026.10.

3.12.3.1. Set Up a Branch Server Networking

The branch server can be configured to use networking in many different ways. The most common ways provide either a dedicated or shared LAN for terminals.

3.12.3.1.1. Set Up a Branch Server with a Dedicated LAN

In this configuration, the branch server requires at least two network interfaces: one acts as a WAN to communicate with the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager server, and the other one acts as an isolated LAN to

communicate with terminals.

This configuration allows for the branch server to provide DHCP, DNS, TFTP, PXE, and FTP services to terminals. These services can be configured with Salt formulas in the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI.

Procedure: Setting Up a Branch Server with a Dedicated LAN

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. In the Branch Network section, set these parameters:
    - Keep Dedicated NIC checked.
    - In the NIC field, enter the name of the network device that is connected to the internal LAN.
    - In the IP field, enter the static IP address to be assigned to the branch server on the internal LAN.
    - In the Netmask field, enter the network mask of the internal LAN.
3. Check Enable Route if you want the branch server to route traffic from internal LAN to WAN.
    - Check Enable NAT if you want the branch server to convert addresses from internal LAN to WAN.
    - Select the bind DNS forwarder mode.
    - Check DNS forwarder fallback if you want to rely on an external DNS if the branch DNS fails.
    - Specify the working directory, and the directory owner and group.

3.12.3.1.2. Set up a Branch Server with a Shared Network

In this configuration, the branch server has only one network interface card, which is used to connect to the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager server as well as the terminals.

This configuration allows for the branch server to provide DNS, TFTP, PXE, and FTP services to terminals. These services can be configured with Salt formulas in the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI. Optionally, the branch server can also provide DHCP services in this configuration.



If DHCP services are not provided by the branch server, ensure that your external DHCP configuration is set correctly:

- The next-server option must point to the branch server for PXE boot to work.
- The filename option must correctly identify the network boot program (by default, this is /boot/pxelinux).
- The domain-name-servers option must point to the branch server for correct host name resolution.

Procedure: Setting Up a Branch Server with a Shared Network

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. In the Branch Network section, set these parameters:
    - Keep Dedicated NIC unchecked.
    - Enable services on the branch server's firewall. Ensure you include DNS, TFTP, and FTP services.
    - Select the bind DNS forwarder mode.
    - Check DNS forwarder fallback if you want to rely on an external DNS if the branch DNS fails.
    - Specify the working directory, and the directory owner and group.

3.12.3.2. Set up Branch Server Terminal Naming

In this configuration it is required to fill at least Branch Identification. This identifies Branch Server in Retail subsystem and is also used to better organize terminals with their respective branch servers.

Procedure: Setting up a Branch Server Identification

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. In the Terminal Naming section, enter the Branch Identification string.
3. Click **[Save]** to save your changes.
4. Apply the highstate.

It is also possible to set various options about terminal naming, for more information about terminal naming see **Retail Guide › Retail Terminal Names**.

3.12.4. DHCPd Formula

The DHCPd formula is used to configure the DHCP service on the branch server.

Procedure: Configuring DHCP

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. Check the Dhcpd formula, and click **[Save]**.
3. Navigate to the **Formulas › Dhcpd** tab, and set these parameters:
    - In the Domain Name field, enter the domain name for the branch server (for example:

branch1.example.com).

- In the Domain Name Server field, enter either the IP address or resolvable FQDN of the branch DNS server (for example: 192.168.1.5).
- In the Listen Interfaces field, enter the name of the network interface used to connect to the local branch network (for example: eth1).

4. Navigate to the Network Configuration (subnet) section, and use these parameters for Network1:
   - In the Network IP field, enter the IP address of the branch server network (for example: 192.168.1.0).
   - In the Netmask field, enter the network mask of the branch server network (for example: 255.255.255.0).
   - In the Domain Name field, enter the domain name for the branch server network (for example: branch1.example.com).
5. In the Dynamic IP Range section, use these parameters to configure the IP range to be served by the DHCP service:
   - In the first input box, set the lower bound of the IP range (for example: 192.168.1.51).
   - In the second input box, set the upper bound of the IP range (for example: 192.168.1.151).
6. In the Broadcast Address field, enter the broadcast IP address for the branch network (for example: 192.168.1.255).
7. In the Routers field, enter the IP address to be used by routers in the branch server network (for example: 192.168.1.5).
8. In the Next Server field, enter the hostname or IP address of the branch server (for example: 192.168.1.5).
9. In the Filename field, if you are booting a client using PXE, type the path to the PXE bootloader. There is usually no need to change the default value of /boot/pxelinux.0.
10. In the Filename Efi field, if you are booting a UEFI client using PXE, type the path to the PXE bootloader. There is usually no need to change the default value of /boot/shim.efi.
11. In the Filename Http field, if you are booting a UEFI client using HTTP, type http://branchserver/saltboot/boot/shim.efi.
12. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.
13. Apply the highstate.

3.12.5. Image Synchronization Formula

The Image Synchronization formula is used to configure when OS images are synchronized to the branch server, and to specify which images to synchronize.

If this formula is not enabled, synchronization must be started manually, and all images will be synchronized.

Procedure: Configuring Image Synchronization

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. Check the Image Synchronize formula, and click **[Save]**.
3. Navigate to the **Formulas › Image Synchronize** tab, and set these parameters:
    - Check the Include Image Synchronization in Highstate field to have image synchronization occur every time highstate is applied. This ensures that you do not have to perform image synchronization manually, however it requires a high bandwidth environment.
    - In the Synchronize only the listed images field, click **[Add item]** to add the images you want to have synchronized automatically. Alternatively, you can leave this list blank to have all images synchronized.
4. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.
5. Apply the highstate.



The Image Synchronization state does not delete cached images. If you are running out of disk space, check the size of the Salt client cache directory, and delete it if required. By default, the directory is located at /var/cache/salt/minion.

3.12.6. Liberate Formula

The liberate formula migrates systems from EL clients such as CentOS 7 or Red Hat Enterprise Linux 9 to SUSE Liberty Linux. With this formula the conversion will take place during the client onboarding on Uyuni.



The Liberate Formula comes preinstalled within the server container.

3.12.6.1. Configure Uyuni

To provide all the software channels for SUSE Liberty Linux on the Uyuni Server, proceed as follows.

Procedure: Providing SUSE Customer Center credentials

1. Sign in to SUSE Customer Center at https://scc.suse.com.
2. Navigate to My Organization, and select your organization.
3. Navigate to **Users › Organization Credentials** and take note of your organization username and password.
4. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Admin › Setup Wizard › Organization**

Credentials to add the credentials to your Uyuni Server.

5. Click **[Add new credential]**, and enter the SUSE Customer Center username and password noted in a previous step.

Procedure: Synchronizing the SLL/SLES-ES channels

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Admin › Setup Wizard › Products**
2. Select the SUSE Liberty Linux Channels that you will use:
   - EL7 LTSS: SUSE Linux Enterprise Server with Expanded Support LTSS 7 x86_64
   - EL7: SUSE Linux Enterprise Server with Expanded Support 7 x86_64
   - EL8: RHEL or SLES ES or CentOS 8 Base
   - EL9: RHEL and Liberty 9 Base
3. Click the top right button **[Add products]**.

Initial sychronization can take considerable time. You can check progress by accessing the server machine via SSH and monitoring the logs using:

```
tail -f /var/log/rhn/reposync/*
```

Procedure: Creating one activation key per SUSE Liberty Linux parent channel

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › Activation Keys**, and click the top right button **[Create key]**.
2. In the Activation Key dialog, set the fields:

   Description

   Enter some text describing the activation key.

   Key

   Enter the identifier of the key. For example [literal`sll9-default` for EL 9 systems. Note: Keys will have a numeric prefix depending on the organization, so that they are unique.

Usage

Leave blank.

Base Channel

Select one base channel:

- EL7 LTSS: RES-7-LTSS-Updates for x86_64
- EL7: RHEL x86_64 Server 7
- EL8: RHEL8-Pool for x86_64
- EL9: EL9-Pool for x86_64

Child Channel

Include all child channels.

Add-On system type

Leave all blank.

Contact Method

Default

Universal Default

Leave unchecked.

3. Click **[Create Activation Key]**.

3.12.6.2. Add Liberate formula and assign it to activation keys

When installed, the formula can be assigned to an Activation Key by creating a System Group.

Procedure: Assigning system group and assigning Liberate formula

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › System Groups**, and click the **[Create Group]** button in top right corner.
2. In the dialog, fill in the following data:

Name

Liberate

Description

Systems to be converted to SUSE Liberty Linux

3. From the Liberate System Group page, navigate go to the Formulas tab.
4. Select the Liberate formula, and click **[Save]**. A new tab called Liberate will appear.
5. On the Liberate tab, you see the Reinstall all packages after conversion option. Keep it checked if you want to reinstall all the packages during the migration. This way you ensure all the packages will have SUSE signatures and no previous package will be kept. If you do not want to change the state of your system during the migration, uncheck this option and click the **[Save Formula]** button. In this case, you can reinstall the packages later.



When reinstall all packages is selected, a few packages like kernel, grub2 and shim might be excluded due to update restrictions of yum/dnf. After the system is migrated, update the kernel when a newer version is available. In case of secure boot enabled, take care that kernel, grub2 and shim are always coming from the same vendor and are signed with the same key.

Now a system group exists that has assigned the Liberate formula. This formula will be applied only once to migrate the system to SUSE Liberty Linux, even if you run it multiple times. With the next procedure, assign the system group to the activation key.

Procedure: Assigning the system group to the activation key

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › Activation Keys**.
2. Select the activation key, for example sll9-default for the EL 9 systems.
3. From the activation key page navigate to the **Groups › Join** tab, select the Liberate group, and click the **[Join Selected Groups]** button. The group will be assigned to the activation key.

Procedure: Applying migrate directly during registration

1. From the activation key page, navigate to the Details tab.
2. Navigate to the Configuration File Deployment section, and check the Deploy configuration files to systems on registration option.
3. Click **[Update Activation Key]**.

When you register a system with this key it will perform the migration automatically.

3.12.6.3. Register new system and proceed to migration

There are two ways to onboard (or register) a new client with the activation key:

- For one-off registration or for testing purposes, see **Client Configuration Guide › Registration Webui**
- For mass registration, see **Client Configuration Guide › Registration Bootstrap**.

3.12.6.3.1. Already registered clients

Software channels, system group membership, and formulas can be assigned to any already registered client. This method makes use of the bootstrap script mentioned above.

Procedure: Creating a reactivation key

1. In the Uyuni Web UI, open the System Details page of any registered client you want to migrate to SUSE Liberty Linux.
2. Click the Reactivation tab. If there is already a key listed, you can use it. If not, click **[Generate New Key]**, and copy the entire key. The key name will begin with re-.
3. SSH into this client and set the environment variable to be the key that you copied:

```
export REACTIVATION_KEY=re-xxxxxxxxxxxxx
```

4. Run the bootstrap script from **Client Configuration Guide › Registration Bootstrap**, and the system will re-register using the same profile as before, but with the newly assigned SUSE Liberty Linux context.



Make sure you use the activation key with the Liberate formula assigned.

3.12.7. Monitoring Formula

The monitoring services in Uyuni are configured using formulas with forms. The package is installed by default, and contains these formulas:

- Grafana
- Prometheus
- Prometheus Exporters

For more information about using monitoring, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

3.12.7.1. Prometheus

Procedure: Configuring the Prometheus Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Prometheus** tab, and set these parameters in the Prometheus section:
    - Check the Enabled box to enable Prometheus monitoring.
    - In the Scrape interval field, type the frequency of data scraping, in seconds. For example, 15 will scrape data every fifteen seconds.
    - In the Evaluation interval field, type the frequency of rules evaluation, in seconds. For example, 15 will evaluate alerting and aggregation rules every fifteen seconds.
2. In the TLS section, set these parameters:
    - Check the Enabled box to enable the secure configuration on Prometheus server.
    - In the Server Certificate field, type the path to the TLS server certificate.
    - In the Server Key field, type the path to the TLS server key.

- In the User field, type the user name for Prometheus server.
- In the Password Hash field, type the password for Prometheus server hashed with bcrypt.
  - To generate password hash, use tool htpassswd available from apache2-utils package.
  - For example:

```
htpasswd -nbBC 10 "" "thePassword" | tr -d ':'
```

3. In the Uyuni Server section, set these parameters:
   - Check the Enabled box to enable monitoring on this server.
   - Check the Autodiscover clients box to enable Prometheus to automatically find and monitor new clients when they are added to the server.
   - In the Username field, type the user name of the Prometheus account on the server.
   - In the Password field, type the password of the Prometheus account on the server.
   - In the Targets TLS section, set these parameters:
     - Check the Enabled box to enable the secure configuration for auto-discovered targets.
     - In the CA Certificate field, type the path to the Certificate Authority certificate.
     - In the Client Certificate field, type the path to the TLS client certificate for authentication.
     - In the Client Key field, type the path to the TLS client key for authentication.
4. In the Alerting section, set these parameters:

- Check the Enable local Alertmanager service box to enable the alert manager service.
- Check the Use local Alertmanager box to use the local alert manager service.

5. For each alert manager you want to use, in the **Alerting › Alertmanagers** section, click `[+]`, and set these parameters:
   - In the IP Address:Port field, type the location of the alert manager target, including the port number.
6. To use a rule file, in the **Alerting › Rule Files** section, click `[+]`, and set these parameters:
   - In the Rule Files field, type the location of the rule file you want to use.
7. To add a custom scrape configuration, in the User defined scrape configurations section, click `[+]`, and set these parameters:
   - In the Job name field, type a unique job name for your configuration.
   - In the Files field, type the location pattern of file service discovery files you want to use. For more information, see the upstream documentation https://prometheus.io/docs/prometheus/latest/configuration/configuration/#file_sd_config.
8. Click `[Save Formula]` to save your configuration.



The formula does not generate and deploy the TLS certificates and keys. Ensure the files are present on the Salt client and readable for the user prometheus before applying the highstate. For more information about generating client and server certificates, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

3.12.7.2. Grafana

Procedure: Configuring the Grafana Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Grafana** tab, and set these parameters in the Grafana section:

- Check the Enabled box to enable Grafana visualizations.



Initial admin password is used on the first run only, and Grafana UI prompts to change it. This field cannot be used to change the Grafana password. For more information on how to change the password, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

2. For each Prometheus data source you want to use, in the **Datasources › Prometheus** section, click `[+]`, and set these parameters:
   - In the Datasource name field, type a name to identify the data source.
   - In the Prometheus URL field, type the used protocol, the location of the Prometheus server, and append port 9090. For example, http://example.com:9090. In case TLS encryption is enabled in Prometheus formula make sure to use https protocol and FQDN.
   - Optionally, if TLS encryption is enabled in Prometheus formula. In the fields Prometheus server username and Prometheus server password, enter basic authentication credentials for Prometheus server matching the ones in Prometheus formula.
3. In the Dashboards section, check the dashboards you want to use:
   - Uyuni server dashboard
   - Uyuni clients dashboard
   - PostgreSQL dashboard
   - Apache HTTPD dashboard
   - Kubernetes cluster dashboard
   - Kubernetes etcd dashboard
   - Kubernetes namespaces dashboard
4. Click `[Save Formula]` to save your configuration.

3.12.7.2.1. Report DB

The Grafana formula can connect directly to the Uyuni reporting database and deploy pre-built dashboards for fleet management and compliance reporting.

Procedure: Configuring the Report DB Datasource

1. In the **Datasources › Report DB** section, check the Enabled box.
    - This automatically creates a read-only reporting database user (named grafana_<minion_id>) with a secure randomized password and configures the datasource automatically.
2. If you are configuring the reporting database on a Hub server, check the This Report DB is for a Hub server box.
3. Apply the highstate.

The formula automatically connects to the reporting database on the managed Uyuni server. The server hostname and database name are auto-detected. The database user credentials are automatically generated and stored in the Salt pillars.

The following dashboards are installed under a Reporting folder in Grafana:

- Hub Overview (only if the Hub option is enabled): high-level overview of the Hub setup, listing peripheral servers and their fleets.
- Fleet Overview & Security : fleet composition, security posture, CVE analysis, patch compliance, proxy infrastructure, and virtualization overview.
- Reports & History : channels, packages, errata, actions, system inventory, user management, system history, and SCAP compliance.
- Executive Overview : dynamic statistics including system counts and package queries.

3.12.7.3. Prometheus Exporters

Procedure: Configuring the Prometheus Exporters Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Prometheus Exporters** tab, and set these parameters in the Node Exporter section:
    - Check the Enabled box to enable the node exporter.

- In the Arguments field, type any customized arguments for this exporter. For example, --web.listen-address=":9100".

2. In the Apache Exporter section:
   - Check the Enabled box to enable the Apache exporter.
   - In the Arguments field, type any customized arguments for this exporter. For example, --telemetry.address=":9117".
3. In the Postgres Exporter section:
   - Check the Enabled box to enable the PostreSQL exporter.
   - In the Data source Name field, type the name of the data source to use.
   - In the Arguments field, type any customized arguments for this exporter. For example, --web.listen-address=":9187".
4. In the TLS section:
   - Check the Enabled box to enable the secure configuration.
   - In the CA Certificate field, type the path to the Certificate Authority certificate.
   - In the Server Certificate field, type the path to the TLS server certificate.
   - In the Server Key field, type the path to the TLS server key.
5. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

3.12.7.3.1. File-based service discovery

It is possible to define monitored targets using file-based service discovery provided in the Prometheus formula. This is a basic example demonstrating the usage:

```
[
  {
    "targets": [ "<client1>:9100", "<client2>:9100" ],
    "labels": {
      "role": "<MLM-client>",
      "job": "<MLM-refclient>"
    }
  },
```

```
  {
    "targets": [ "<server>:80" ],
    "labels": {
      "role": "<MLM-server>",
      "job": "<MLM-refhost>",
      "__metrics_path__": "/rhn/metrics"
    }
  }
]
```

For more information, see https://prometheus.io/docs/guides/file-sd/.

3.12.7.3.2. TLS certificates and keys

The formula does not generate and deploy the TLS certificates and keys. Ensure the files are present on the Salt client and readable for the user prometheus before applying the highstate. For more information about generating client and server certificates, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

3.12.7.4. Activate Forms

When you have completed and saved all the forms, apply the highstate.

For more information about using monitoring, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

3.12.8. PXE Formula

The PXE formula is used to configure PXE booting on the branch server.



The formula is used only for connecting Uyuni Proxy 4.3. with Uyuni Server 2026.10. Do not use this formula if you want to connect Uyuni Proxy 2026.10.

Procedure: Configuring PXE Booting

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. Select the Pxe formula, and click Save.
3. Navigate to the **Formulas › Pxe** tab, and set these parameters:
    - In the Kernel Filename field, keep the default value.
    - In the Initrd Filename field, keep the default value.
    - If the terminals connecting to this branch server are running arm64 architecture, check the Enable ARM64 UEFI boot box. Leave unchecked for x86-64.
    - In the Kernel Filename for ARM64 field, keep the default value.

- In the Initrd Filename for ARM64 field, keep the default value.
- In the Kernel Command Line Parameters field, keep the default value. For more information about possible values, see Saltboot Kernel Command Line Parameters.
- In the PXE root directory field, enter the path to the Saltboot directory (for example, /srv/saltboot).

4. Click Save Formula to save your configuration.
5. Apply the highstate.

3.12.8.1. Saltboot Kernel Command Line Parameters

Saltboot supports common kernel parameters and Saltboot-specific kernel parameters. All the parameters can be entered in the Kernel Command Line Parameters field of the PXE formula.

kiwidebug=1

Starts a shell on tty2 during boot and enables debug logging in Salt.



Do not use this parameter in a production environment as it creates a major security hole. This parameter should be used only in a development environment for debug purposes.

MASTER

Overrides auto-detection of the Salt master. For example:

```
MASTER=myproxy.domain.com
```

SALT_TIMEOUT

Overrides the local boot fallback timeout if the Salt master does not apply the Saltboot state within this timeout (default: 60 seconds). For example:

```
SALT_TIMEOUT=300
```

DISABLE_HOSTNAME_ID

If the terminal has a hostname assigned by DHCP, it is by default used as a minion ID. Setting this option to `1` disables this mechanism, and SMBios information will be used as a minion ID.

DISABLE_UNIQUE_SUFFIX

Setting this option to `1` disables adding random generated suffix to terminal minion ID.

If you set this parameter make sure your terminal has either a unique hostname provided by DHCP and DNS, or the terminal hardware comes with a unique serial number stored in its SMBios memory. Otherwise there is a risk of terminal minion ID duplicity, and bootstrapping the minion will fail.

The following parameters (MINION_ID_PREFIX, salt_device, root) are usually autoconfigured and should be used only in specific conditions such as debugging or development:

MINION_ID_PREFIX

Branch ID set in the Branch Network formula form.

salt_device

Device that contains the Salt configuration.

root

Device that contains the already deployed root file system. Used for falling back to local boot.

3.12.9. Saline Formula

Saline in Uyuni monitoring is configured using formulas with forms. The package is installed by default, and contains these formulas:

- Saline Prometheus
- Saline Grafana

These formulas are extending the configuration of Grafana and Prometheus created with Monitoring Formulas.



Before configuring these formulas, you must also enable Saline on the server side. For more information about enabling it, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Monitoring**.

3.12.9.1. Saline Prometheus

Procedure: Configuring the Saline Prometheus Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Saline Prometheus** tab, and set these parameters in the Saline Prometheus section:
    - Check the Enable Saline scrape configuration box to enable Saline Prometheus monitoring.
    - Check the Saline secure connection (HTTPS) to use secure connection to Saline (used by default).
2. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

3.12.9.2. Saline Grafana

Procedure: Configuring the Saline Grafana Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Saline Grafana** tab, and set these parameters in the Saline Grafana section:

2. In the Dashboards section, check the dashboards you want to use:
    - Uyuni server dashboard with Saline
    - Uyuni Saline States Job dashboard
3. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

3.12.9.3. Activate Forms

When you have completed and saved all the forms, apply the highstate.

- For more information about configuring Prometheus and Grafana with formulas, see Monitoring Formulas.
- For more information about using monitoring, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring with Prometheus and Grafana**.

3.12.10. Saltboot Formula

The Saltboot formula is used to configure disk images and partitioning for the selected hardware type.

The Saltboot formula is meant to be used as a group formula. Enable and configure Saltboot formula for hardware type groups.



To apply changes to a terminal, terminal needs to be restarted. Applying highstate does not have any effect on running terminals.

Procedure: Configuring the Hardware Type Group with Saltboot

1. Open the details page for your new hardware type group, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. Select the Saltboot formula and click **[Save]**.
3. Navigate to the **Formulas › Saltboot** tab.
4. In the Disk 1 section, set these parameters:
    - In the Disk symbolic ID field, enter a custom name for the disk (for example, disk1).
    - In the Device type field, select DISK.
    - In the Disk device field, select the device that corresponds to the device name on the target machine or asterisk *, see Disk Selection in Saltboot Formula.
    - In the RAID level field, leave it empty.
    - In the Disk Label field, select gpt.
5. In the Partition section, set these parameters for Partition 1:

- In the Partition symbolic ID field, enter a custom name for the partition (for example, p1).
- In the Partition size use value 500.
- In the Device mount point use /boot/efi.
- In the Filesystem format use vfat.
- In the OS Image to deploy field, leave it empty.
- In the Partition encryption password field, leave it empty.
- In the Partition flags use boot.

6. In the Partition section, set these parameters for Partition 2:
   - In the Partition symbolic ID field, enter a custom name for the partition (for example, p2).
   - In the Partition size field, specify a size for the partition in Mebibytes (MiB).
   - In the Device mount point field, select a location to mount the partition (for example, /data).
   - In the Filesystem format field, select your preferred format (for example, xfs).
   - In the OS Image to deploy field, leave it empty.
   - In the Partition encryption password field, enter a password if you want to encrypt the partition.
   - In the Partition flags field, leave it empty.
7. In the Partition section, set these parameters for Partition 3:
   - In the Partition symbolic ID field, enter a custom name for the partition (for example, p3).
   - In the Partition size field, specify a size for the partition in Mebibytes (MiB).
   - In the Device mount point field, leave it empty.
   - In the Filesystem format field, select swap.
   - In the OS Image to deploy field, leave it empty.
   - In the Partition encryption password field, enter a password if you want to encrypt the partition.
   - In the Partition flags field, select swap.
8. In the Partition section, set these parameters for Partition 4:
   - In the Partition symbolic ID field, enter a custom name for the partition (for example, p4).
   - In the Partition size field, leave it empty. This will ensure the partition uses up all remaining space.
   - In the Device mount point field, select /.
   - In the Filesystem format field, leave it empty.
   - In the OS Image to deploy field, enter the name of the image to deploy.
   - In the Image version field, leave it empty. This will ensure you use the latest available version.

- In the Partition encryption password field, enter a password if you want to encrypt the partition.
- In the Partition flags field, leave it empty.

9. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

3.12.10.1. Special Partition Types

The Saltboot formula helps you with setting up special partition types.



For terminal to be able to boot locally, either BIOS grub or EFI partition must be configured.

3.12.10.1.1. BIOS grub Partition

A BIOS grub partition is needed for local booting from a GPT disk on non-EFI machines. For more information, see https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BIOS_boot_partition.

In the formula, enter the following options:

```
Partition Symbolic ID: p1
Partition Size (MiB): 50
Partition Flags: bios_grub
```

Leave the other fields empty.

3.12.10.1.2. EFI Partition

An EFI partition is needed for local booting on EFI machines, Partition Table Type must be GPT. For more information, see https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/EFI_system_partition.

In the formula, enter the following options:

```
Partition Symbolic ID: p1
Partition Size (MiB): 500
Device Mount Point: /boot/efi
Filesystem Format: vfat
Partition Flags: boot
```

Leave the other fields empty.

3.12.10.2. Disk Selection in Saltboot Formula

When there is only one disk present on target hardware (including USB drives), use an asterisk * to automatically select the disk device.

When there are multiple disks, use an asterisk * in the device path. In this example, SATA disks are differentiated from USB disks:

```
/dev/disk/by-path/*-ata-1
/dev/disk/by-path/*usb*
```

If the entered value does not contain /, the entered value is automatically prepended by /dev/disk/by-path/. For example, *usb* is the same as /dev/disk/by-path/*usb*.

If you prefer to select specific devices, you can this format in the disk device field:

- symbolic names (for example: /dev/sda)
- by-path (for example: /dev/disk/by-path/..)
- by-id (for example: /dev/disk/by-id/...)

To see a list of available devices from the command prompt, press `Esc` while waiting for key approval.

3.12.10.3. Troubleshooting the Saltboot Formula

msdos Disklabel Limitations

On the msdos disk label, you can create a maximum of four primary partitions. Extended partitions are not supported. If you need more than four partitions, use the GPT disk label instead.

3.12.11. TFTPd Formula

The TFTPd formula is used to configure the TFTP service on the Uyuni for Retail branch server.



The formula is used only for connecting Uyuni Proxy 4.3. with Uyuni Server 2026.10. Do not use this formula if you want to connect Uyuni Proxy 2026.10.

Procedure: Configuring TFTP

1. In the SUSE Multi-Linux Manager Web UI, open the details page for the branch server, and navigate to the Formulas tab.
2. Select the Tftpd formula, and click **[Save]**.
3. Navigate to the **Formulas › Tftpd** tab, and set these parameters:
    - In the Internal Network Address field, enter the IP address of the branch server (for example: 192.168.1.5).
    - In the TFTP Base Directory field, enter the path to the Saltboot directory (for example, /srv/saltboot).
    - In the Run TFTP Under User field, enter saltboot.

4. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.
5. Apply the highstate.

3.12.12. Virtualization Guest Formula

The Virtualization Guest formula is used to configure settings for virtual machine.

Open the Tuning pull-down checklist and select from the following virtual machine performance tuning settings:

- Disable IRQ balancing.
- Disable Kernel Samepage Merging (KSM). Reduces performance overhead by not sharing memory across virtual machines.
- Optimizations for KVM passed through host CPU. Requires the KVM hint-dedicated option to be set on the VM definition.

When configured, click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration, and apply the highstate.

3.12.13. Virtualization Host Formula

The Virtualization Host formula is used to configure settings for a virtualization host.

Hypervisor

Select KVM or Xen as the hypervisor.

Create default storage pool

Create default virtual network

- Default pool: Open the pull-down list and enter the directory name of the default storage pool.
- Default net: Open the pull-down list and configure the default virtual network by setting the Mode (NAT or Bridge) and the Bridge name.

Tuning

Enable IOMMU support (x86_64).

When configured, click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration, and apply the highstate.

3.12.14. Yomi Formula

The Yomi (yet one more installer) installer for SUSE and openSUSE operating systems is configured using formulas with forms.

The yomi-formula package provides these formulas:

- Yomi
- Yomi Storage
- Yomi Bootloader
- Yomi Software
- Yomi Services
- Yomi Users

Procedure: Install the Yomi Formulas with Forms

1. On the Uyuni Server, at the command prompt, as root, install the yomi-formula package:

```
zypper in yomi-formula
```

2. Restart services:

```
systemctl restart salt-master.service
```

When the formula package is installed, you need to install the PXE Yomi image on the client, boot the client you want to provision, and enable the Yomi formulas on the client. For more information on preparing Yomi clients for provisioning, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Yomi**.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi** tab, and set these parameters in the General Configuration section:
    - Check the Events box to allow monitoring.
    - In the Reboot field, select yes to instruct the client to reboot after installation.
    - Check the Snapper box if you are using the btrfs file system on the client.
    - In the Locale field, select the region and encoding for systemd to use on the client. For example: en_US.utf8 for US English and UTF-8.
    - In the Keymap field, select the appropriate keyboard layout. For example: us for a US keyboard layout.
    - In the Timezone field, select the timezone for the client to use. For example: America/New_York for EST.
    - In the Hostname field, enter the hostname for the client to use. Leave this blank if you are using DHCP to provide the hostname.

- In the Machine Id field, enter a machine identification number for the client. Leave this blank to have systemd generate one automatically.
- In the Target field, enter a systemd target unit.

2. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Storage Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi Storage** tab, and set these parameters in the **Partitions › Config** section:
   - In the Labels field, select the default partition table type to use.
   - In the Initial Gap field, select the default amount of space to leave before the first partition. For example: `1 MB`, or use `0` to leave no space between partitions.
2. For each device that you want to configure, in the **Partitions › Devices** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Device field, type the mount point for the device. For example, /dev/sda.
   - In the Label field, select the partition table type to use, if it is different from the default label you selected.
   - In the Initial Gap field, select the amount of space to leave before the first partition, if it is different from the default space you specified.
3. For each partition that you want to create, in the **Partitions › Devices › Partitions** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Partition Number field, enter a number for the partition. The number you enter here is appended to the device name to identify the partition. For example, partition number `1` on device /dev/sda can be identified as /dev/sda`1`.
   - In the Partition Name field, enter a name for the partition. Leave this blank if you have entered a partition number in the previous field.
   - In the Partition Size field, enter a size for the partition. For example: 500 MB. Use rest to use all the remaining free space.
4. For each file system that you want to create, in the Filesystems section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Partition field, select the partition to create the file system on. For example, /dev/sda`1`.
   - In the Filesystem field, select the file system type to create.
   - In the Mountpoint field, type the mount point for the file system. For example: / for root.
5. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.



If you want to use LVM or RAID on your devices, click **[+]** in the appropriate sections, and

complete the details for your environment.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Bootloader Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi Bootloader** tab, and set these parameters in the Bootloader section:
    - In the Device field, type the path for the bootloader. For example, /dev/sda.
    - In the Timeout field, select the number of seconds grub will wait before booting the default menu entry.
    - In the Kernel field, type any additional kernel parameters you want to use. Any kernel parameters you add here will be appended to the GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT line during boot.
    - In the Terminal field, type the terminal to use for both terminal input and output.
    - In the Serial Command field, type parameters for using the serial port. Use this only if you are using the serial console as the default terminal.
    - In the Gfxmode field, type the resolution to use for the graphical terminal. Use this only if you are using the graphical console as the default terminal.
    - Check the Theme box to use GRUB2 default branding package.
    - Check the Disable OS Prober box to disable using the OS prober to discover other installed operating systems.
2. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Software Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi Software** tab, and set these parameters in the **Software › Configuration** section:
    - Check the Minimal box to use a minimal installation, which only installs packages listed as Required.
2. For each repository that you want to add, in the **Software › Repositories** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
    - In the Repository Name field, type a name for the repository.
    - In the Repository URL field, type the location of the repository.
3. To add packages from each repository, in the **Software › Packages** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
    - In the **Software › Packages** field, type the names of the packages to install, or type a pattern to search for the appropriate packages. For example, pattern:enhanced_base glibc-locale, or kernel-default.
4. In the **Software › Image** section, set these parameters:

- In the Image URL field, type the location of the operating system ISO image to use.
- In the Md5 field, type the MD5 hash to use to verify the ISO.

5. In the **SUSEConect › Config** section, set these parameters:
   - In the Registration Code field, type the registration code for the client you are installing. You can obtain this code from SUSE Customer Center.
   - In the Email field, type the administrator email address to use.
   - In the Url field, type the address of the registration server to use. For example, use https://scc.suse.com, to register with SUSE Customer Center.
   - In the Version field, type the version of the product you are registering.
6. For each product that you want to register, in the **SUSEConnect › Products** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Product field, type each product you want to register. For example, <product_name>/1.1/x86, for version 1.1 with x86 architecture.
   - In the **SUSEConnect › Packages** field, type the names of the packages to install, or type a pattern to search for the appropriate packages. For example, pattern:enhanced_base glibc-locale, or kernel-default.
7. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Services Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi Services** tab, and set these parameters:
   - Check the Install salt-minion box to install and configure the client as a Salt client.
2. For each service you want to enable, in the **Services › Enabled** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Service field, type the name of the service to enable. For example, salt-minion.
3. For each service you want to disable, in the **Services › Disabled** section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Service field, type the name of the service to disable.
4. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

Procedure: Configuring the Yomi Users Formula

1. Navigate to the **Formulas › Yomi Users** tab.
2. For each user you want to create, in the Users section, click **[+]**, and set these parameters:
   - In the Username field, type the name of the new user.

- In the Password Hash field, type the hashed version of the password to use.

3. To add a certificate for each user, in the **Users › Certificates** section, click **[+]**, and add the certificate to the Certificate field.
4. Click **[Save Formula]** to save your configuration.

When you have completed and saved all the forms, apply the highstate.

For more information about using Yomi, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Yomi**.

3.12.15. Custom Salt Formulas

This section contains information about writing custom formulas, including formulas with forms. You can write your own custom formulas, and make them available to client systems in the Uyuni Web UI.

For information about the formulas provided by Uyuni, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Formulas by Product**.

3.12.15.1. File Structure Overview

RPM-based formulas must be placed in a specific directory structure to ensure that they work correctly. A formula contains two separate directories: states, and metadata. Folders in these directories need to have exactly matching names.

The formula states directory contains anything necessary for a Salt state to work independently. This includes .sls files, a map.jinja file and any other required files. This directory should only be modified by RPMs and should not be edited manually. For example, the locale-formula states directory is located in:

```
/usr/share/susemanager/formulas/states/locale/
```

To create formulas with forms, the metadata directory contains a form.yml file. The form.yml file defines the forms for Uyuni. The metadata directory also contains an optional metadata.yml file with additional information about the formula. For example, the locale-formula metadata directory is located in:

```
/usr/share/susemanager/formulas/metadata/locale/
```

If you have a custom formula that is not in an RPM, it must be in a state directory configured as a Salt file root. Custom state formula data must be in:

```
/srv/salt/<custom-formula-name>/
```

Custom metadata information must be in:

```
/srv/formula_metadata/<custom-formula-name>/
```

All custom folders must contain a form.yml file. These files are detected as form recipes and are applied to groups and systems from the Web UI:

```
/srv/formula_metadata/<custom-formula-name>/form.yml
```



The Salt formula directory changed in Uyuni 4.0. The old directory location, /usr/share/susemanager/formulas, will continue to work for some time. You should ensure that you update to the new directory location, /usr/share/salt-formulas/ as soon as possible.

3.12.15.2. Define Formula with Forms Data

Uyuni requires a file called form.yml, to describe how formula data should look within the Web UI. The form.yml file is used by Uyuni to generate the desired formula with forms, with values editable by a user.

The file contains a list of editable attributes that start with a $ sign. These attributes are used to determine how to display the formula in the Uyuni Web UI.

For example, the form.yml that is included with the locale-formula is in:

```
/usr/share/susemanager/formulas/metadata/locale/form.yml
```

Part of that file looks like this:

```
timezone:
  $type: group

  name:
    $type: select
    $values: ["CET",
              "Etc/Zulu"
              ]
    $default: CET

  hardware_clock_set_to_utc:
    $type: boolean
    $default: True
...
```

All values that start with a $ sign are annotations used to display the UI that users interact with. These annotations are not part of pillar data itself and are handled as metadata.

This section lists the available attributes:

$type

The most important attribute is the $type attribute. It defines the type of the pillar value and the form-field that is generated. The supported types are:

- text
- password
- number
- url
- email
- date
- time
- datetime
- boolean
- color
- select
- group
- edit-group
- namespace
- hidden-group (obsolete, renamed to namespace)



The text attribute is the default and does not need to be specified explicitly.

Many of these values are self-explanatory:

- The text type generates a simple text field
- The password type generates a password field
- The color type generates a color picker

The group, edit-group, and namespace (formerly hidden-group) types do not generate an editable field and are used to structure form and pillar data. All these types support nesting.

The group and namespace types differ slightly. The group type generates a visible border with a heading. The namespace type shows nothing visually, and is only used to structure pillar data.

The edit-group type allows you to structure and restrict editable fields in a more flexible way. The edit-group type is a collection of items of the same kind. Collections can have these four shapes:

- List of primitive items
- List of dictionaries
- Dictionary of primitive items
- Dictionary of dictionaries

The size of each collection is variable. Users can add or remove elements.

For example, edit-group supports the $minItems and $maxItems attributes, which simplifies complex and repeatable input structures. These, and also itemName, are optional.

$default

Allows you to specify a default value to be displayed. This default value will be used if no other value is entered. In an edit-group it allows you to create initial members of the group and populate them with specified data.

$optional

This type is a Boolean attribute. If it is true and the field is empty in the form, then this field will not be generated in the formula data and the generated dictionary will not contain the field name key. If it is false and the field is empty, the formula data will contain a <field name>: null entry.

$ifEmpty

This type is used if the field is empty. This usually occurs because the user did not provide a value. The ifEmpty type can only be used when $optional is false or not defined. If $optional is true, then $ifEmpty is ignored. In this example, the DP2 string would be used if the user leaves the field empty:

```
displayName:
  $type: string
  $ifEmpty: DP2
```

$name

Allows you to specify the name of a value that is shown in the form. If this value is not set, the pillar name is used and capitalized without underscores and dashes. Reference it in the same section with ${name}.

$help and $placeholder

These attributes are used to give a user a better understanding of what the value should be. The $help type defines the message a user sees when hovering over a field The $placeholder type displays a gray placeholder text in the field

Use $placeholder only with text fields like text, password, email or date fields. Do not add a placeholder if you also use $default, as it will hide the placeholder.

$key

Applicable only if the edit-group has the shape of a dictionary. When the pillar data is a dictionary, the $key attribute determines the key of an entry in the dictionary.

For example:

```
user_passwords:
  $type: edit-group
  $minItems: 1
  $prototype:
    $key:
        $type: text
    $type: text
  $default:
    alice: secret-password
    bob: you-shall-not-pass
```

Pillar:

```
user_passwords:
  alice:
    secret-password
  bob:
    you-shall-not-pass
```

$minItems and $maxItems

In an edit-group, $minItems and $maxItems specifies the lowest and highest numbers for the group.

$itemName

In an edit-group, $itemName defines a template for the name to be used for the members of the group.

$prototype

In an edit-group, $prototype is mandatory and defines the default pre-filled values for newly added members in the group.

$scope

Specifies a hierarchy level at which a value may be edited. Possible values are system, group, and readonly.

The default value is $scope: system, allows values to be edited at group and system levels. A value can be entered for each system but if no value is entered the system will fall back to the group default.

The $scope: group option makes a value editable only for a group. On the system level you will be able to see the value, but not edit it.

The $scope: readonly option makes a field read-only. It can be used to show data to the user, but will not allow them to edit it. This option should be used in combination with the $default attribute.

$visibleIf

Deprecated in favor of $visible.

Allows you to show a field or group if a simple condition is met. An example condition is:

```
some_group#another_group#my_checkbox == true
```

The left part of the condition is the path to another value, and groups are separated by # signs. The middle section of the condition should be either == for a value to be equal or != for values that should be not equal. The last field in the statement can be any value which a field should have or not have.

The field with this attribute associated with it will be shown only when the condition is met. In this example the field will be shown only if my_checkbox is checked. The ability to use conditional statements is not limited to check boxes. It may also be used to check values of select-fields, text-fields, and similar.

A check box should be structured like this:

```
some_group:
  $type: group

  another_group:
    $type: group

      my_checkbox:
        $type: boolean
```

Relative paths can be specified using prefix dots. One dot indicates a sibling, two dots indicate a parent, and so on. This is mostly useful for edit-group.

```
some_group:
  $type: group

  another_group:
    $type: group

    my_checkbox:
      $type: boolean

    my_text:
      $visibleIf: .my_checkbox == true

  yet_another_group:
    $type: group

    my_text2:
      $visibleIf: ..another_group#my_checkbox == true
```

If you use multiple groups with the attribute, you can allow a users to select an option and show a completely different form, dependent upon the selected value.

Values from hidden fields can be merged into the pillar data and sent to the client. A formula must check the condition again and use the appropriate data. For example:

```
show_option:
  $type: checkbox
some_text:
  $visibleIf: .show_option == true
```

```
{% if pillar.show_option %}
do_something:
  with: {{ pillar.some_text }}
{% endif %}
```

$values

Can only be used together with $type Use to specify the different options in the select-field. $values must be a list of possible values to select. For example:

```
select_something:
  $type: select
  $values: ["option1", "option2"]
```

Or:

```
select_something:
  $type: select
  $values:
    - option1
    - option2
```

$visible

Allows you to show a field or group if a condition is met. You must use the jexl expression language to write the condition.

Example structure:

```
some_group:
  $type: group

  another_group:
    $type: group

      my_checkbox:
        $type: boolean
```

An example condition is:

```
formValues.some_group.another_group.my_checkbox == true
```

The field with this attribute will only show if the condition is met. In this example, the field will show only if my_checkbox is checked. You can also choose other elements for the conditional statement, such as select fields or text fields.

If you use multiple groups with the attribute, users can select an option that will show a completely different form, depending on the selected value.

Values from hidden fields can be merged into the pillar data and sent to the client. A formula must check the condition again and use the appropriate data. For example:

```
show_option:
  $type: checkbox
some_text:
  $visible: this.parent.value.show_option == true
```

```
{% if pillar.show_option %}
do_something:
  with: {{ pillar.some_text }}
{% endif %}
```

$disabled

Allows you to disable a field or group if a condition is met. You must use the jexl expression language to write the condition.

If specified at group level it will disable all fields in that group.

$required

Fields with this attribute are mandatory. Supports using the jexl expresion language.

$match

Allows using a regular expression to validate the content of a text field.

It supports the regular expression features existing in JavaScript.

Example:

```
      hardware:
        $type: text
        $name: Hardware Type and Address
        $placeholder: Enter hardware-type hardware-address (for example, "ethernet
AA:BB:CC:DD:EE:FF")
        $help: Hardware Identifier - prefix is mandatory
        $match: "\\w+ [A-Z]{2}:[A-Z]{2}:[A-Z]{2}:[A-Z]{2}:[A-Z]{2}:[A-Z]{2}"
```

3.12.15.2.1. Expression language

You must use the jexl expression language to write conditions.

Given a structure like this:

```
some_group:
  $type: group

  another_group:
    $type: group

      my_checkbox:
        $type: boolean
```

An example condition is:

```
formValues.some_group.another_group.my_checkbox == true
```

Absolute paths must begin with formValues.

Specify relative paths using this.parent.value to define the value of the parent.

You can also refer to the parent of the parent, with this.parent.parent.value. This is mostly useful for edit-group elements.

Example for relative paths:

```
some_group:
  $type: group

  another_group:
    $type: group

    my_checkbox:
      $type: boolean

    my_text:
      $visible: this.parent.value.my_checkbox

  yet_another_group:
    $type: group

    my_text2:
      $visible: this.parent.parent.value.another_group.my_checkbox
```

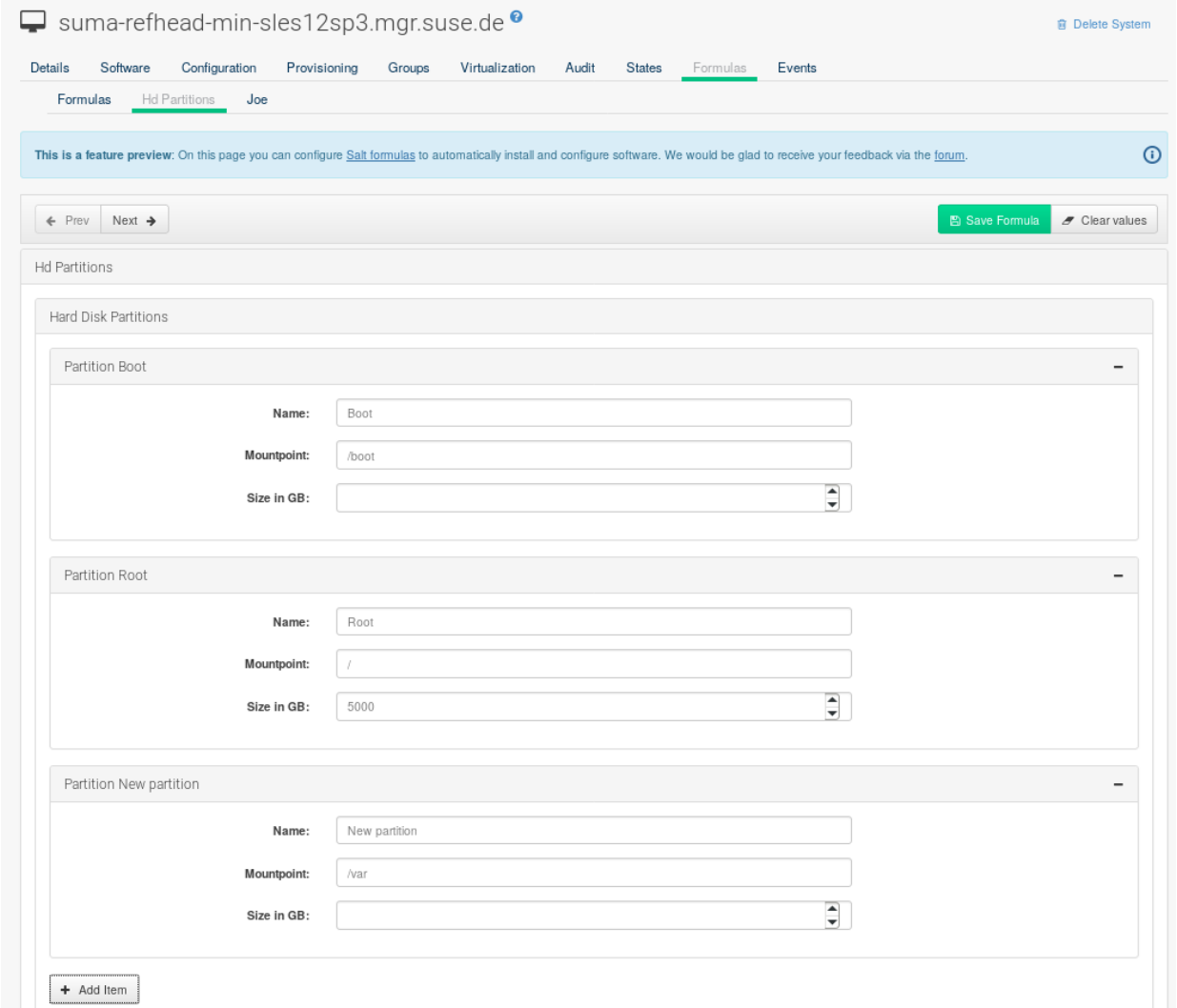
Listing 6. Example: Basic edit-group

```
partitions:
  $name: "Hard Disk Partitions"
  $type: "edit-group"
  $minItems: 1
```

```
$maxItems: 4
$itemName: "Partition ${name}"
$prototype:
  name:
    $default: "New partition"
  mountpoint:
    $default: "/var"
  size:
    $type: "number"
    $name: "Size in GB"
$default:
  - name: "Boot"
    mountpoint: "/boot"
  - name: "Root"
    mountpoint: "/"
    size: 5000
```

Click **[Add]** to fill the form with the default values.

The formula is called hd-partitions and will appear as Hd Partitions in the Web UI.



To remove the definition of a partition click the minus symbol in the title line of an inner group.

When you are finished, click **[Save Formula]**.

Listing 7. Example: Nested edit-group

```
users:
  $name: "Users"
  $type: edit-group
  $minItems: 2
  $maxItems: 5
  $prototype:
    name:
      $default: "username"
    password:
      $type: password
    groups:
      $type: edit-group
      $minItems: 1
      $prototype:
        group_name:
          $type: text
  $default:
    - name: "root"
      groups:
        - group_name: "users"
        - group_name: "admins"
    - name: "admin"
      groups:
        - group_name: "users"
```

3.12.15.3. Writing Salt Formulas

Salt formulas are pre-written Salt states. You can use Jinja to configure formulas with pillar data.

Basic Jinja syntax is:

```
pillar.some.value
```

When you are sure a pillar exists, use this syntax:

```
salt['pillar.get']('some:value', 'default value')
```

You can also replace the pillar value with grains. For example, grains.some.value.

Using data this way makes the formula configurable. In this example, a specified package is installed in the package_name pillar:

```
install_a_package:
  pkg.installed:
    - name: {{ pillar.package_name }}
```

You can also use more complex constructs such as if/else and for-loops to provide greater functionality:

```
{% if pillar.installSomething %}
something:
  pkg.installed
{% else %}
anotherPackage:
  pkg.installed
{% endif %}
```

Another example:

```
{% for service in pillar.services %}
start_{{ service }}:
  service.running:
    - name: {{ service }}
{% endfor %}
```

Jinja also provides other helpful functions. For example, you can iterate over a dictionary:

```
{% for key, value in some_dictionary.items() %}
do_something_with_{{ key }}: {{ value }}
{% endfor %}
```

You can have Salt manage your files (for example, configuration files for a program), and change them with pillar data.

In this example, Salt copies the file salt-file_roots/my_state/files/my_program.conf on the server to /etc/my_program/my_program.conf on the client and template it with Jinja:

```
/etc/my_program/my_program.conf:
  file.managed:
    - source: salt://my_state/files/my_program.conf
    - template: jinja
```

This example allows you to use Jinja in the file, like the previous example for states:

```
some_config_option = {{ pillar.config_option_a }}
```

3.12.15.4. Separate Data

Separating data from a state can increase flexibility and make it easier to re-use. You can do this by writing values into a separate file named map.jinja. This file must be within the same directory as the state files.

This example sets data to a dictionary with different values, depending on which system the state runs on. It will also merge data with the pillar using the some.pillar.data value so you can access some.pillar.data.value by using data.value.

You can choose to override defined values from pillars. For example, by overriding some.pillar.data.package in

this example:

```
{% set data = salt['grains.filter_by']({
    'Suse': {
        'package': 'packageA',
        'service': 'serviceA'
    },
    'RedHat': {
        'package': 'package_a',
        'service': 'service_a'
    }
}, merge=salt['pillar.get']('some:pillar:data')) %}
```

When you have created a map file, you can maintain compatibility with multiple system types while accessing deep pillar data in a simpler way.

Now you can import and use data in any file. For example:

```
{% from "some_folder/map.jinja" import data with context %}

install_package_a:
  pkg.installed:
    - name: {{ data.package }}
```

You can define multiple variables by copying the {% set ...%} statement with different values and then merge it with other pillars. For example:

```
{% set server = salt['grains.filter_by']({
    'Suse': {
        'package': 'my-server-pkg'
    }
}, merge=salt['pillar.get']('myFormula:server')) %}
{% set client = salt['grains.filter_by']({
    'Suse': {
        'package': 'my-client-pkg'
    }
}, merge=salt['pillar.get']('myFormula:client')) %}
```

To import multiple variables, separate them with a comma. For example:

```
{% from "map.jinja" import server, client with context %}
```

For more information about conventions to use when writing formulas, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/development/conventions/formulas.html.

3.12.15.5. Generated Pillar Data

Pillar data is generated by Uyuni when events occur like generating the highstate. You can use an external pillar script to generate pillar data for packages and group IDs, and include all pillar data for a system:

```
/usr/share/susemanager/modules/pillar/MLM_minion.py
```

The process is executed like this:

1. The MLM_minion.py script starts and finds all formulas for a system by checking the group_formulas.json and server_formulas.json files.
2. The script loads the values for each formula (groups and from the system) and merges them with the highstate. By default, if no values are found, a group overrides a system if $scope: group.
3. The script also includes a list of formulas applied to the system in a pillar named formulas.

This structure makes it possible to include states. In this example, the top file is specifically generated by the mgr_master_tops.py script. The top file includes a state called formulas for each system. This includes the formulas.sls file located in /usr/share/susemanager/formulas/states or /usr/share/salt-formulas/states/. The content looks similar to this:

```
include: {{ pillar["formulas"] }}
```

This pillar includes all formulas that are specified in the pillar data generated from the external pillar script.

Formulas should be created directly after Uyuni is installed. If you encounter any problems with formulas check these things first:

- The external pillar script (MLM_minion.py) must include formula data.
- Data is saved to /srv/susemanager/formula_data and the pillar and group_pillar sub-directories. These directories should be automatically generated by the server.
- Formulas must be included for every client listed in the top file. Currently this process is initiated by the mgr_master_tops.py script which includes the formulas.sls file located in /usr/share/susemanager/formulas/states/ or /usr/share/salt-formulas/states/. This directory must be a salt file root. File roots are configured on the salt-master (Uyuni) located at /etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf.

3.13. Salt SSH

Salt SSH allows Salt commands and states to be issued directly over SSH. SSH connections are created on demand, when the server executes an action on a client.

For more information about Salt SSH, see https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/ssh/.

3.13.1. SSH Connection Methods

In Uyuni there are two SSH connection methods, ssh-push and ssh-push-tunnel. In both methods the server

initiates an SSH connection to the client to execute a Salt call.

In the ssh-push method, the package manager works as normal, and the HTTP or HTTPS connection is directly created.

In the ssh-push-tunnel method, the server creates an HTTP or HTTPS connection through an SSH tunnel. The HTTP connection initiated by the package manager is redirected through the tunnel using /etc/hosts aliasing. Use this method for in-place firewall environments that block HTTP or HTTPS connections between server and client.

3.13.2. Salt SSH Integration

As with all Salt calls, Uyuni invokes salt-ssh via the salt-api.

Salt SSH relies on a roster to obtain details such as hostname, ports, and the SSH parameters of a client. Uyuni keeps these details in the database and makes them available to Salt SSH by using the uyuni roster module, or by generating a temporary roster file on bootstrapping new clients with the Web UI. The location of the temporary roster file is supplied to Salt SSH using the roster-file option. For the registered clients roster set to uyuni is used instead to get the roster from the database with uyuni salt roster module.



It is not recommended to run salt-ssh as root user. This can cause permission issues the next time Uyuni tries to use Salt SSH. Use mgr-salt-ssh, which changes the effective user to salt and avoids file permission issues. If you want to use mgr-salt-ssh with a user other than root, the user should have the permission to change effective user to salt.

mgr-salt-ssh uses roster set to uyuni by default, if neither roster nor roster-file specified in the command line. It helps to call Salt commands to the registered Salt SSH clients with no roster file generation.

3.13.3. Authentication

Salt SSH supports both password and key authentication. Uyuni uses both methods:

Password authentication is used only when bootstrapping. During the bootstrap step the key of the server is not authorized on the client and therefore a password must be used for a connection to be made. The password is used transiently in a temporary roster file used for bootstrapping and the roster file is removed on finishing processing the event. This password is not stored.

All other common Salt calls use key authentication. During the bootstrap step the SSH key of the server is authorized on the client and added to the client /.ssh/authorized_keys file. Subsequent calls no longer require a password.

3.13.4. User Account

The user for Salt SSH calls made by Uyuni is taken from the ssh_push_sudo_user setting. By default, the user is root.



If bootstrapping with default settings fail, check whether the client allows root login with ssh.

If the value of ssh_push_sudo_user is not root, then the --sudo options of salt-ssh are used. For this user you must configure the NOPASSWD option in the sudoers file. At least, set the python binary with the version number; for example:

```
<USER> ALL=(ALL) NOPASSWD:/usr/bin/python3.6
```

3.13.5. HTTP Redirection

The ssh-push-tunnel method requires traffic to be redirected through an SSH tunnel. This allows traffic to bypass firewalls blocking a direct connection between the client and the server.

This is achieved by using port 1233 in the repository URL:

```
https://MLM-server:1233/repourl...
```

You can alias the MLM-server hostname to localhost in /etc/hosts:

```
127.0.0.1       localhost    MLM-server
```

The server creates a reverse SSH tunnel that connects localhost:1233 on the client to MLM-server:443:

```
ssh ... -R 1233:MLM-server:443
```

This means that the package manager will actually connect to localhost:1233, which is then forwarded to MLM-server:443 by the SSH tunnel.

The package manager can contact the server only if the tunnel is open, which occurs only when the server executes an action on the client.

Manual package manager operations that require server connectivity are not possible in this case.

3.13.6. Call Sequence

Salt SSH calls run in this sequence:

1. Set roster parameter to uyuni for registered clients or prepare the Salt roster on bootstrapping for the call
    a. Create remote port forwarding option if the contact method is ssh-push-tunnel
    b. Compute the ProxyCommand if the client is connected through a proxy
    c. Create Roster content
2. Create a temporary roster file (only in case of bootstrapping new client)
3. Execute a synchronous salt-ssh call using the API
4. Remove the temporary roster file (only in case of bootstrapping new client)

The roster content contains:

- hostname
- user
- port
- remote_port_forwards: The remote port forwarding SSH option
- ssh_options: Other ssh options:
    - ProxyCommand: If the client connects through a proxy
- timeout: defaults to 180 seconds
- minion_opts:
    - master: Set to the minion ID if the contact method is ssh-push-tunnel
- ssh_pre_flight: The path to the shell script executed on the client before running any Salt command
- ssh_pre_flight_args: The list of arguments to call the pre flight script on the client

3.13.7. Bootstrap Sequence

This section describes the sequence of events when clients are registered to a Salt master. While bootstrapping is a type of Salt SSH call, the sequence differs slightly from regular SSH calls.

Bootstrapping uses Salt SSH for communication between the master and the client. This happens for both regular and SSH clients.

1. For a regular Salt client, generate and pre-authorize the Salt key of the client.
2. For an SSH client, if a proxy was selected, retrieve the SSH public key of the proxy using the mgrutil.chain_ssh_cmd runner. The runner copies the public key of the proxy to the server using SSH. If needed, it can chain multiple SSH commands to reach the proxy across multiple hops.
3. Generate pillar data for bootstrap. The pillar data is compiled and stored on the Salt master, and retrieved

by the client.

4. Generate the roster for bootstrapping into a temporary file on the client. You can use the roster by passing it to the Salt API, with this command:

```
mgr-salt-ssh --roster-file=<temporary_bootstrap_roster> minion state.apply
certs,<bootstrap_state>
```

For bootstrap_state, use bootstrap for regular clients or ssh_bootstrap for SSH clients.

The way the client retrieves the pillar data depends on the contact method you have chosen for your client:

- If you are using the ssh-push-tunnel contact method, ensure you have completed the remote port forwarding option.
- If the client connects through a proxy, ensure you have completed the ProxyCommand option. This depends on your proxy configuration, including how many proxies you need to connect through.

Pillar data contains:

- mgr_server: The hostname of the Salt master
- mgr_origin_server: The hostname of the Uyuni Server
- minion_id: The hostname of the client to bootstrap
- contact_method: The connection type
- mgr_sudo_user: The user for salt-ssh
- activation_key: If selected
- minion_pub: The pre-authorized public client key
- minion_pem: The pre-authorized private client key
- proxy_pub_key: The public SSH key that was retrieved from the proxy if the target is an SSH client and a proxy was selected

The roster content contains:

- hostname
- user
- password
- port
- remote_port_forwards: the remote port forwarding SSH option
- ssh_options: other SSH options:

- ProxyCommand if the client connects through a proxy

- timeout: defaults to 180 seconds
- ssh_pre_flight: The path to the pre flight shell script (default: /usr/share/susemanager/salt-ssh/preflight.sh)
- ssh_pre_flight_args: The list of arguments to call the pre flight script on the client

This image provides an overview of the Salt SSH bootstrap process.

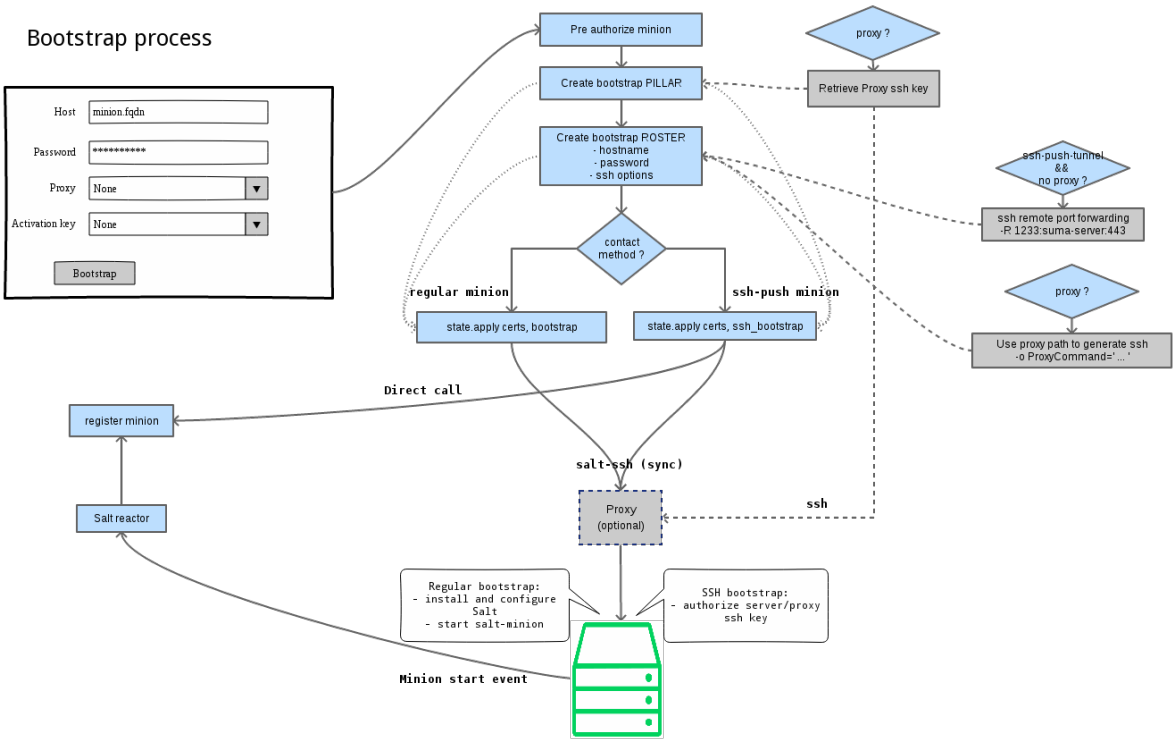
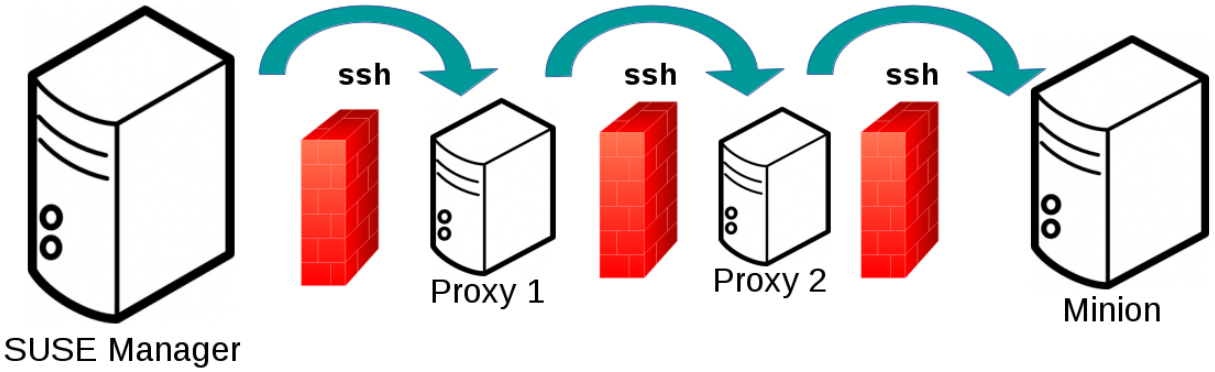


Figure 1. Salt SSH Bootstrap Process

3.13.8. Proxy Support

Salt SSH works with Uyuni Proxy by chaining the SSH connection from one server or proxy to the next. This is also known as a multi-hop or multi-gateway SSH connection.

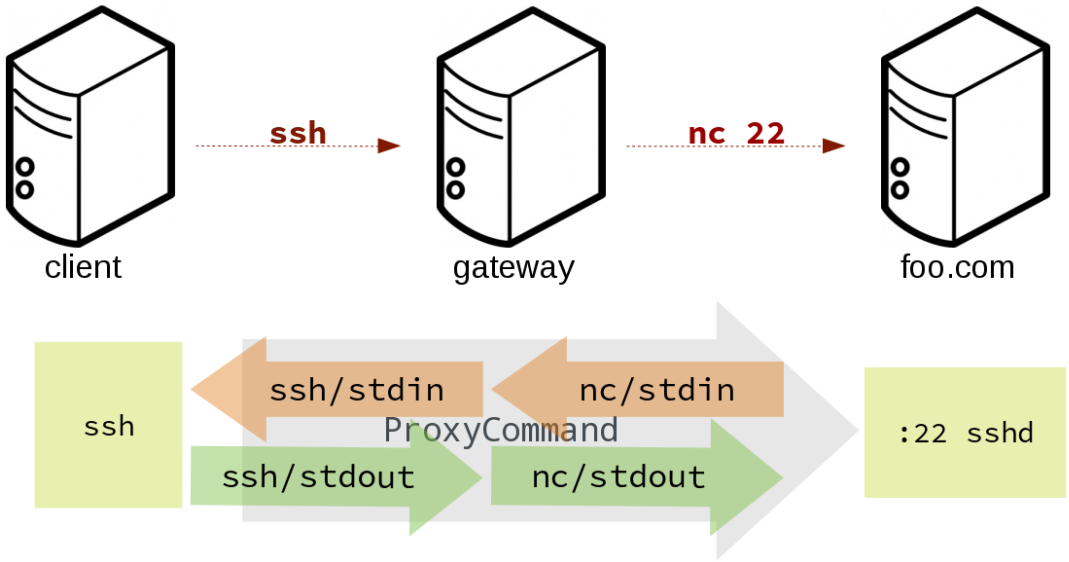


Uyuni uses ProxyCommand to redirect SSH connections through proxies. This options invokes an arbitrary command that is expected to connect to the SSH port on the target host. The SSH process uses standard input and output of the command to communicate with the remote SSH daemon.

ProxyCommand replaces a TCP/IP connection. It does not perform any authorization or encryption. Its role is simply to create a byte stream to the remote SSH daemon port.

This image depicts a client connecting to a server that is behind a gateway. In this example netcat is used to pipe port 22 of the target host into the SSH standard input/output:

```
ssh -o ProxyCommand=<stdio/stdout to remote port> ...
ssh -o ProxyCommand='ssh gateway nc foo.com 22' root@foo.com
```



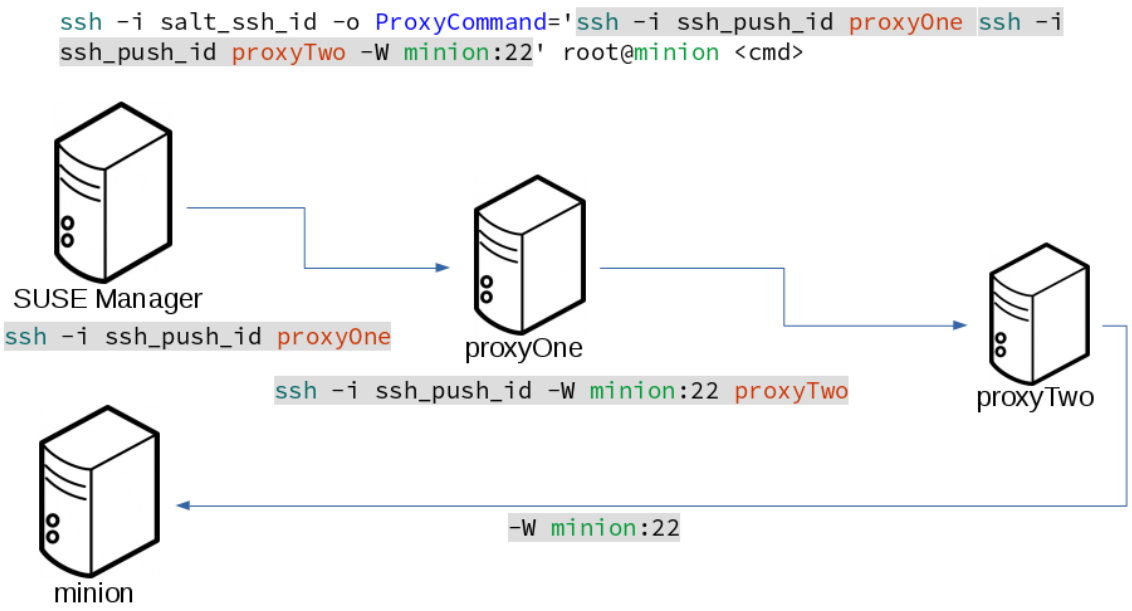
The Salt SSH calls run in this sequence when a proxy is in use:

1. Uyuni initiates the SSH connection.
2. ProxyCommand uses SSH to create a connection from the server to the client through the proxies.

This example uses ProxyCommand with two proxies and the ssh-push method:

```
# Connect the server to the first proxy:
/usr/bin/ssh -i /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/mgr_ssh_id -o StrictHostKeyChecking=no -o
User=mgrsshtunnel  proxy1

# Connect the first proxy to the second, and forward standard input/output on the client
to client:22 using the `-W` option:
/usr/bin/ssh -i /var/lib/spacewalk/mgrsshtunnel/.ssh/id_susemanager_ssh_push -o
StrictHostKeyChecking=no -o User=mgrsshtunnel -W client:22  proxy2
```



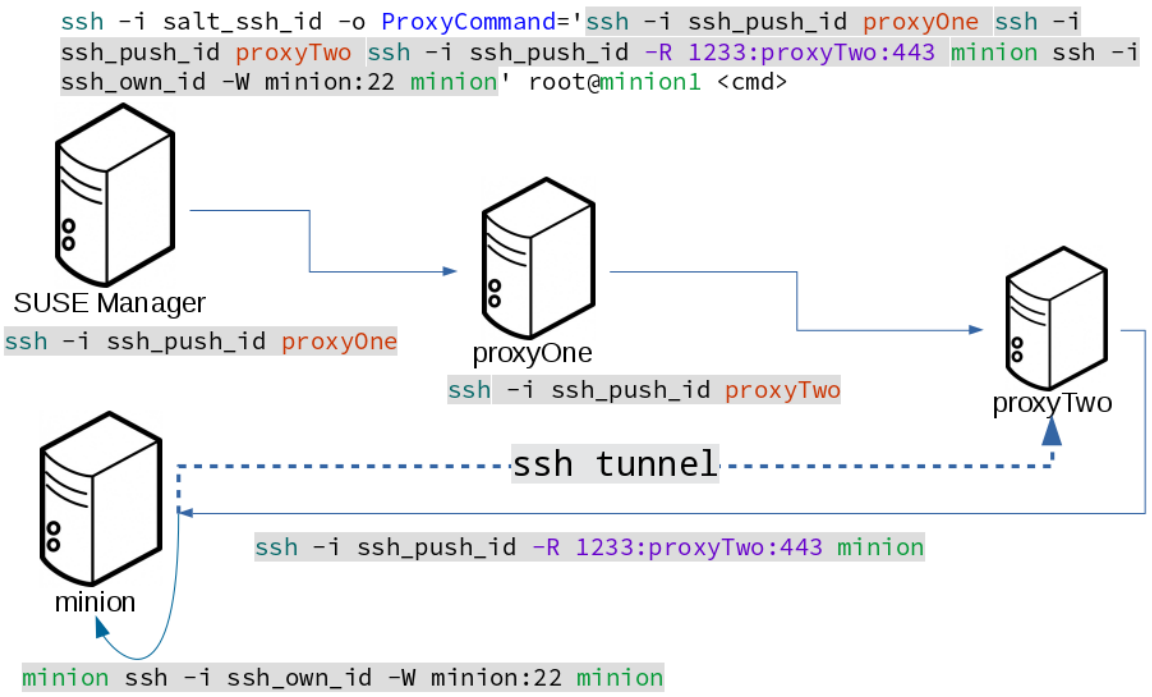
This example uses ProxyCommand with two proxies and the ssh-push-tunnel method:

```
# Connect the server to the first proxy:
/usr/bin/ssh -i /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/mgr_ssh_id -o User=mgrsshtunnel  proxy1

# Connect the first proxy to the second:
/usr/bin/ssh -i /home/mgrsshtunnel/.ssh/id_susemanager_ssh_push -o User=mgrsshtunnel
proxy2

# Connect the second proxy to the client and open an reverse tunnel (-R 1233:proxy2:443)
from the client to the HTTPS port on the second proxy:
/usr/bin/ssh -i /home/mgrsshtunnel/.ssh/id_susemanager_ssh_push -o User=root -R
1233:proxy2:443 client

# Connect the client to itself and forward the standard input/output of the server to the
SSH port of the client (-W client:22).
This is equivalent to `ssh ... proxy2 netcat client 22` and is needed because SSH does not
allow both the reverse tunnel (-R 1233:proxy2:443) and the standard input/output forward
(-W client:22) in the same command.
/usr/bin/ssh -i /root/.ssh/mgr_own_id -W client:22 -o User=root client
```

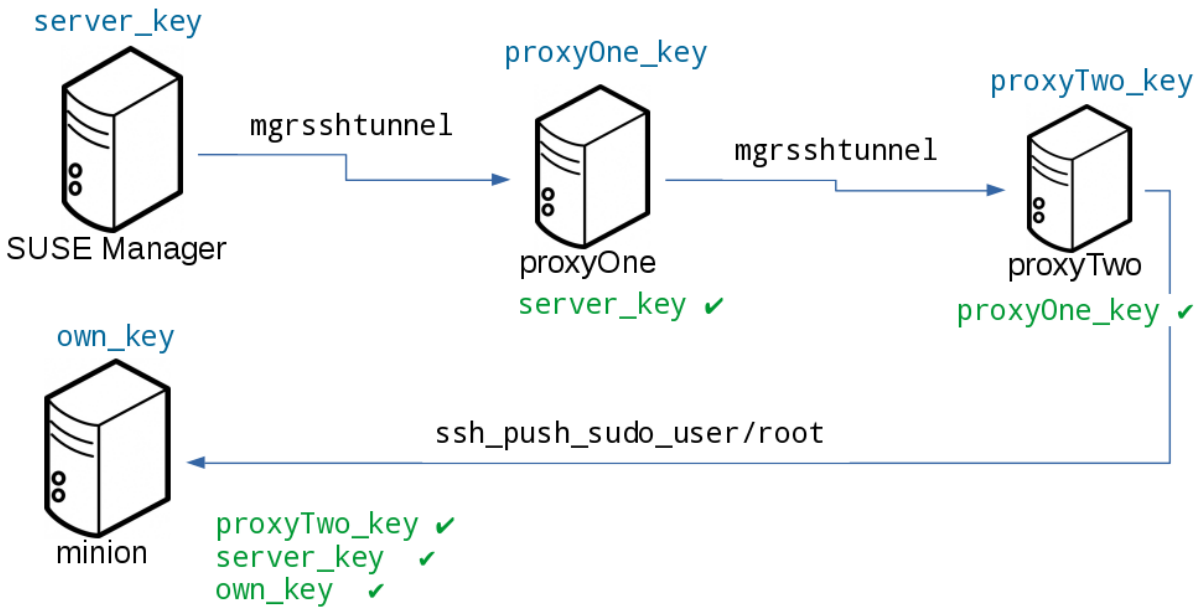


3.13.9. Users and SSH Key Management

To connect to a proxy, the parent server or proxy uses a specific user called mgrsshtunnel. When mgrsshtunnel connects, the SSH configuration of the proxy will force the execution of /usr/sbin/mgr-proxy-ssh-force-cmd. This is a simple shell script that allows only the execution of scp, ssh, or cat commands.

The connection to the proxy or client is authorized using SSH keys in this sequence:

1. The server connects to the client and to the first proxy using the key in /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/mgr_ssh_id.
2. Each proxy has its own key pair in /home/mgrsshtunnel/.ssh/id_susemanager_ssh_push.
3. Each proxy authorizes the key of the parent proxy or server.
4. The client authorizes its own key.

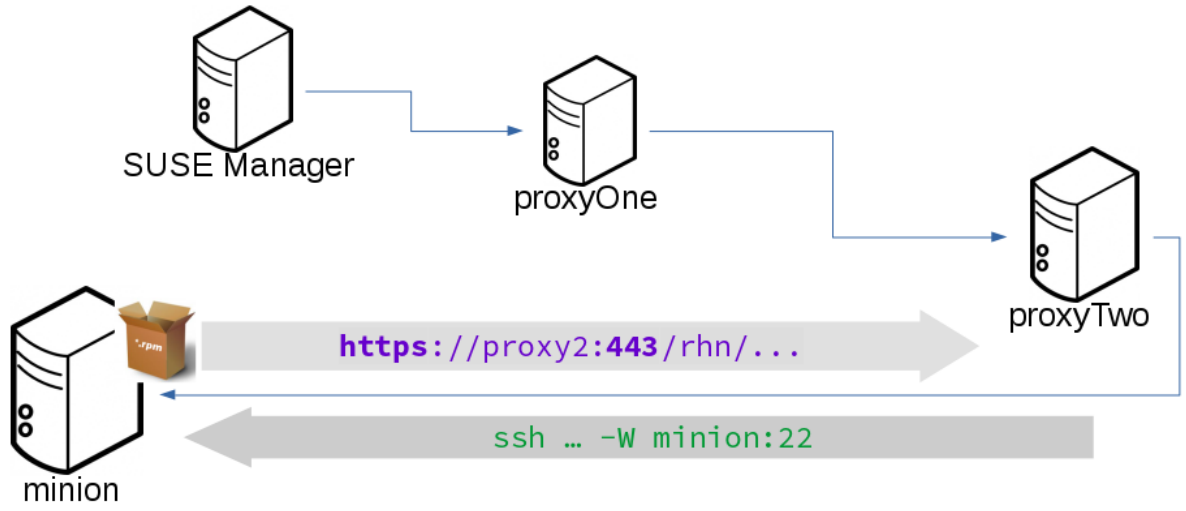


3.13.10. Repository Access with a Proxy

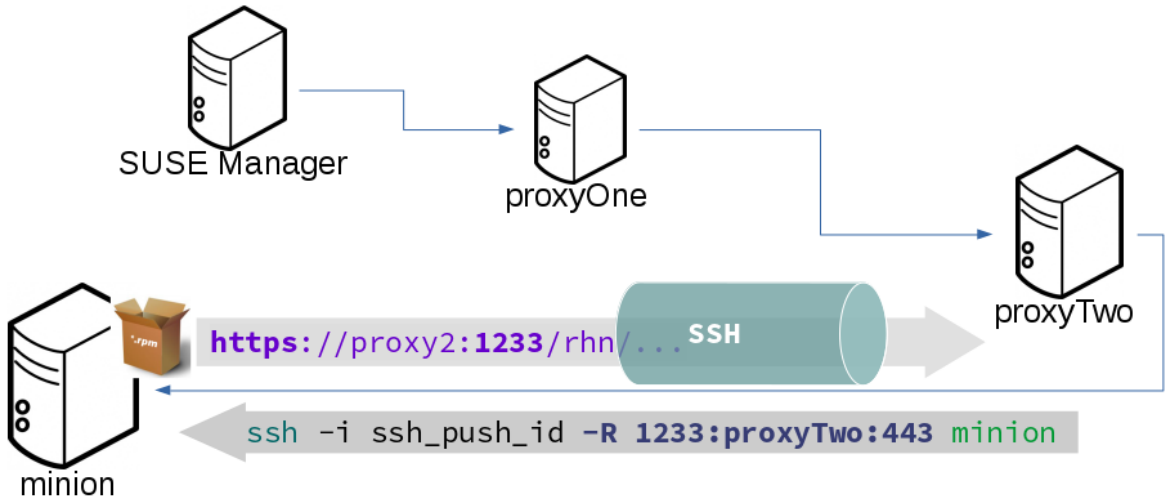
When Uyuni connects to a repository using a proxy, it can use either ssh-push or ssh-push-tunnel.

In both methods the client connects to the proxy to retrieve package and repository information.

In the ssh-push method, the package manager connects directly to the proxy using HTTP or HTTPS. This works in cases where there is no firewall between the client and the proxy that blocks HTTP connections initiated by the client.



In the ssh-push-tunnel method, the HTTP connection to the proxy is redirected through a reverse SSH tunnel.



3.13.11. Proxy Setup

When the spacewalk-proxy package is installed on the proxy, the mgrsshtunnel user is created.

The initial configuration with configure-proxy.sh occurs using this sequence:

1. An SSH key pair is generated, or an existing keypair is imported.
2. The SSH key of the parent server or proxy is retrieved to authorize it on the proxy.
3. The ssh daemon on the proxy is configured to restrict the mgrsshtunnel user. This is done by the mgr-proxy-ssh-push-init script, which is called from configure-proxy.sh. It does not have to be manually invoked.

The parent key is retrieved by calling an HTTPS endpoint on the parent server or proxy. The first endpoint tried is https://$PARENT/pub/id_susemanager_ssh_push.pub. If the parent is a proxy then this will return the public SSH key of the proxy.

If a 404 error is received from that endpoint, then the parent is assumed to be a server not a proxy, and https://$PARENT/rhn/manager/download/saltssh/pubkey is tried instead.

If an SSH key exists at /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/mgr_ssh_id.pub on the server it is returned.

If the public key does not exist because salt-ssh has not been invoked yet, a key will be generates by calling the mgrutil.ssh_keygen runner.



Salt SSH generates a keypair the first time it is invoked with /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/mgr_ssh_id. The sequence in this section is needed if a proxy is configured before Salt SSH was invoked for the first time.

3.13.12. Rotate SSH keys

The SSH key is used on salt-ssh managed systems. Additionally, it is used on Uyuni Proxies for the user mgrsshtunnel. Normal systems managed with the Salt default method are not affected and do not have this key configured.

Procedure: Rotating SSH keys

1. On the Uyuni Server, as user root, change to user salt:

```
su -s /bin/bash - salt
```

2. Create a new SSH key:

```
ssh-keygen -N "" -t rsa -q -f /var/lib/salt/.ssh/new_mgr_ssh_id
```

3. Copy the public key into the Salt filesystem to make it usable in a Salt state:

```
cp /var/lib/salt/.ssh/new_mgr_ssh_id.pub /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/
```

4. Change back to user root again:

```
exit
```

5. Rollout the new key to all systems that need it. Applying the util.mgr_rotate_saltssh_key state will limit the changes to salt-ssh managed systems and proxies:

```
salt '*' state.apply util.mgr_rotate_saltssh_key
mgr-salt-ssh '*' state.apply util.mgr_rotate_saltssh_key
```

6. Move the old key away and make the new key the standard key. Rename mgr_ssh_id key to disabled_mgr_ssh_id and new_mgr_ssh_id key to mgr_ssh_id in the SSH keystore of the user salt as well as in the Salt filesystem for the public keys:

```
su -s /bin/bash - salt
cd .ssh
mv mgr_ssh_id disabled_mgr_ssh_id
mv mgr_ssh_id.pub disabled_mgr_ssh_id.pub
mv new_mgr_ssh_id mgr_ssh_id
mv new_mgr_ssh_id.pub mgr_ssh_id.pub
cd /srv/susemanager/salt/salt_ssh/
mv mgr_ssh_id.pub disabled_mgr_ssh_id.pub
mv new_mgr_ssh_id.pub mgr_ssh_id.pub
```

7. OPTIONAL: When containerized proxies exist, re-create the configuration to get the new SSH key into the proxy configuration. Restart the containers with the new configuration. It is also possible to change the

existing configuration on the podman host (ssh.yaml). Change the value of server_ssh_key_pub with the content of the current mgr_ssh_id.pub.

8. To remove the disabled keys from the authorized_keys files of the salt-ssh managed systems and the proxies, apply the state a second time:

```
salt '*' state.apply util.mgr_rotate_saltssh_key
mgr-salt-ssh '*' state.apply util.mgr_rotate_saltssh_key
```

3.14. Salt Rate Limiting

Salt is able to run commands in parallel on a large number of clients. This can potentially create large amounts of load on your infrastructure. You can use these rate-limiting parameters to control the load in your environment.

These parameters are all configured in the /etc/rhn/rhn.conf configuration file.



Salt commands that are executed from the command line are not subject to these parameters.

3.14.1. Batching

There are two parameters that control how actions are sent to clients, one for the batch size, and one for the delay.

When the Uyuni Server sends a batch of actions to the target clients, it will send it to the number of clients determined in the batch size parameter. After the specified delay period, commands will be sent to the next batch of clients. The number of clients in each subsequent batch is equal to the number of clients that have completed in the previous batch.

Choosing a lower batch size will reduce system load and parallelism, but might reduce overall performance for processing actions.

The batch size parameter sets the maximum number of clients that can execute a single action at the same time. Adjust the java.salt_batch_size parameter. Defaults to 200.

Increasing the delay increases the chance that multiple clients will have completed before the next action is issued (more clients are grouped together in subsequent batches), resulting in fewer overall commands, and reducing load.

The batch delay parameter sets the amount of time, in seconds, to wait after a command from the previous batch is processed before beginning to process the command on the next client. Adjust the java.salt_batch_delay parameter. Defaults to 1.0 seconds.

3.14.2. Disabling the Salt Mine

In older versions, Uyuni used a tool called Salt mine to check client availability. The Salt mine would cause clients to contact the server every hour, which created significant load. With the introduction of a more efficient mechanism in Uyuni 3.2, the Salt mine is no longer required. Instead, the Uyuni Server uses Taskomatic to ping only the clients that appear to have been offline for twelve hours or more, with all clients being contacted at least once in every twenty four hour period by default. You can adjust this by changing the web.system_checkin_threshold parameter in rhn.conf. The value is expressed in days, and the default value is `1`.

Newly registered Salt clients will have the Salt mine disabled by default. If the Salt mine is running on your system, you can reduce load by disabling it. This is especially effective if you have a large number of clients.

Disable the Salt mine by running this command on the server:

```
salt '*' state.sls util.mgr_mine_config_clean_up
```

This will restart the clients and generate some Salt events to be processed by the server. If you have a large number of clients, handling these events could create excessive load. To avoid this, you can execute the command in batch mode with this command:

```
salt --batch-size 50 '*' state.sls util.mgr_mine_config_clean_up
```

You will need to wait for this command to finish executing. Do not end the process with `Ctrl` + `C`.

3.15. Scaling Minions (Large Scale Deployments)

Uyuni is designed by default to work on small and medium scale installations. For installations with more than 1000 clients per Uyuni Server, adequate hardware sizing and parameter tuning must be performed.

For more information on managing large scale deployments, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Overview**.

3.16. Salt Connectivity

Depending on the size and spreadness of the environment where Uyuni is used some connectivity issues are possible. There are no common recommendations for all the possible use cases as the environments could be very different expecially if public clouds instances are involved.

3.16.1. Minions Connectivity

In case clients are losing the connection to the Uyuni Server (or Uyuni Proxy if involved), they are unreachable from the Uyuni Server Web UI or with command line tools. To understand such a connection issue check if the

client is not reachable from the Uyuni Server with salt MINION_ID test.ping, while venv-salt-call test.ping (or salt-call test.ping if non-bundle Salt is used on the client) is working fine on the client side. If this is the case, it is recommended to set tcp_keepalive parameters.

The parameters with the values from the example below can be used as a starting point to look for settings, which could prevent cases of connection loss without restoring for some environments. It is recommended to put the parameters in the separate drop-in configuration file like /etc/venv-salt-minion/minion.d/tuning-keepalives.conf or /etc/salt/minion.d/tuning-keepalives.conf, depending on the minion type used on the client side.

Listing 8. Example: Keepalive Parameters Example Values

```
######      Keepalive settings        ######
############################################
# ZeroMQ now includes support for configuring SO_KEEPALIVE if supported by
# the OS. If connections between the minion and the master pass through
# a state tracking device such as a firewall or VPN gateway, there is
# the risk that it could tear down the connection the master and minion
# without informing either party that their connection has been taken away.
# Enabling TCP Keepalives prevents this from happening.

# Overall state of TCP Keepalives, enable (1 or True), disable (0 or False)
# or leave to the OS defaults (-1), on Linux, typically disabled. Default True, enabled.
tcp_keepalive: True

# How long before the first keepalive should be sent in seconds. Default 300
# to send the first keepalive after 5 minutes, OS default (-1) is typically 7200 seconds
# on Linux see /proc/sys/net/ipv4/tcp_keepalive_time.
tcp_keepalive_idle: 10

# How many lost probes are needed to consider the connection lost. Default -1
# to use OS defaults, typically 9 on Linux, see /proc/sys/net/ipv4/tcp_keepalive_probes.
tcp_keepalive_cnt: 3

# How often, in seconds, to send keepalives after the first one. Default -1 to
# use OS defaults, typically 75 seconds on Linux, see
# /proc/sys/net/ipv4/tcp_keepalive_intvl.
tcp_keepalive_intvl: 10
```

3.16.2. Proxies Connectivity

salt-broker service is used on Uyuni Proxies to forward Salt traffic between the Uyuni Server and salt-minion service used on the client side. It is possible that salt-broker and all the clients behind it could be affected with the same issue as the clients directly connected to the Uyuni Server. The issue could be fixed with the same parameters as recommended for the minions, but specified in /etc/salt/broker on each Uyuni Proxy.

Uyuni Proxy connectivity can also suffer when the connectivity to the Uyuni Server is lost for a quite long interval. In such a case Proxy connected clients started to retry the authentication to the salt-master service on the Uyuni Server. This situation could be potentially dangerous because it could lead to collecting large amount of ZeroMQ messages with authentication attemps in the interal buffer of ZeroMQ sockets used inside the salt-broker service. Then, on restoring the connection to the salt-master all of the pending messages will be pushed

to it. It could lead to the issues on Uyuni Server side with salt-master service, because it could be impossible to serve all the cached requests in appropriate time or even to the complete denial of the service.

To avoid such situation a set of tuning parameters is available. As the most important one, wait_for_backend should be set to True. This prevents opening the sockets for the clients behind the proxy while the connectivity to the salt-master service is not established. In this case the messages from the clients are not collected in the internal buffers. drop_after_retries is setting the number of retries before closing the sockets to drop the cached messages. The other parameters could help to fine tune the behavior for the environment.



Setting timeouts, intervals and drop_after_retries to lower values are making salt-broker service more aggressive on detecting the connection loss to the salt-master, so that it puts the clients behind the proxy to the conditions closer as they are connected directly to the Uyuni Server. Increasing the values could provide some benefits in case if the network channel between the Uyuni Proxy and Uyuni Server is not stable enough, the message buffering can provide some flexibility while re-establishing the connection.

Listing 9. Example: Values for Keepalive Parameters

```
######   ZeroMQ connection options    ######
##############################################
# For more details about the following parameters check ZeroMQ documentation:
# http://api.zeromq.org/4-2:zmq-setsockopt
# All of these parameters will be set to the backend sockets
# (from the salt-broker to the salt-master)

# connect_timeout (sets ZMQ_CONNECT_TIMEOUT)
# default: 0
# value unit: milliseconds
# Sets how long to wait before timing-out a connect to the remote socket.
# 0 could take much time, so it could be better to set to more strict value
# for particular environment depending on the network conditions.
# The value equal to 10000 is setting 10 seconds connect timeout.
connect_timeout: 3000

# reconnect_ivl (sets ZMQ_RECONNECT_IVL)
# default: 100
# value unit: milliseconds
# Sets the interval of time before reconnection attempt on connection drop.
reconnect_ivl: 1000

# heartbeat_ivl (sets ZMQ_HEARTBEAT_IVL)
# default: 0
# value unit: milliseconds
# This parameter is important for detection of loosing the connection.
# In case of value equal to 0 it is not sending heartbits.
# It's better to set to more relevant value for the particular environment,
# depending on possible network issues.
# The value equal to 20000 (20 seconds) works good for most cases.
heartbeat_ivl: 5000

# heartbeat_timeout (sets ZMQ_HEARTBEAT_TIMEOUT)
# default: 0
# value unit: milliseconds
# Sets the interval of time to consider that the connection is timed out
# after sending the heartbeat and not getting the response on it.
# The value equal to 60000 (1 minute) is considering the connection is down
```

```
# after 1 minute of no response to the heartbeat.
heartbeat_timeout: 10000


######   Other connection options    ######
# The following parameters are not related to ZeroMQ,
# but the internal parameters of the salt-broker.
# drop_after_retries
# default: -1
# value unit: number of retries
# Drop the frontend sockets of the salt-broker in case if it reaches
# the number of retries to reconnect to the backend socket.
# -1 means not drop the frontend sockets
# It's better to choose more relevant value for the particular environment.
# 10 can be a good choise for most of the cases.
drop_after_retries: 5

# wait_for_backend
# default: False
# The main aim of this parameter is to prevent  collecting the messages
# with the open frontend socket and prevent pushing them on connecting
# the backend socket to prevent large number of messages to be pushed
# at once to salt-master.
# It's better to set it to True if there is significant numer of minions
# behind the salt-broker.
wait_for_backend: True
```

3.17. Monitoring Salt Events

In some cases the Salt event bus could publish significant amount of events with a high rate, what could make it hard to analyze. Getting the statistics based on the events published in the Salt event bus can help to identify possible weak points and perform Salt internals profiling.

3.17.1. Saline

Saline is a powerful tool designed to function as a Prometheus exporter, enabling the collection of metrics based on events from the Salt event bus. These metrics are derived from event data available on the Salt master, similar to what is accessible through the command:

```
mgrctl exec -ti -- salt-run state.event
```

Saline is distributed as a separate container image, server-saline, for use with Uyuni Server. All related commands and operations should be executed on the Uyuni Server container host system.

In addition to its role as a Prometheus exporter, Saline also provides the saline-formula, which simplifies configuration of Prometheus and Grafana dashboards, enhancing monitoring and visualization capabilities.

3.17.2. Saline deployment

Deployment instructions depend on when the customer decides to enable Saline.

- Saline can be deployed during the initial installation or an upgrade of the Uyuni server, by using command:

```
mgradm install --saline-replicas 1
```

- If the Uyuni server is already installed, you can enable Saline support without running a full server upgrade with this command:

```
mgradm scale uyuni-saline --replicas 1
```

- If you want to upgrade and add Saline with one single command, use:

```
mgradm upgrade && mgradm scale uyuni-saline --replicas 1
```

In all scenarios, the only possible values for --saline-replicas are 1 or 0.

After finishing the deployment Uyuni-saline.service should be configured on the Uyuni Server host system.

3.17.3. Salt master configuration recommendations

It is recommended to add master_stats: True and adjust the value of master_stats_event_iter: 60 if needed. Then restart salt-master to get the detailed statistics of internal Salt calls. This can be help with tuning large scale deployment installations.

3.17.4. Saline formula

To configure Prometheus and Grafana dashboards, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Saline Formula**.

3.17.5. Removing Saline

To remove Saline from the Uyuni Server use mgradm upgrade with --saline-replicas 0.

3.17.6. Examples of resulting Grafana dashboards

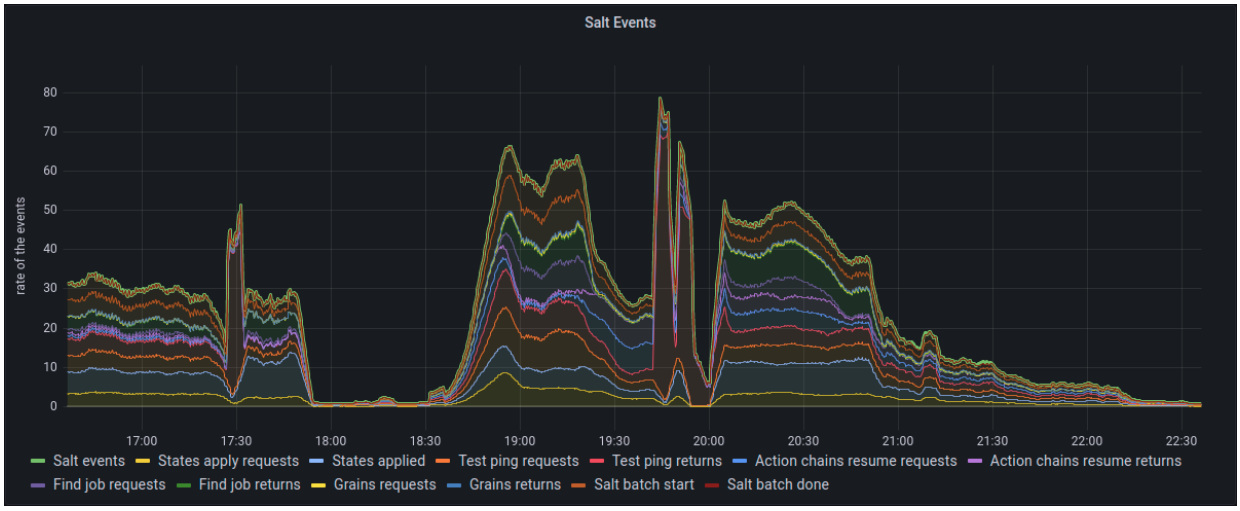
3.17.6.1. Uyuni Server (with Saline) dashboard

The dashboard represents Salt events with the different views presented on the panels.

3.17.6.2. Salt Events

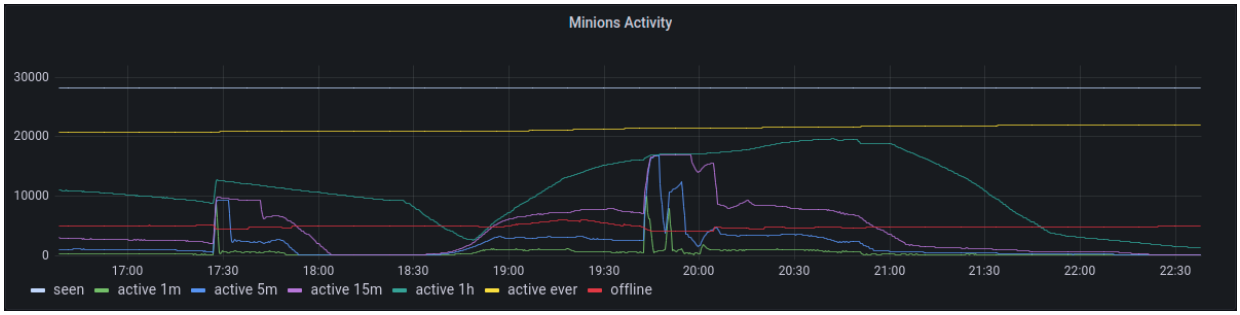
The panel represents all the Salt events grouped by categories. Salt events represents the total number of all

categories of the events.



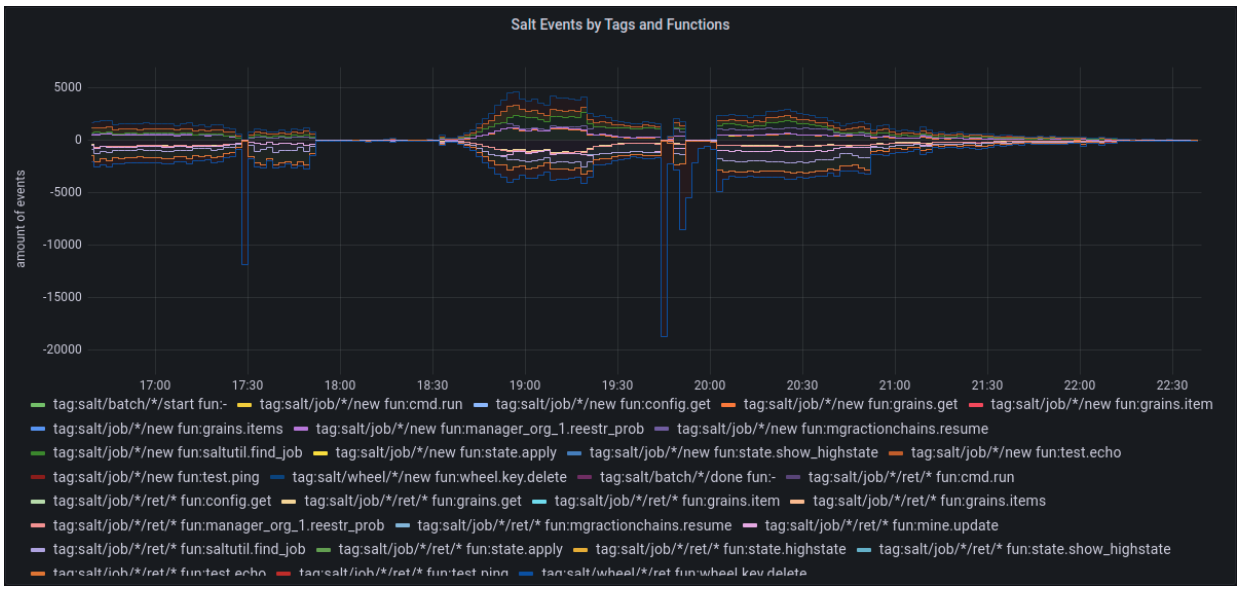
3.17.6.3. Minions Activity

The panel provides the minions activity status for the specified interval of times. It shows the amount of minions which were active in last minute, 5 minutes, 15 minutes, 1 hour or considered offline on this moment of time or even ever seen (could be targeted or either responded or not) or active.



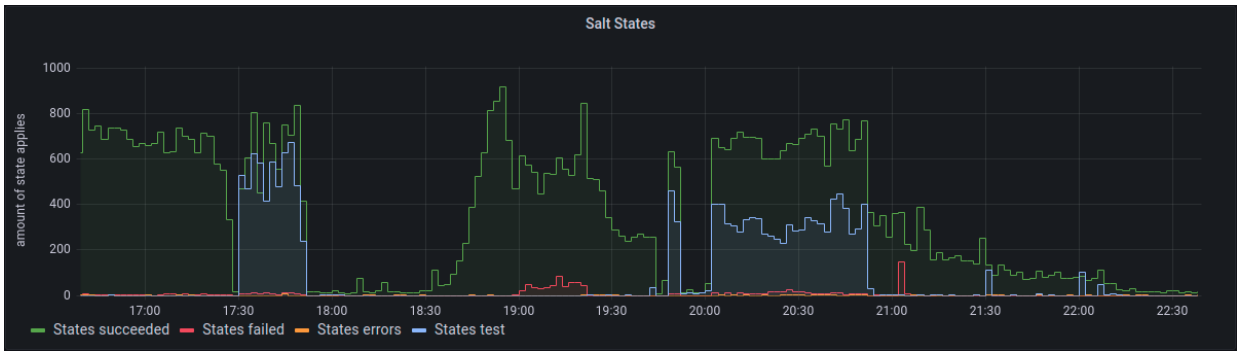
3.17.6.4. Salt Events by Tags and Functions

The panel provides the detailed representation of **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Events** with the event spread by direction The events which are send to the minions are presented on the positive side of the axis, while the events received from the minions are presented on the negative side.



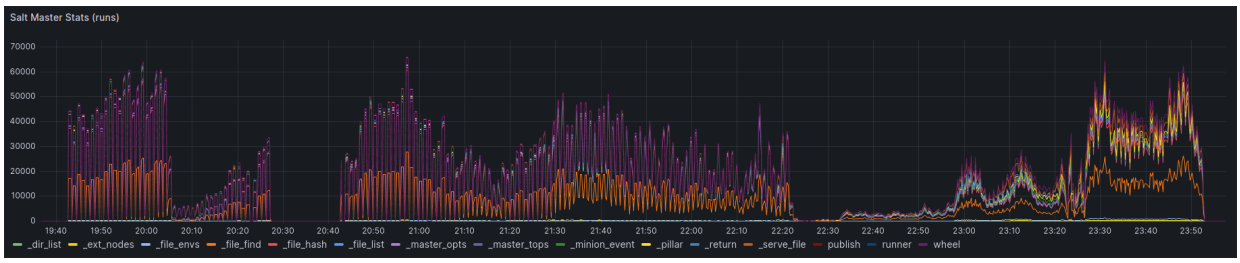
3.17.6.5. Salt States

The panel represents states apply process events grouped by the status: succeeded, failed, causing errors or applied in the test mode.



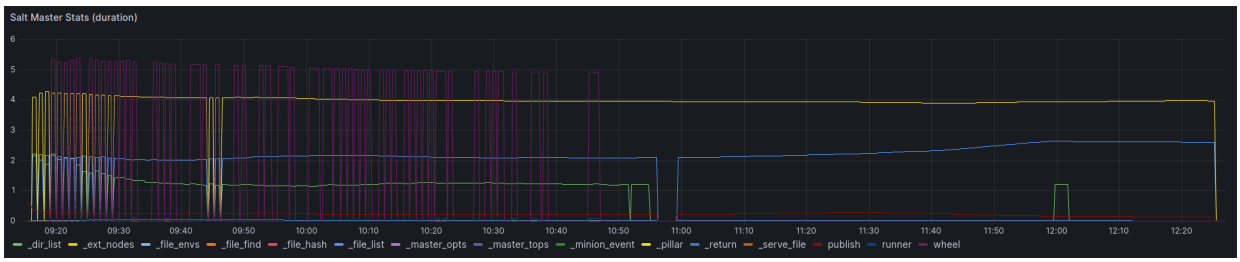
3.17.6.6. Salt Master Stats (runs)

The panel represents the number of internal calls grouped by function, which are exposed with Salt stats.



3.17.6.7. Salt Master Stats (avg. duration)

The panel represents the average duration of internal calls grouped by function, which are exposed with Salt stats.



3.17.7. Saline State Jobs dashboard

The dashboard represents Salt state apply process, it can be used for detailed monitoring of the internals of state apply process initiated for a number of targets.

3.17.7.1. Salt State Jobs (instant)

The panel represents an instant view of the state functions calls represented in the table view.

Salt State Jobs (instant)

Function	MODS	Test	Targeted	Progress	Succeeded	Failed ↓	Timed out
state.apply	manager_org_1.UpdateA...	-	1	100%	0%	100%	0%
state.highstate	HIGHSTATE	-	17	100%	24%	76%	0%
state.apply	util.systeminfo	-	21181	100%	96%	3%	2%
state.apply	util.synccustomall, hard...	-	48	100%	96%	2%	2%
state.apply	HIGHSTATE	-	77	100%	95%	1%	4%
state.apply	manager_org_1.test_exa...	-	20596	100%	83%	0%	17%
state.apply	packages.profileupdate	-	10756	100%	99%	0%	1%
state.apply	minion.install-ptf	-	29	100%	100%	0%	0%

3.17.7.2. Salt States Profiling

The panel provides the table of state functions calls with the detailed profiling data that can be used for state optimization.

Salt States Profiling

SLS	State ID	Function	Succeeded	Avg. duration (succ.)	Failed	Avg. duration (fail.)
manager_org_1.test	test_chromium-gost-s...	pkg.latest	8162	2.85 min	435	1.82 min
manager_org_1.test	test_chromium-gost-s...	pkg.installed	12	1.84 min	0	-
minion.install-ptf	salt-minion-upgrade	pkg.installed	7	1.33 min	0	-
util.syncmodules	sync_modules	module.run	41667	36.3 s	545	4.02 min
util.syncgrains	sync_grains	module.run	42106	26.8 s	107	4.10 min
util.syncbeacons	sync_beacons	module.run	27787	26.0 s	19	3.82 min
packages.profileupdate	products	module.run	14408	6.42 s	0	-
manager_org_1.test	/etc/skel/Desktop/re...	file.managed	8173	6.00 s	436	576 ms
channels	mgrchannels_repo	file.managed	323	3.81 s	0	-

3.18. Salt timeouts

3.18.1. General Salt timeouts

Salt features two timeout parameters called timeout and gather_job_timeout that are relevant during the execution of Salt commands and jobs—it does not matter whether they are triggered using the command line interface or API. These two parameters are explained in the following article.

This is a normal workflow when all clients are well reachable:

- A Salt command or job is executed:

```
salt '*' test.ping
```

- Salt master publishes the job with the targeted clients into the Salt PUB channel.
- Clients take that job and start working on it.
- Salt master is looking at the Salt RET channel to gather responses from the clients.
- If Salt master gets all responses from targeted clients, then everything is completed and Salt master will return a response containing all the client responses.

If some of the clients are down during this process, the workflow continues as follows:

1. If timeout is reached before getting all expected responses from the clients, then Salt master would trigger an aditional job (a Salt find_job job) targeting only pending clients to check whether the job is already running on the client.
2. Now gather_job_timeout is evaluated. A new counter is now triggered.
3. If this new find_job job responds that the original job is actually running on the client, then Salt master will wait for that client's response for another gather_job_timeout interval before issuing the next find_job job.
4. In case of reaching gather_job_timeout without having any response from the client (neither for the initial test.ping nor for the find_job job), Salt master will return with only the gathered responses from the responding clients.

By default, Uyuni globally sets timeout and gather_job_timeout to 120 seconds. So, in the worst case, a Salt call targeting unreachable clients will end up with 240 seconds of waiting until getting a response.

You can configure these values differently by creating a /etc/salt/master.d/custom.conf configuration file according to syntax in /etc/salt/master.conf.

3.18.2. Presence Ping Timeouts

Before Actions are executed on Salt clients, whether they scheduled via the Web UI or the API, Uyuni performs a "presence ping" command to ensure the respective salt-minion processes are active and able to respond.

Then, a ping gather job runs on the Salt master to handle the incoming pings from the clients. Actual commands will begin only after all clients have either responded to the ping, or timed out.

The presence ping is an ordinary Salt command, but is not subject to the same timeout parameters as all other Salt commands (timeout/gather_job_timeout, described above). Rather, it has its own parameters (java.salt_presence_ping_timeout/java.salt_presence_ping_gather_job_timeout) that can be set in /etc/rhn/rhn.conf.

To allow for quicker detection of unresponsive clients, the timeout values for presence pings are by default significantly shorter than the general defaults. You can configure the presence ping parameters in /etc/rhn/rhn.conf, however the default values should be sufficient in most cases.

A lower total presence ping timeout value will increase the chance of false negatives. In some cases, a client might be marked as non-responding, when it is responding but did not respond quickly enough. Additionally, setting this total presence ping timeout value too low could result in a client hanging at the boot screen. A higher total presence ping timeout will increase the accuracy of the test, as even slow clients will respond to the presence ping before timing out. Additionally, a higher presence ping timeout could limit throughput if you are targeting a large number of clients, when some of them are slow.

If a client does not reply to a ping within the allocated time, it is marked as not available, and is excluded from the command. The Web UI shows a minion is down or could not be contacted message in this case.

The presence ping timeout parameter changes the timeout setting for the presence ping, in seconds. Adjust the java.salt_presence_ping_timeout parameter. Defaults to 4 seconds.

The presence ping gather job parameter changes the timeout setting for gathering the presence ping, in seconds. Adjust the java.salt_presence_ping_gather_job_timeout parameter. Defaults to 1 second.

3.18.3. Salt SSH Clients (SSH Push)

Salt SSH clients are slightly different than regular clients (zeromq). Salt SSH clients do not use Salt PUB/RET channels but a wrapper Salt command inside of an SSH call. Salt timeout and gather_job_timeout are not playing a role here.

Uyuni defines a timeout for SSH connections in /etc/rhn/rhn.conf:

```
# salt_ssh_connect_timeout = 180
```

Chapter 4. Large Deployments Guide Overview

Uyuni is designed by default to work on small and medium scale installations. For installations with more than 1000 clients per Uyuni Server, adequate hardware sizing and parameter tuning must be performed.

There is no hard maximum number of supported systems. Many factors can affect how many clients can reliably be used in a particular installation. Factors can include which features are used, and how the hardware and systems are configured.

There are two main ways to manage large scale deployments. You can manage them with a single Uyuni Server, or you can use multiple servers in a hub. Both methods are described in this book.

With large scale environments one should also consider the usage of Uyuni Proxies. Sizing and location of the Proxies will dependent on the deployment topology. For more information, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Install Proxy**.

Additionally, if you are operating within a Retail environment, you can use Uyuni for Retail to manage large deployments of point-of-service terminals. There is an introduction to Uyuni for Retail in this book.

Tuning and monitoring large scale deployments can differ from smaller installations. This book contains guidance for both tuning and monitoring within larger installations.

4.1. Hardware Requirements

Not all problems can be solved with better hardware, but choosing the right hardware is an absolute necessity for large scale deployments.



All hardware recommendations are **guidelines only**. The actual hardware needs will be influenced by number of clients, channels operations, and other parameters.

For succesful configuration of large deployments, seek guidance from SUSE Support Team.

The minimum requirements for the Uyuni Server are:

Table 1. Minimum Server Hardware Requirements

Hardware	Details	Recommendation
CPU	x86-64	Minimum 8 dedicated 64-bit CPU cores
RAM	Minimum	32 GB
	Recommended	For installations with thousands of clients, use 64 GB or more.

Hardware	Details	Recommendation
Storage devices		Fast I/O storage devices, such as locally attached SSDs. For PostgreSQL data directories, we recommend locally attached RAID-0 SSDs.

If the Uyuni Server is virtualized, enable the elevator=none kernel command line option, for the best input/output performance. You can check the current status with cat /sys/block/<DEVICE>/queue/scheduler. This command will display a list of available schedulers with the currently active one in brackets. To change the scheduler before a reboot, use echo none > /sys/block/<DEVICE>/queue/scheduler.

The minimum requirements for the Uyuni Proxy are:

Table 2. Minimum Proxy Hardware Requirements

Hardware	Details	Recommendation
CPU	x86-64	Minimum 2 dedicated 64-bit CPU cores
RAM	Minimum	16 GB
		Additionally, include sufficient storage for caching.
Number of clients	Recommendation	One proxy is generally reasonable for **500-1000 clients**, but this is a **recommendation, not a hard limit**, and depends on available network bandwidth

Clients should never be directly attached to the Uyuni Server in production systems.

In large scale installations, the Uyuni Proxy is used primarily as a local cache for content between the server and clients. Using proxies in this way can substantially reduce download time for clients, and decrease Server egress bandwidth use.

The number of clients per proxy will affect the download time. Always take network structure and available bandwidth into account.

We recommend you estimate the download time of typical usage to determine how many clients to connnect to each proxy. To do this, you will need to estimate the number of package upgrades required in every patch cycle. You can use this formula to calculate the download time:

```
Size of updates * Number of clients / Theoretical download speed / 60
```

For example, the total time needed to transfer 400 MB of upgrades through a physical link speed of 1 GB/s to 3000 clients:

```
400 MB  * 3000 / 119 MB/s / 60 = 169 min
```

4.2. Using a Single Server to Manage Large Scale Deployments

This section discusses how to set up a single Uyuni Server to manage a large number of clients. It contains some recommendations for hardware and networking, and an overview of the tuning parameters that you need to consider in a large scale deployment.

4.2.1. Operation Recommendations

This section contains a range of recommendations for large scale deployments.



Always start small and scale up gradually. Monitor the server as you scale to identify problems early.

4.2.1.1. Client Onboarding Rate

The rate at which Uyuni can onboard clients is limited and depends on hardware resources. Onboarding clients at a faster rate than Uyuni is configured for will build up a backlog of unprocessed keys. This slows down the process and can potentially exhaust resources. We recommend that you limit the acceptance key rate programmatically. A safe starting point would be to onboard a client every 15 seconds. You can do that with this command:

```
for k in $(salt-key -l un|grep -v Unaccepted); do salt-key -y -a $k; sleep 15; done
```

4.2.1.2. Clients and the RNG

All communication to and from clients is encrypted. During client onboarding, Salt uses asymmetric cryptography, which requires available entropy from the Random Number Generator (RNG) facility in the kernel. If sufficient entropy is not available from the RNG, it will significantly slow down communications. This is especially true in virtualized environments. Ensure enough entropy is present, or change the virtualization host options.

You can check the amount of available entropy with the cat /proc/sys/kernel/random/entropy_avail. It should never be below 100-200.

4.2.1.3. Clients Running with Unaccepted Salt Keys

Idle clients which have not been onboarded, that is clients running with unaccepted Salt keys, consume more resources than idle clients that have been onboarded. Generally, this consumes about an extra 2.5 Kb/s of inbound network bandwidth per client. For example, 1000 idle clients will consume about 2.5 Mb/s extra. This

consumption will reduce almost to zero when onboarding has been completed for all clients. Limit the number of non-onboarded clients for optimal performance.

4.2.1.4. Disabling the Salt Mine

In older versions, Uyuni used a tool called Salt Mine to check client availability. The Salt Mine would cause clients to contact the server every hour, which created significant load. Since the introduction of a more efficient mechanism in Uyuni 3.2, the Salt Mine is no longer required. Instead, the Uyuni Server uses Taskomatic to ping only the clients that appear to have been offline for twelve hours or more, with all clients being contacted at least once in every twenty four hour period by default. You can adjust this by changing the web.system_checkin_threshold parameter in rhn.conf. The value is expressed in days, and the default value is `1`.

Newly registered clients will have the Salt Mine disabled by default. If the Salt Mine is running on your system, you can reduce load by disabling it. This is especially effective if you have a large number of clients.

Disable the Salt Mine by running this command on the server:

```
salt '*' state.sls util.mgr_mine_config_clean_up
```

This will restart the clients and generate some Salt events to be processed by the server. If you have a large number of clients, handling these events could create excessive load. To avoid this, you can execute the command in batch mode with this command:

```
salt --batch-size 50 '*' state.sls util.mgr_mine_config_clean_up
```

You will need to wait for this command to finish executing. Do not end the process with `Ctrl` + `C`.

4.2.1.5. Disable Unnecessary Taskomatic Jobs

To minimize wasted resources, you can disable non-essential or unused Taskomatic jobs.

You can see the list of Taskomatic jobs in the Uyuni Web UI, at **Admin › Task Schedules**.

To disable a job, click the name of the job you want to disable, select Disable Schedule, and click **[Update Schedule]**.

To delete a job, click the name of the job you want to delete, and click **[Delete Schedule]**.

We recommend disabling these jobs:

- Daily comparison of configuration files: compare-configs-default
- Hourly synchronization of Cobbler files: cobbler-sync-default

- Daily gatherer and subscription matcher: gatherer-matcher-default

Do not attempt to disable any other jobs, as it could prevent Uyuni from functioning correctly.

4.2.1.6. Swap and Monitoring

It is especially important in large scale deployments that you keep your Uyuni Server constantly monitored and backed up.

Swap space use can have significant impacts on performance. If significant non-transient swap usage is detected, you can increase the available hardware RAM.

You can also consider tuning the Server to consume less memory. For more information on tuning, see **Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Scaling Minions**.

4.2.1.7. AES Key Rotation

Communications from the Salt Master to clients is encrypted with a single AES key. The key is rotated when:

- The salt-master process is restarted, or
- Any minion key is deleted (for example, when a client is deleted from Uyuni)

After the AES key has been rotated, all clients must re-authenticate to the master. By default, this happens next time a client receives a message. If you have a large number of clients (several thousands), this can cause a high CPU load on the Uyuni Server. If the CPU load is excessive, we recommend that you delete keys in batches, and in off-peak hours if possible, to avoid overloading the server.

For more information, see:

- https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/topics/tutorials/intro_scale.html#too-many-minions-re-authing
- https://docs.saltproject.io/en/getstarted/system/communication.html

4.3. Multiple Servers with Hub to Manage Large Scale Deployments

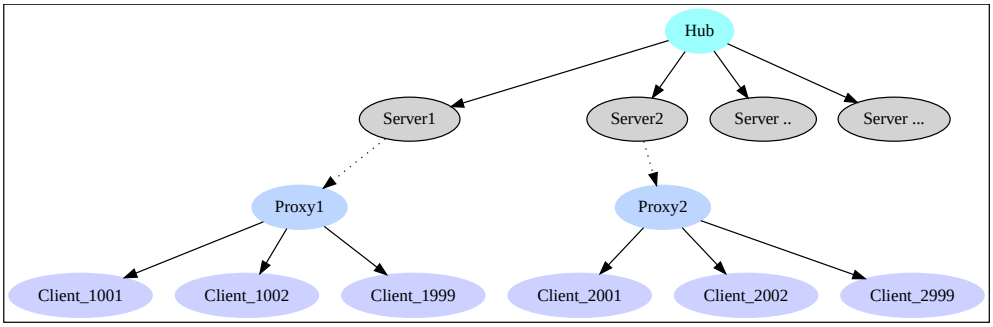
If you need to manage a large number of clients, in most cases you can do so with a single Uyuni Server, tuned appropriately.

However, if you need to manage tens of thousands of clients, you might find it easier to use one of the following mechanisms:

- **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Online Synchronization**
- **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Inter-Server Synchronization (ISS v2)**

ISS version 2 is based on exporting data from one server (source) and importing it on another (target) server. It is useful for disconnected setups.

Uyuni Hub helps managing very large deployments by connecting multiple servers together. The connection between the Hub and its peripheral servers is established using Hub Online Synchronization. This connection also enables other features like **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub XMLRPC API** and **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Reporting**. The typical Hub topology looks like this:



- One central Uyuni Server, which acts as the Hub Server.
- One or more additional Uyuni Servers, registered to the Hub. This document refers to these additional servers as peripheral servers.
- Any number of clients registered to the peripheral servers. Some of these clients can act as Uyuni Proxies.

This chapter gives more details about Hub deployment.

4.3.1. Hub Online Synchronization

4.3.1.1. Introduction

Hub online synchronization is the primary mechanism for connecting peripheral servers to the hub. It establishes the underlying connection required for other hub features: **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub XMLRPC API** and **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Reporting**.

It reuses the existing repository synchronization and synchronizes channels in the peripheral servers from the repositories on the hub server.

When the connection between hub and peripheral server is established, the hub server becomes the main source of data for the peripheral server. In case of vendor channels, hub server is effectively replacing SUSE Customer Center. In case of custom channels, when they are synchronized, the peripheral server will fetch the packages from the hub and not from the original location of the custom channel defined on the hub.

The main characteristics of this feature are:

- There can only be one hub server per connection, with one or more peripheral servers.
- Each peripheral server can only have one hub server.
- Content can be synchronized on regular basis, or on demand.

4.3.1.2. Registration of the hub and peripheral servers

Hub online synchronization is configured from menu **Admin › Hub Configuration**.

Configuration process uses token which uniquely identifies peripheral server's connection to the hub.

There are two ways to register a peripheral server to the hub server:

1. by using a combination of token creation on the peripheral, and subsequent registration on the hub server. This method uses Procedure: Generating token on the peripheral server and Procedure: Registering to the hub server with the token.
2. by direct registration from the hub, without any user interactions with the peripheral server. This method is described in Procedure: Direct registering from the hub server.



In any case, if the peripheral host should be managed by the hub, you must first bootstrap the host as a minion to the hub before proceeding with the registration of the peripheral server. If the bootstrapping happens later, two systems are shown in the systems list.

4.3.1.2.1. Registration from peripheral server by token generation

Before being registered to the hub server, a token needs to be generated on the peripheral server and passed to the administrator of the hub server.

Procedure: Generating token on the peripheral server

1. On the peripheral server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Access Tokens**.
2. Click button **[Add token]** and select option Issue new token.
3. In the field Server FQDN on the form that opens type the FQDN of the hub server that will be using this token.

4. Click **[Issue]**.
5. A new form with the successfully generated token appears and button **[Copy]**.



The only time token is displayed is at the time of its creation. Save it in a safe place until it is later needed.

6. Once generated, the token appears on the screen Access Tokens.

The generated token needs to be transferred to the hub server before it can be used.

Procedure: Registering to the hub server with the token

1. On the hub server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Click button **[Add peripheral]**. A new form Register a new peripheral server opens.
3. In the field Peripheral Server FQDN enter the name of the peripheral server.
4. In the field Registration mode select option Existing token.
5. In the field Token paste the token that was created on the peripheral server.
6. In the field Root CA certificate specify the certificate using one of the options:
   - Use option Not needed if both hub and peripheral servers have the same certificate authority.
   - Use option Upload a file if the servers have different certificate authorities to upload a certificate file.
   - Use option Paste a PEM certificate to paste a certificate.
7. Click button **[Register]**. A newly registered peripheral server will appear on screen Peripherals Configuration.

4.3.1.2.2. Registration from the hub server directly

It is possible to initiate the registration of a peripheral server from hub server, without any interaction with the peripheral server.

Procedure: Direct registering from the hub server

1. On the hub server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Click button **[Add peripheral]**. A new form Register a new peripheral server opens.
3. In the field Peripheral Server FQDN enter the name of the peripheral server.
4. In the field Registration mode select option Administrator User/Password.
5. In the fields Username and Password enter the credentials for the peripheral server.



The credentials must be those of SUSE Manager Administrator of the peripheral server.

6. In the field Root CA certificate specify the certificate using one of the options:
   - Use option Not needed if both hub and peripheral servers have the same certificate authority.
   - Use option Upload a file if the servers have different certificate authorities to upload a certificate file.
   - Use option Paste a PEM certificate in cases when PEM certificate is used.
7. Click button **[Register]**.
8. The newly registered peripheral server will be shown in the **Systems › System List** with the value Foreign in the column System Type.

9. To access its details, click on the peripheral server's name and select tab **Details › Peripheral Server**.

Peripheral server uses hub to access the vendor channels and does not connect to the SUSE Customer Center directly. Therefore, if you open configured peripheral server's page **Admin › Setup Wizard › Organization Credentials**, **Admin › Setup Wizard › Products** or **Admin › Setup Wizard › PAYG Connections**, you will see a notification that this is peripheral server and its connections are managed via hub.

4.3.1.2.3. Migrating from previous ISS versions

If you have peripheral servers that were previously configured using legacy Inter-Server Synchronization versions (ISS v1 or ISS v2), you can migrate them to Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) directly from the WebUI.



The Uyuni Hub reporting database and Hub XML-RPC API rely entirely on a valid and active Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) registration to function. After any Hub upgrade or migration, ensure that all peripheral servers are successfully migrated or registered under ISS v3.

Migrating from ISS v1

Procedure: Migrating from ISS v1

1. On the Hub server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Click the **[Migrate]** dropdown button and select option Migrate ISS v1....
3. The page displays a table of detected ISS v1 peripheral servers. Select the servers you want to migrate.
4. In the Token field for each selected server, enter the access token generated on that peripheral server.
5. Specify the root CA certificate using one of the options (for example, select Not needed if both servers share the same CA).
6. Click **[Migrate]**. Once successfully completed, the migrated servers will appear in the Peripherals Configuration list.

Migrating from ISS v2

Since ISS v2 is a manual, file-based mechanism, you must specify the peripheral server details manually during migration.

Procedure: Migrating from ISS v2

1. On the Hub server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Click the **[Migrate]** dropdown button and select option Migrate ISS v2....
3. Click **[Add Server]**.
4. In the modal dialog that opens, enter the Server FQDN of the remote peripheral server and click **[Save]**.
5. In the Token field, enter the access token generated on that peripheral server.
6. Specify the root CA certificate using one of the options (for example, upload or paste the PEM certificate).
7. Click **[Migrate]**. Once successfully completed, the migrated servers will appear in the Peripherals Configuration list.

4.3.1.2.4. Access tokens

All existing tokens are shown in **Admin › Hub Configuration › Access Tokens**.

A token can viewed as Consumed and Issued, both from the perspective of the peripheral and the hub server.

- From the perspective of the peripheral server:

  Consumed

  The `Consumed` token is generated on the peripheral server and received by the hub server to be used.

  Issued

  The Issued token is issued by the hub server to be used by the peripheral server.

- From the perspective of the hub server:

Consumed

The `Consumed` token is generated on the hub server and received by the peripheral server to be used.

Issued

The Issued token is issued by the peripheral server to be used by the hub server.

Token operations

A token can be invalidated, or deleted.

Be careful when using option **[Invalidate]** as it no longer grants access to the other server. This operation ensures that no communication will happen until a new token is generated if the existing one is compromised, or until the current token is reactivated. Invalidated token can be made valid again at any time.

It is possible to delete a token. Deleting is only possible when the server associated with the token is not registered as hub or peripheral. This operation cannot be undone.

4.3.1.3. Access hub server details from the peripheral server

Every peripheral server stores the information about its hub server.



A peripheral server can only have one hub server configured.

Procedure: Accessing hub server details

1. On the peripheral server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Hub Details**.
2. On the screen Hub Details find the information about the hub server.
    a. Field Hub server FQDN shows the hub server's FQDN.
    b. Field Registration date shows the time when the peripheral server was registered to the hub server.
    c. Field Last modified shows the time of the last saved configuration change.
    d. Field Root Certificate Authority shows certificate details. To download, edit or delete the root certificate, clicking **[Download]**, **[Edit]** or **[Delete]** respectively. Deleting the certificate will break the connection between servers.

e. Field GPG Public Key shows whether the GPG key has been configured for the hub server. For more information about GPG keys between hub and peripheral servers, see GPG key usage with hub online synchronization.

f. Field Mirror credentials is the username the peripheral server uses when connecting to the hub server to synchronize vendor channels. This username is generated automatically on the hub server, and then transmitted to the peripheral server during the registration phase.

4.3.1.3.1. GPG key usage with hub online synchronization

When the metadata on the hub server are signed with a GPG key, the public key is automatically transmitted from hub to peripheral server.

By default, Uyuni is not signing metadata. Therefore, when the peripheral server is downloading data from the hub server there is no way of checking if the downloaded metadata have a valid signature, unless the customer has created their own GPG key.

To enable checking of the data integrity, the GPG key needs to be created on the hub. When the peripheral server is configured to communicate with the hub, the public GPG key will then automatically be transferred to it.

When the GPG key is created on the hub, field GPG Public Key will be set to show that this server is using the GPG key. For more information about setting up own GPG key, see **Administration Guide › Repo Metadata**.

4.3.1.4. Access peripheral server details from the hub server

On the hub server, the **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration** page displays the information about all the peripheral servers currently registered.

Table 3. Peripheral servers list columns

Column	Description
Peripheral FQDN	Fully qualified domain name of the peripheral server.
N. of synced channels	Number of the channels currently synchronized from the hub to this peripheral.
N. of synced organizations	Number of peripheral organization currently owning the synchronized channels.

Column	Description
Download Root CA	Action to download the current root certificate authority, if different from the one used by the hub
Delete	Action to deregister the peripheral server

Procedure: Accessing the details of a peripheral server

1. On the hub server, go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Find the perpheral server on the list
3. Click the fully qualified domain name of the peripheral server to access its details.
4. On the screen Peripheral Details .
    a. Field Peripheral server FQDN shows the peripheral server's FQDN.
    b. Field Registration date shows the time when the peripheral server was registered to the hub server.
    c. Field Last modified shows the time of the last saved configuration change.
    d. Field Root Certificate Authority shows certificate details. To download, edit or delete the root certificate, respectively click **[Download]**, **[Edit]** or **[Delete]**. Deleting the certificate will break the connection between servers.
    e. Field Mirror credentials is the username the peripheral server uses when connecting to the hub server to synchronize vendor channels. This username is generated automatically on the hub server, and then transmitted to the peripheral server during the registration phase. To generate new credentials, click **[Regenerate Credentials]**. This action will create a new password and transmit it securely to the peripheral server.
    f. Field Synchronized channels shows the number of currently synchronized channels and organization.

4.3.1.4.1. Synchronize channels from hub to peripheral server

Synchronizing vendor channels for the configured hub and server is done via dedicated user interface.

Procedure: Synchronizing channels from hub to peripheral server

1. Go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripherals Configuration**.
2. Find the perpheral server on the list
3. Click the fully qualified domain name of the peripheral server to access its details.
4. In the field Synchronized channels click on **[Edit channels]**.
5. Page Sync Channels from Hub to Peripheral opens.
6. Select the channels you want to synchronize.
7. For custom channels also select the target organization on the peripheral from the dropdown.

   > The drop-down list exists only for custom channels which do not yet exist on the peripheral server. If the channel exists, the organization stays unchanged.

8. Click **[Apply Changes]** to view the summary of your changes.
9. A pop-up window with the summary of your selections will open.
10. Click **[Confirm]** to confirm the selection.

Following the confirmation, the channels will be created on the peripheral server and everything will be set up to mirror the channels during the next regular repository synchronization task.

The repository synchronization can be initated from the peripheral server.

Procedure: Initiating repository synchronization from the peripheral server

1. Go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Hub Details**.
2. Find the perpheral server on the list

3. Click the fully qualified domain name of the peripheral server to access its details.
4. Click **[Sync Channels]**.
5. Confirm the operation by clicking **[Schedule]** on the pop-up window.

The full channel synchronization will start in the background.

4.3.1.5. Deregister peripheral server

Deregistration can happen from both sides, from the hub or from the peripheral server.

Procedure: Deregistering from the peripheral server

1. Go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Hub Details**.
2. Click **[Deregister]**.
3. Confirm the operation by clicking **[Deregister]** on the pop-up window.
4. Page **Admin › Hub Configuration › Hub Details** is now empty.

Procedure: Deregistering from the hub server

1. Go to **Admin › Hub Configuration › Peripheral Configuration**.
2. Find the perpheral server on the list.
3. Click **[Deregister]** next to the peripheral server's name.
4. The peripheral server is no longer shown on the list.

4.3.2. Using the Hub XMLRPC API

The Hub XMLRPC API allows you to perform operations across multiple peripheral servers from a single endpoint. The Hub connects to these peripheral servers using the connection details established via **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Online Synchronization**. Ensure that your peripheral servers are correctly registered to the hub before attempting to use the XMLRPC API.



The Hub XMLRPC API depends entirely on a valid and active Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) registration to communicate with and execute operations on peripheral servers. During any Hub upgrade or migration, ensure that all peripheral servers are successfully migrated or registered under Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) for XMLRPC operations

to continue working.

When XMLRPC API is running, connect to it through server FQDN at the location /hub/rpc/api using any XMLRPC-compliant client libraries. For examples, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Auth**.

Logs are saved in /var/log/hub/hub-xmlrpc-api.log. Logs are rotated weekly, or when the log file size reaches the specified limit. By default, the log file size limit is 10 MB.

4.3.2.1. Hub XMLRPC API Namespaces

The Hub XMLRPC API operates in a similar way to the Uyuni API. For Uyuni API documentation, see https://documentation.suse.com/multi-linux-manager/2026.10/api/docs/index.html.

The Hub XMLRPC API exposes the same methods that are available from the server's XMLRPC API, with a few differences in parameter and return types. Additionally, the Hub XMLRPC API supports some Hub-specific end points which are not available in the Uyuni API.

The Hub XMLRPC API supports three different namespaces:

- The hub namespace is used to target the Hub XMLRPC API Server. It supports Hub-specific XMLRPC endpoints which are primarily related to authentication.
- The unicast namespace is used to target a single server registered in the hub. It redirects any call transparently to one specific server and returns any value as if the server's XMLRPC API endpoint was used directly.
- The multicast namespace is used to target multiple peripheral servers registered in the hub. It redirects any call transparently to all the specified servers and returns the results in the form of a map.
- If you do not specify a namespace, all calls are transparently redirected to the underlying Uyuni Server XMLRPC API of the Hub Server. This allows you to call all available methods on the Uyuni Server XMLRPC API.

Methods called without specifying any of the above namespaces will be forwarded to the normal XMLRPC API of the hub. This is the API exposed on ports 80 and 443.

Some important considerations for hub namespaces:

- Individual server IDs can be obtained using client.hub.listServerIds(hubSessionKey).
- The unicast namespace assumes all methods receive hubSessionKey and serverID as their first two parameters, then any other parameter as specified by the regular Server API.

```
client.unicast.[namespace].[methodName](hubSessionKey, serverId, param1, param2)
```

- The hubSessionKey can be obtained using different authentication methods. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Auth**.
- The multicast namespace assumes all methods receive hubSessionKey, a list of ServerID values, then lists of per-server parameters as specified by the regular server XMLRPC API. The return value is a map, with Successful and Failed entries for each server involved in the call.

```
client.multicast.[namespace].[methodname](hubSessionKey, [serverId1, serverId2],
[param1_s1, param1_s2], [param2_s1, param2_s2])
```

4.3.2.2. Hub XMLRPC API Authentication Modes

The Hub XMLRPC API supports three different authentication modes:

- Manual mode (default): API credentials must be explicitly provided for each server.
- Relay mode: the credentials used to authenticate with the Hub are also used to authenticate to each server. You must provide a list of servers to connect to.
- Auto-connect mode: credentials are reused for each server, and any peripheral server you have access to is automatically connected.

4.3.2.2.1. Authentication Examples

This section provides examples of each authentication method.

Manual authentication

In manual mode, credentials have to be explicitly provided for each peripheral server before you can connect to it.

Procedure: Using manual authentication

1. Credentials for the Hub are passed to the login method, and a session key for the Hub is returned (hubSessionKey).
2. Using the session key from the previous step, Uyuni Server IDs are obtained for all the peripheral servers attached to the Hub via the hub.listServerIds method.
3. Credentials for each peripheral server are provided to the attachToServers method. This performs authentication against each server's XMLRPC API endpoint.

4. A multicast call is performed on a set of servers. This is defined by serverIds, which contains the IDs of the servers to target. In the background, system.list_system is called on each server's XMLRPC API
5. Hub aggregates the results and returns the response in the form of a map. The map has two entries:
    - Successful: list of responses for those peripheral servers where the call succeeded.
    - Failed: list of responses for those peripheral servers where the call failed.



If you want to call a method on just one Uyuni Server, then Hub API also provides a unicast namespace. In this case, the response will be a single value and not a map, in the same way as if you called that Uyuni server's API directly.

Listing 10. Example: Python script for manual authentication

```
#!/usr/bin/python3
import xmlrpc.client

HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL = "https://<SERVER_FQDN>/hub/rpc/api"
HUB_USERNAME = "<USERNAME>"
HUB_PASSWORD = "<PASSWORD>"

client = xmlrpc.client.ServerProxy(HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL, verbose=0)

hubSessionKey = client.hub.login(HUB_USERNAME, HUB_PASSWORD)

# Get the server IDs
serverIds = client.hub.listServerIds(hubSessionKey)

# For simplicity, this example assumes you are using the same username and password here,
as on the hub server.
# However, in most cases, every server has its own individual credentials.
usernames = [HUB_USERNAME for s in serverIds]
passwords = [HUB_PASSWORD for s in serverIds]

# Each server uses the credentials set above, client.hub.attachToServers needs
# them passed as lists with as many elements as there are servers.
client.hub.attachToServers(hubSessionKey, serverIds, usernames, passwords)

# Perform the operation
systemsPerServer = client.multicast.system.list_systems(hubSessionKey, serverIds)
successfulResponses = systemsPerServer["Successful"]["Responses"]
failedResponses = systemsPerServer["Failed"]["Responses"]

for system in successfulResponses:
  print(system)

# Log out
client.hub.logout(hubSessionKey)
```

Relay authentication

In relay authentication mode, the credentials used to sign in to the Hub API are also used to sign in into the APIs of the peripheral servers the user wants to work with. In this authentication mode, it is assumed that the same credentials are valid for every server, and that they correspond to a user with appropriate permissions.

After signing in, you must call the attachToServers method. This method defines the servers to target in all subsequent calls.

Procedure: Using relay authentication

1. Credentials for the Hub are passed to the loginWithAuthRelayMode method, and a session key for the Hub is returned (hubSessionKey).
2. Using the session key from the previous step, Uyuni Server IDs are obtained for all the peripheral servers attached to the Hub via the hub.listServerIds method
3. A call to attachToServers is made, and the same credentials used to sign in to the Hub are passed to each server. This performs authentication against each server's XMLRPC API endpoint.
4. A multicast call is performed on a set of servers. This is defined by serverIds, which contains the IDs of the servers to target. In the background, system.list_system is called on each server's XMLRPC API.
5. Hub aggregates the results and returns the response in the form of a map. The map has two entries:
    - Successful: list of responses for those peripheral servers where the call succeeded.
    - Failed: list of responses for those peripheral servers the call failed.

Listing 11. Example: Python script for relay authentication

```
#!/usr/bin/python3
import xmlrpc.client

HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL = "https://<SERVER_FQDN>/hub/rpc/api"
HUB_USERNAME = "<USERNAME>"
HUB_PASSWORD = "<PASSWORD>"

client = xmlrpc.client.ServerProxy(HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL, verbose=0)
```

```
hubSessionKey = client.hub.loginWithAuthRelayMode(HUB_USERNAME, HUB_PASSWORD)

# Get the server IDs
serverIds = client.hub.listServerIds(hubSessionKey)

# Authenticate those servers(same credentials will be used as of hub to authenticate)
client.hub.attachToServers(hubSessionKey, serverIds)

# Perform the needed operation
systemsPerServer = client.multicast.system.list_systems(hubSessionKey, serverIds)
successfulResponses = systemsPerServer["Successful"]["Responses"]
failedResponses = systemsPerServer["Failed"]["Responses"]

for system in successfulResponses:
  print(system)

# Log out
client.hub.logout(hubSessionKey)
```

Auto-connect authentication

Auto-connect mode is similar to relay mode, it uses the Hub credentials to sign in to all peripheral servers. However, there is no need to use the attachToServers method, as auto-connect mode connects to all available peripheral servers. This occurs at the same time as you sign in to the Hub.

Procedure: Using auto-connect authentication

1. Credentials for the Hub are passed to the loginWithAutoconnectMode method, and a session key for the Hub is returned (hubSessionKey).
2. A multicast call is performed on a set of servers. This is defined by serverIds, which contains the IDs of the servers to target. In the background, system.list_system is called on each server's XMLRPC API.
3. Hub aggregates the results and returns the response in the form of a map. The map has two entries:
   - Successful: list of responses for those peripheral servers where the call succeeded.
   - Failed: list of responses for those peripheral servers where the call failed.

Listing 12. Example: Python script for auto-connect authentication

```
#!/usr/bin/python3
import xmlrpc.client

HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL = "https://<SERVER_FQDN>/hub/rpc/api"
HUB_USERNAME = "<USERNAME>"
```

```
HUB_PASSWORD = "<PASSWORD>"

client = xmlrpc.client.ServerProxy(HUB_XMLRPC_API_URL, verbose=0)

loginResponse = client.hub.loginWithAutoconnectMode(HUB_USERNAME, HUB_PASSWORD)
hubSessionKey = loginResponse["SessionKey"]

# Get the server IDs
serverIds = client.hub.listServerIds(hubSessionKey)

# Perform the needed operation
systemsPerServer = client.multicast.system.list_systems(hubSessionKey, serverIds)
successfulResponses = systemsPerServer["Successful"]["Responses"]
failedResponses = systemsPerServer["Failed"]["Responses"]

for system in successfulResponses:
  print(system)

# Log out
client.hub.logout(hubSessionKey)
```

4.3.3. Hub Reporting

Hub Reporting extends the **Administration Guide › Reporting Database** feature by aggregating reporting data from all connected peripheral Uyuni servers into a single central reporting database on the Hub.

For general reporting database setup, user creation, schema documentation, and Grafana dashboard integration, see **Administration Guide › Reporting Database**.

4.3.3.1. Hub architecture

In a hub deployment:

- the reporting database in the Uyuni Hub stores, collects, and aggregates data coming from the reporting databases of all peripheral servers,
- the reporting database in the Uyuni Hub also stores its own data from systems directly connected to and managed by the Hub,
- the reporting database on each peripheral Uyuni server stores only its own data,
- external reporting tools can connect to either the Hub or any peripheral Uyuni server.



The connection between hub and peripheral servers is established via hub online synchronization. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Online Sync**.

Hub Reporting and central Report DB aggregation depend entirely on active Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) registration. During any Hub upgrade or migration, ensure that all peripheral servers are successfully migrated or registered under Hub Online Synchronization (ISS v3) for reporting data aggregation to continue working.

4.3.3.2. Enable reporting dashboards in Grafana

To make hub reporting dashboards available in Grafana, the reporting database data source must be enabled in the Grafana formula on the monitoring server.

Procedure: Enabling reporting dashboards in Grafana

1. Navigate to **Systems › (monitoring server) › Formulas › Grafana**.
2. Expand Datasources > Report database.
3. Check Enable Reporting Dashboards.
4. Click button Save Formula.
5. Apply the highstate.

4.3.3.3. Hub data aggregation

The update-reporting-hub-default schedule fetches and aggregates reporting data from all registered peripheral servers. For a description of both taskomatic reporting schedules, see **Administration Guide › Reporting Database**.

If peripheral servers are in different timezones, align all update-reporting-default schedules so that every peripheral server has finished its local job before update-reporting-hub-default runs on the Hub.

4.3.3.4. Tuning

4.3.3.4.1. report_db_hub_workers

Description	The maximum number of workers requesting data from peripheral servers on a hub at the same point in time.
Tune when	The number of peripheral servers increases significantly (more than 100), or a faster synchronization is required.
Value default	2
Value recommendation	2 - 10
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf

Example	report_db_hub_workers = 5
After changing	Monitor memory and CPU usage of the hub closely before and after the change. Also monitor the load, CPU and memory usage of the reporting database of the hub.
Notes	All the data collected from the peripheral server must be written into the hub reporting database. Tuning that database could increase the performance as well.

For the report_db_batch_size tuning parameter, which applies to all servers including the hub, see **Administration Guide › Reporting Database › Reportdb Batch Size**.

4.3.4. Hub deployment



The connection between hub and peripheral servers is now primarily established using **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Online Synchronization**. This chapter describes an optional but recommended best practice to use the same CA for all servers.

You can deploy a hub environment either with third party certificates or with self-generated certificates.

4.3.4.1. With third party certificates

Prepare third party certificates for both the Hub Server and the Peripheral servers first.

4.3.4.1.1. Hub server installation

Procedure: Installing the Hub Server

1. Install a container host with SL Micro. For more information about SL Micro as a container host, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Container Deployment › Server Deployment Mlm › Deploy Mlm Server Micro**.
2. On the container host, deploy Uyuni as the hub server using the third party certificate. Add --hubxmlrpc-replicas 1 to the mgradm install command line. For example:

```
mgradm install --ssl-ca-root CA-Certificate.crt --ssl-server-cert hub.crt --ssl
-server-key hub.key --ssl-db-ca-root CA-Certificate.crt --ssl-db-cert hud-
db.crt --ssl-db-key hub-db.key --hubxmlrpc-replicas 1
```

For more information about deploying with mgradm, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Container Deployment › Server Deployment Mlm › Deploy Mlm Server Mgradm**.

4.3.4.1.2. Peripheral servers

Procedure: Installing peripheral servers using third party certificates

1. Preliminary Requirement: A certificate for every peripheral server and its database (for example, server.crt) and a key (for example, server.key).
2. Preliminary Requirement: CA Certificate.
3. Preliminary Requirement: Hub server installation. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Install › Lsd Hub Install 3rd Hub**.
    - On every peripheral server host, copy the same CA to /etc/pki/trust/anchors/ and run update-ca-certificates.
    - On every peripheral server host, install Uyuni using the following command (replace appropriately the names of the certificates):

```
mgradm install --ssl-ca-root CA-Certificate.crt --ssl-server-cert server.crt
--ssl-server-key server.key --ssl-db-ca-root CA-Certificate.crt --ssl-db-cert
db.crt --ssl-db-key db.key
```

4.3.4.2. With self-generated certificates

4.3.4.2.1. Hub server installation

Procedure: Installing the hub server

1. Install a container host with SL Micro. For more information about SL Micro as a container host, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Container Deployment › Server Deployment Mlm › Deploy Mlm Server Micro**.
2. On the container host, deploy Uyuni as the hub server. Add --hubxmlrpc-replicas 1 to the mgradm install command line. For example:

```
mgradm install MLM.example.com --hubxmlrpc-replicas 1
```

For more information about deploying with mgradm, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Container Deployment › Server Deployment Mlm › Deploy Mlm Server Mgradm**.

4.3.4.2.2. Peripheral servers

Procedure: Peripheral servers with self-generated certificates

1. Preliminary Requirement: Hub server installation. For more information, see **Specialized Guides › Large Deployments › Hub Install › Lsd Hub Install Self Hub**.
2. On the container host of the hub server, enter the server container with:

```
mgrctl term
```

3. Inside the container, run rhn-ssl-tool for every peripheral server:

```
rhn-ssl-tool --gen-server --dir="/root/ssl-build" --set-country="COUNTRY" \
  --set-state="STATE" --set-city="CITY" --set-org="ORGANIZATION" \
  --set-org-unit="ORGANIZATION UNIT" --set-email="name@example.com" \
  --set-hostname=PERIPHAL-FQDN
```

4. For every peripheral server:
   - From the hub server container, copy /root/ssl-build/RHN-ORG-TRUSTED-SSL-CERT, /root/ssl-build/<hostname>/server.crt and /root/ssl-build/<hostname>/server.key to the peripheral server host.
   - On every peripheral server host, copy RHN-ORG-TRUSTED-SSL-CERT to /etc/pki/trust/anchors/, and run update-ca-certificates.
   - On every peripheral server host, deploy Uyuni with:

```
mgradm install --ssl-ca-root RHN-ORG-TRUSTED-SSL-CERT --ssl-server-cert
server.crt --ssl-server-key server.key --ssl-db-ca-root RHN-ORG-TRUSTED-SSL-
CERT --ssl-db-cert server.crt --ssl-db-key server.key
```

4.3.4.3. Background information

Checking the following hub configuration settings is optional.

On the container host, find environment variables in /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-hub-xmlrpc.service generated by mgradm. If needed, you can customize these variables with Environment=` settings in a user

created `/etc/systemd/system/uyuni-hub-xmlrpc.service.d/local.conf systemd configuration file on the container host.

It will override settings in /etc/hub/hub.conf inside the server container. It is the same file for all containers.

- HUB_API_URL: URL to the Hub Server XMLRPC API endpoint. Use the default value if you are installing hub-xmlrpc-api on the Hub Server. It is set automatically in the systemd unit file during the installation.
- HUB_CONNECT_TIMEOUT: the maximum number of seconds to wait for a response when connecting to a Server. Use the default value in most cases.
- HUB_REQUEST_TIMEOUT: the maximum number of seconds to wait for a response when calling a Server method. Use the default value in most cases.
- HUB_CONNECT_USING_SSL: use HTTPS instead of HTTP for communicating with peripheral Servers. Recommended for a secure environment. It is always enabled.

4.3.5. Inter-Server Synchronization version 2

If you have more than one Uyuni installation, you will need to copy contents between servers. Inter-Server Synchronization (ISS) allows you to export data from one server (hub) and import it on another server (peripheral). This is useful for hub deployment scenarios or disconnected setups.

4.3.5.1. Install Inter-Server Synchronization packages

To use ISS you need to install the inter-server-sync package on hub and peripheral servers.

4.3.5.2. Content synchronization



Use mgrctl term before running steps inside the server container.

Procedure: Export data on source server

1. At the command prompt of the Uyuni container host of the hub server, as root, enter the server container:

```
mgrctl term
```

2. Inside the container, execute the following steps:

   a. Execute the ISS export command. The -h option provides detailed help:

```
inter-server-sync export -h
```

The export procedure creates an output directory with all the needed data for the import procedure.



To avoid data loss or filling up the container file system, store the data on a persistent volume (preferably /var/spacewalk). For more information about persistent volumes, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Hardware Requirements › Server Hardware Requirements**.

Procedure: Copy export directory to peripheral server

1. Contents from the hub server needs to be synchronized to the peripheral server. At the command prompt of the Uyuni container host of the hub server, as root, enter the server container:

```
mgrctl term
```

2. Inside the container, execute the following steps:

    a. Synchronize to the peripheral server:

```
rsync -r <PATH_EXPORTED_DIR> root@<PERIPHERAL_SERVER>:~/
```

When all contents is copied, start importing it.

Procedure: Import data on peripheral server

1. At the command prompt of the Uyuni container host of the peripheral server, as root, enter the server container:

```
mgrctl term
```

2. Inside the container, execute the following steps:

    a. Execute the ISS import command. The -h option provides detailed help:

```
inter-server-sync import -h
```

4.3.5.3. Database connection configuration

Database connection configuration is loaded by default from /etc/rhn/rhn.conf. Properties file location can be overridden with parameter --serverConfig.

4.3.5.4. Known limitations

- Hub and peripheral servers need to be on the same version.
- Export and import organization should have exactly the same name. The organization name is case sensitive.

4.4. Managing Large Scale Deployments in a Retail Environment

Uyuni for Retail 2026.10 is an open source infrastructure management solution, optimized and tailored specifically for the retail industry. It uses the same technology as SUSE Multi-Linux Manager, but is customized to address the needs of retail organizations.

Uyuni for Retail is designed for use in retail situations where customers can use point-of-service terminals to purchase or exchange goods, take part in promotions, or collect loyalty points. In addition to retail installations, it can also be used for novel purposes, such as maintaining student computers in an educational environment, or self-service kiosks in banks or hospitals.

Uyuni for Retail is intended for use in installations that include servers, workstations, point-of-service terminals, and other devices. It allows administrators to install, configure, and update the software on their servers, and manage the deployment and provisioning of point-of-service machines.

Point-of-Service (POS) terminals can come in many different formats, such as point-of-sale terminals, kiosks, digital scales, self-service systems, and reverse-vending systems. Every terminal, however, is provided by a vendor, who set basic information about the device in the firmware. Uyuni for Retail accesses this vendor information to determine how best to work with the terminal in use.

In most cases, different terminals will require a different operating system (OS) image to ensure they work correctly. For example, an information kiosk has a high-resolution touchscreen, where a cashier terminal might only have a very basic display. While both of these terminals require similar processing and network functionality, they will require different OS images. The OS images ensure that the different display mechanisms work correctly.

For more information about setting up and using Uyuni for Retail, see **Retail Guide › Uyuni Retail Overview**.

4.5. Tuning Large Scale Deployments

Uyuni is designed by default to work on small and medium scale installations. For installations with more than 1000 clients per Uyuni Server, adequate hardware sizing and parameter tuning must be performed.



The instructions in this section can have severe and catastrophic performance impacts when improperly used. In some cases, they can cause Uyuni to completely cease functioning. Always test changes before implementing them in a production environment. During implementation, take care when changing parameters. Monitor performance before and after each change, and revert any steps that do not produce the expected result.



Tuning is not required on installations of fewer than 1000 clients. Do not perform these instructions on small or medium scale installations.

4.5.1. The Tuning Process

Any Uyuni installation is subject to a number of design and infrastructure constraints that, for the purposes of tuning, we call environmental variables. Environmental variables can include the total number of clients, the number of different operating systems under management, and the number of software channels.

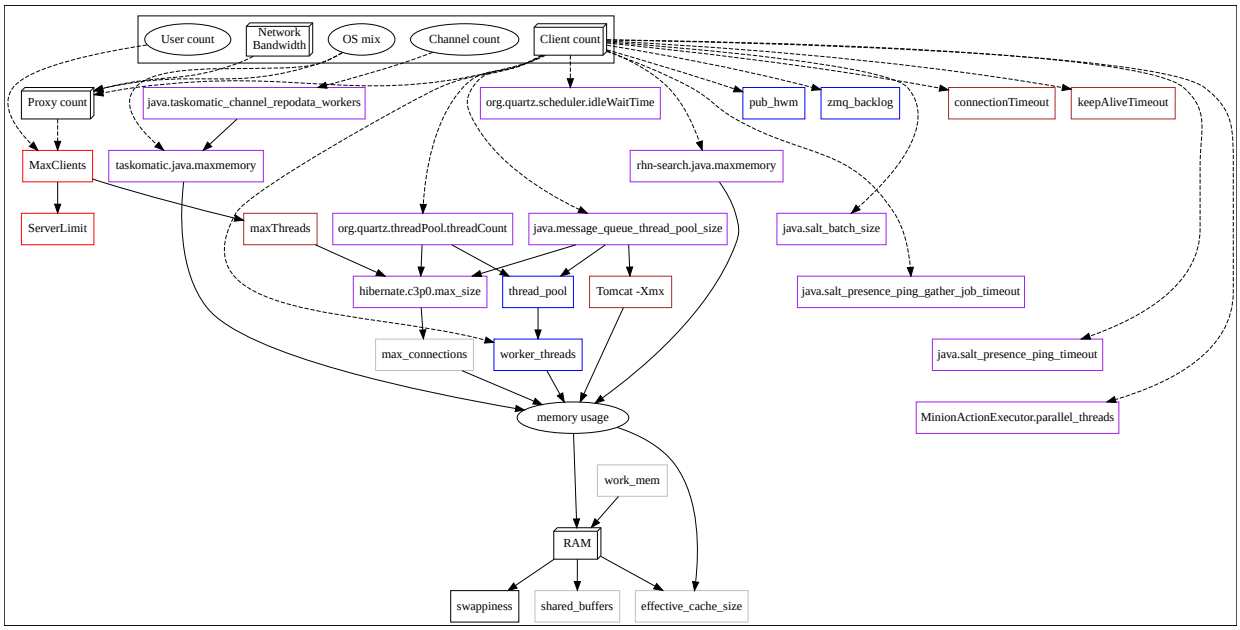
Environmental variables influence, either directly or indirectly, the value of most configuration parameters. During the tuning process, the configuration parameters are manipulated to improve system performance.

Before you begin tuning, you will need to estimate the best setting for each environment variable, and adjust the configuration parameters to suit.

To help you with the estimation process, we have provided you with a dependency graph. Locate the environmental variables on the dependency graph to determine how they will influence other variables and parameters.

Environmental variables are represented by graph nodes in a rectangle at the top of the dependency graph. Each node is connected to the relevant parameters that might need tuning. Consult the relevant sections in this document for more information about recommended values.

Tuning one parameter might require tuning other parameters, or changing hardware, or the infrastructure. When you change a parameter, follow the arrows from that node on the graph to determine what other parameters might need adjustment. Continue through each parameter until you have visited all nodes on the graph.



Key to the Dependency Graph

- 3D boxes are hardware design variables or constraints

- Oval-shaped boxes are software or system design variables or constraints
- Rectangle-shaped boxes are configurable parameters, color-coded by configuration file:
  - Red: Apache httpd configuration files
  - Blue: Salt configuration files
  - Brown: Tomcat configuration files
  - Grey: PostgreSQL configuration files
  - Purple: /etc/rhn/rhn.conf
- Dashed connecting lines indicate a variable or constraint that might require a change to another parameter
- Solid connecting lines indicate that changing a configuration parameter requires checking another one to prevent issues

After the initial tuning has been completed, you will need to consider tuning again in these cases:

- If your tuning inputs change significantly
- If special conditions arise that require a certain parameter to be changed. For example, if specific warnings appear in a log file.
- If performance is not satisfactory

To re-tune your installation, you will need to use the dependency graph again. Start from the node where significant change has happened.

4.5.2. Environmental Variables

This section contains information about environmental variables (inputs to the tuning process).

Network Bandwidth

A measure of the typically available egress bandwith from the Uyuni Server host to the clients or Uyuni Proxy hosts. This should take into account network hardware and topology as well as possible capacity limits on switches, routers, and other network equipment between the server and clients.

Channel count

The number of expected channels to manage. Includes any vendor-provided, third-party, and cloned or staged channels.

Client count

The total number of actual or expected clients. It is important to tune any parameters in advance of a client count increase, whenever possible.

OS mix

The number of distinct operating system versions that managed clients have installed. This is ordered by family (SUSE Linux Enterprise, openSUSE, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, or Ubuntu based). Storage and computing requirements are different in each case.

User count

The expected maximum amount of concurrent users interacting with the Web UI plus the number of programs simultaneously using the XMLRPC API. Includes spacecmd, spacewalk-clone-by-date, and similar.

4.5.3. Parameters

This section contains information about the available parameters.

4.5.3.1. MaxRequestWorkers

Description	The maximum number of HTTP requests served simultaneously by Apache httpd. Proxies, Web UI, and XMLRPC API clients each consume one. Requests exceeding the parameter will be queued and might result in timeouts.
Tune when	User count and proxy count increase significantly and this line appears in /var/log/apache2/error_log: [...] [mpm_prefork:error] [pid ...] AH00161: server reached MaxRequestWorkers setting, consider raising the MaxRequestWorkers setting. MaxRequestWorkers should not exceed maxThreads + acceptCount (default acceptCount=100). Beyond that, Tomcat refuses new connections instead of queuing them.
Value default	150
Value recommendation	150-500
Location	/etc/apache2/server-tuning.conf, in the prefork.c section
Example	MaxRequestWorkers = 200
After changing	Immediately change ServerLimit and check maxThreads for possible adjustment.

Notes	This parameter was renamed to MaxRequestWorkers, both names are valid.
More information	https://httpd.apache.org/docs/2.4/en/mod/mpm_common.html#maxrequestworkers

4.5.3.2. ServerLimit

Description	The number of Apache httpd processes serving HTTP requests simultaneously. The number must equal MaxRequestWorkers.
Tune when	MaxRequestWorkers changes
Value default	150
Value recommendation	The same value as MaxRequestWorkers
Location	/etc/apache2/server-tuning.conf, in the prefork.c section
Example	ServerLimit = 200
More information	https://httpd.apache.org/docs/2.4/en/mod/mpm_common.html#serverlimit

4.5.3.3. maxThreads

Description	The number of Tomcat threads dedicated to serving HTTP requests
Tune when	MaxRequestWorkers changes. maxThreads should be less or equal to MaxRequestWorkers to fully utilize the tomcat.
Value default	150
Value recommendation	The same value as MaxRequestWorkers
Location	/etc/tomcat/server.xml
Example	<Connector port="8009" protocol="AJP/1.3" redirectPort="8443" URIEncoding="UTF-8" address="127.0.0.1" maxThreads="200" connectionTimeout="20000"/>

More information	https://tomcat.apache.org/tomcat-9.0-doc/config/http.html

4.5.3.4. LimitRequestBody

Description	This parameter specifies the number of bytes that are allowed in a request body. A value of 0 means unlimited.
Tune when	When following message appears in the logs: "Request entity too large! The POST method does not allow the data transmitted, or the data volume exceeds the capacity limit."
Value default	1GB
Location	Custom file /etc/apache2/conf.d/maxrequestbody.conf
Example	LimitRequestBody 0

4.5.3.5. connectionTimeout

Description	The number of milliseconds before a non-responding AJP connection is forcibly closed.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly and AH00992, AH00877, and AH01030 errors appear in Apache error logs during a load peak.
Value default	900000
Value recommendation	20000-3600000
Location	/etc/tomcat/server.xml
Example	<Connector port="8009" protocol="AJP/1.3" redirectPort="8443" URIEncoding="UTF-8" address="127.0.0.1" maxThreads="200" connectionTimeout="1000000" keepAliveTimeout="300000"/>
More information	https://tomcat.apache.org/tomcat-9.0-doc/config/http.html

4.5.3.6. keepAliveTimeout

Description	The number of milliseconds without data exchange from the JVM before a non-responding AJP connection is forcibly closed.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly and AH00992, AH00877, and AH01030 errors appear in Apache error logs during a load peak.
Value default	300000
Value recommendation	20000-600000
Location	/etc/tomcat/server.xml
Example	<Connector port="8009" protocol="AJP/1.3" redirectPort="8443" URIEncoding="UTF-8" address="127.0.0.1" maxThreads="200" connectionTimeout="1000000" keepAliveTimeout="400000"/>
More information	https://tomcat.apache.org/tomcat-9.0-doc/config/http.html

4.5.3.7. Tomcat's -Xmx

Description	The maximum amount of memory Tomcat can use
Tune when	java.message_queue_thread_pool_size is increased or OutOfMemoryException errors appear in /var/log/rhn/rhn_web_ui.log
Value default	1 GiB
Value recommendation	4-8 GiB
Location	/etc/tomcat/conf.d/tomcat_java_opts.conf
Example	JAVA_OPTS="... -Xmx8G ..."
After changing	Check memory usage
More information	https://docs.oracle.com/javase/8/docs/technotes/tools/windows/java.html

4.5.3.8. java.disable_list_update_status

Description	Disable displaying the update status for clients of a system group
Tune when	displaying the update status causes timeouts
Value default	false
Value recommendation	
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.disable_list_update_status = true
After changing	?
Notes	
More information	man rhn.conf

4.5.3.9. java.message_queue_thread_pool_size

Description	The maximum number of threads in Tomcat dedicated to asynchronous operations
Tune when	Client count increases significantly
Value default	5
Value recommendation	50 - 150
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.message_queue_thread_pool_size = 50
After changing	Check hibernate.c3p0.max_size, as each thread consumes a PostgreSQL connection, starvation might happen if the allocated connection pool is insufficient. Check thread_pool, as each thread might perform Salt API calls, starvation might happen if the allocated Salt thread pool is insufficient. Check Tomcat's -Xmx, as each thread consumes memory, OutOfMemoryException might be raised if insufficient.

Notes	Incoming Salt events are handled in separate thread pool, see java.salt_event_thread_pool_size
More information	man rhn.conf

4.5.3.10. java.salt_batch_size

Description	The maximum number of minions concurrently executing a scheduled action.
Tune when	Client count reaches several thousands and actions are not executed quickly enough.
Value default	200
Value recommendation	200-500
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.salt_batch_size = 300
After changing	Check memory usage. Monitor memory usage closely before and after the change.
More information	**Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Rate Limiting**

4.5.3.11. java.salt_event_thread_pool_size

Description	The maximum number of threads in Tomcat dedicated to handling of incoming Salt events.
Tune when	The number of queued Salt events grows. Typically, this can happen during onboarding of large number of minions with higher value of java.salt_presence_ping_timeout. The number of events can be queried by ` echo "select count(*) from susesaltevent;" | spacewalk-sql --select-mode-direct - `
Value default	8
Value recommendation	20-100
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.salt_event_thread_pool_size = 50

After changing	Check the length of Salt event queue. Check hibernate.c3p0.max_size, as each thread consumes a PostgreSQL connection, starvation might happen if the allocated connection pool is insufficient. Check thread_pool, as each thread might perform Salt API calls, starvation might happen if the allocated Salt thread pool is insufficient. Check Tomcat's -Xmx, as each thread consumes memory, OutOfMemoryException might be raised if insufficient.
More information	man rhn.conf

4.5.3.12. java.salt_presence_ping_timeout

Description	Before any action is executed on a client, a presence ping is executed to make sure the client is reachable. This parameter sets the amount of time before a second command (in most cases state.apply or any other Salt function) is sent to the client to verify its presence. Having many clients typically means some will respond faster than others, so this timeout could be raised to accommodate for the slower ones.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly, or some clients are responding correctly but too slowly, and Uyuni excludes them from calls. This line appears in /var/log/rhn/rhn_web_ui.log: "Got no result for <COMMAND> on minion <MINION_ID> (minion did not respond in time)"
Value default	4 seconds
Value recommendation	4-20 seconds
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.salt_presence_ping_timeout = 10
After changing	Large java.salt_presence_ping_timeout value can reduce overall throughput. This can be compensated by increasing java.salt_event_thread_pool_size
More information	**Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Timeouts**

4.5.3.13. java.salt_presence_ping_gather_job_timeout

Description	Before any action is executed on a client, a presence ping is executed to make sure the client is reachable. After java.salt_presence_ping_timeout seconds have elapsed without a response, a second command (in most cases state.apply or any other Salt function) is sent to the client and if there is no response from the client for the amount of seconds specified with this parameter one more call (saltutil.find_job) is sent for a final check. This parameter sets the number of seconds after the second command after which the client is definitely considered timeout. Having many clients typically means some will respond faster than others, so this timeout could be raised to accommodate for the slower ones.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly, or some clients are responding correctly but too slowly, and Uyuni excludes them from calls. This line appears in /var/log/rhn/rhn_web_ui.log: "Got no result for <COMMAND> on minion <MINION_ID> (minion did not respond in time)"
Value default	1 second
Value recommendation	1-50 seconds
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.salt_presence_ping_gather_job_timeout = 20
More information	**Specialized Guides › Salt › Salt Timeouts**

4.5.3.14. java.taskomatic_channel_repodata_workers

Description	Whenever content is changed in a software channel, its metadata needs to be recomputed before clients can use it. Channel-altering operations include the addition of a patch, the removal of a package or a repository synchronization run. This parameter specifies the maximum number of Taskomatic threads that Uyuni will use to recompute the channel metadata. Channel metadata computation is both CPU-bound and memory-heavy, so raising this parameter and operating on many channels simultaneously could cause Taskomatic to consume significant resources, but channels will be available to clients sooner.
Tune when	Channel count becomes larger than 50, or more concurrent operations on channels are expected.
Value default	2
Value recommendation	2-10
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	java.taskomatic_channel_repodata_workers = 4
After changing	Check taskomatic.java.maxmemory for adjustment, as every new thread will consume memory
More information	man rhn.conf

4.5.3.15. taskomatic.java.maxmemory

Description	The maximum amount of memory Taskomatic can use. Generation of metadata, especially for some OSs, can be memory-intensive, so this parameter might need raising depending on the managed OS mix.
Tune when	java.taskomatic_channel_repodata_workers increases, OSs are added to Uyuni (particularly Red Hat Enterprise Linux or Ubuntu), or OutOfMemoryException errors appear in /var/log/rhn/rhn_taskomatic_daemon.log.
Value default	4096 MiB

Value recommendation	4096-16384 MiB
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	taskomatic.java.maxmemory = 8192
After changing	Check memory usage.
More information	man rhn.conf

4.5.3.16. org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount

Description	The number of Taskomatic worker threads. Increasing this value allows Taskomatic to serve more clients in parallel.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly
Value default	20
Value recommendation	20-200
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount = 100
After changing	Check hibernate.c3p0.max_size and thread_pool for adjustment
More information	http://www.quartz-scheduler.org/documentation/2.4.0-SNAPSHOT/configuration.html



In containerized Uyuni deployments, insufficient Taskomatic worker threads can cause scheduled system tasks to remain permanently in “pending” state. If you increase this parameter to clear pending tasks, verify that your container environment has adequate CPU limits to handle the additional concurrent task processing. Monitor /var/log/rhn/rhn_taskomatic_daemon.log to verify if worker threads are exhausted.

4.5.3.17. org.quartz.scheduler.idleWaitTime

Description	Cycle time for Taskomatic. Decreasing this value lowers the latency of Taskomatic.
Tune when	Client count is in the thousands.

Value default	5000 ms
Value recommendation	1000-5000 ms
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	org.quartz.scheduler.idleWaitTime = 1000
More information	http://www.quartz-scheduler.org/documentation/2.4.0-SNAPSHOT/configuration.html

4.5.3.18. MinionActionExecutor.parallel_threads

Description	Number of Taskomatic threads dedicated to sending commands to Salt clients as a result of actions being executed.
Tune when	Client count is in the thousands.
Value default	1
Value recommendation	1-10
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	taskomatic.minion_action_executor.parallel_threads = 10



When increasing Taskomatic's thread count or memory allocation to resolve stuck pending tasks in a containerized deployment, you must verify that the underlying container's memory limit is set higher than the taskomatic.java.maxmemory value. If the container does not have sufficient hardware capacity or limits are too restrictive, task processing will fail or the container will be unexpectedly terminated by the host.

4.5.3.19. SSHMinionActionExecutor.parallel_threads

Description	Number of Taskomatic threads dedicated to sending commands to Salt SSH clients as a result of actions being executed.
Tune when	Client count is in the hundreds.
Value default	20

Value recommendation	20-100
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	taskomatic.sshminion_action_executor.parallel_threads = 40

4.5.3.20. hibernate.c3p0.max_size

Description	Maximum number of PostgreSQL connections simultaneously available to both Tomcat and Taskomatic. If any of those components requires more concurrent connections, their requests will be queued.
Tune when	java.message_queue_thread_pool_size or maxThreads increase significantly, or when org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount has changed significantly. Each thread consumes one connection in Taskomatic and Tomcat, having more threads than connections might result in starving.
Value default	20
Value recommendation	100 to 200, higher than the maximum of java.message_queue_thread_pool_size + maxThreads and org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	hibernate.c3p0.max_size = 100
After changing	Check max_connections for adjustment.
More information	https://www.mchange.com/projects/c3p0/#maxPoolSize

4.5.3.21. rhn-search.java.maxmemory

Description	The maximum amount of memory that the rhn-search service can use.

Tune when	Client count increases significantly, and OutOfMemoryException errors appear in journalctl -u rhn-search.
Value default	512 MiB
Value recommendation	512-4096 MiB
Location	/etc/rhn/rhn.conf
Example	rhn-search.java.maxmemory = 4096
After changing	Check memory usage.

4.5.3.22. shared_buffers

Description	The amount of memory reserved for PostgreSQL shared buffers, which contain caches of database tables and index data.
Tune when	RAM changes
Value default	25% of total RAM
Value recommendation	25-40% of total RAM
Location	/var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/var-pgsql/_data/postgresql.conf
Example	shared_buffers = 8192MB
After changing	Check memory usage.
More information	https://www.postgresql.org/docs/15/runtime-config-resource.html#GUC-SHARED-BUFFERS

4.5.3.23. max_connections

Description	Maximum number of PostgreSQL connections available to applications. More connections allow for more concurrent threads/workers in various components (in particular Tomcat and Taskomatic), which generally improves performance. However, each connection consumes resources, in particular work_mem megabytes per sort operation per connection.
Tune when	hibernate.c3p0.max_size changes significantly, as that parameter determines the maximum number of connections available to Tomcat and Taskomatic
Value default	400
Value recommendation	Depends on other settings, use /usr/lib/susemanager/bin/susemanager-connection-check to obtain a recommendation.
Location	/var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/var-pgsql/_data/postgresql.conf
Example	max_connections = 250
After changing	Check memory usage. Monitor memory usage closely before and after the change.
More information	https://www.postgresql.org/docs/15/runtime-config-connection.html#GUC-MAX-CONNECTIONS

4.5.3.24. work_mem

Description	The amount of memory allocated by PostgreSQL every time a connection needs to do a sort or hash operation. Every connection (as specified by max_connections) might make use of an amount of memory equal to a multiple of work_mem.

Tune when	Database operations are slow because of excessive temporary file disk I/O. To test if that is happening, add log_temp_files = 5120 to /var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/var-pgsql/_data/postgresql.conf, restart PostgreSQL, and monitor the PostgreSQL log files. If you see lines containing LOG: temporary file: try raising this parameter's value to help reduce disk I/O and speed up database operations.
Value recommendation	2-20 MB
Location	/var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/var-pgsql/_data/postgresql.conf
Example	work_mem = 10MB
After changing	check if the Uyuni Server might need additional RAM.
More information	https://www.postgresql.org/docs/15/runtime-config-resource.html#GUC-WORK-MEM

4.5.3.25. effective_cache_size

Description	Estimation of the total memory available to PostgreSQL for caching. It is the explicitly reserved memory (shared_buffers) plus any memory used by the kernel as cache/buffer.
Tune when	Hardware RAM or memory usage increase significantly
Value recommendation	Start with 75% of total RAM. For finer settings, use shared_buffers + free memory + buffer/cache memory. Free and buffer/cache can be determined via the free -m command (free and buff/cache in the output respectively)
Location	/var/lib/containers/storage/volumes/var-pgsql/_data/postgresql.conf
Example	effective_cache_size = 24GB
After changing	Check memory usage

Notes	This is an estimation for the query planner, not an allocation.
More information	https://www.postgresql.org/docs/15/runtime-config-query.html#GUC-EFFECTIVE-CACHE-SIZE

4.5.3.26. thread_pool

Description	The number of worker threads serving Salt API HTTP requests. A higher number can improve parallelism of Uyuni Server-initiated Salt operations, but will consume more memory.
Tune when	java.message_queue_thread_pool_size or org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount are changed. Starvation can occur when there are more Tomcat or Taskomatic threads making simultaneous Salt API calls than there are Salt API worker threads.
Value default	100
Value recommendation	100-500, but should be higher than the sum of java.message_queue_thread_pool_size and org.quartz.threadPool.threadCount
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/susemanager.conf, in the rest_cherrypy section.
Example	thread_pool: 100
After changing	Check worker_threads for adjustment.
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/netapi/all/salt.netapi.rest_cherrypy.html#performance-tuning

4.5.3.27. worker_threads

Description	The number of salt-master worker threads that process commands and replies from minions and the Salt API. Increasing this value, assuming sufficient resources are available, allows Salt to process more data in parallel from minions without timing out, but will consume significantly more RAM (typically about 70 MiB per thread). Setting this value to very high values could cause opposite effect as the workers will compete to each other for the CPU resources and the performance could be dropped significantly.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly, thread_pool increases significantly, or SaltReqTimeoutError or Message timed out errors appear in /var/log/salt/master could be a sign of too low or too high value of this parameter.
Value default	8
Value recommendation	8-32, depending on the number of the CPU cores available for the server, it is recommended to keep the value slightly less than the number of CPU cores.
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/tuning.conf
Example	worker_threads: 16
After changing	Check memory usage. Monitor memory usage closely before and after the change. It makes sense to monitor the salt-master stats event by enabling master_stats and adjusting master_stats_event_iter to fine tune the value of this parameter.
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html#worker-threads

4.5.3.28. auth_events

Description	Determines whether the master will fire authentication events. Authentication events are fired when a minion performs an authentication check with the master. It helps to reduce the number of events published with the Salt Master Event Publisher and reduce the workload on Event Publisher subscribers.

Tune when	Large amount of salt/auth events published in the Salt event bus, which in most cases are useless for the subscribers.
Value default	True
Value recommendation	False
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/tuning.conf
Example	auth_events: False
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html#auth-events

4.5.3.29. minion_data_cache_events

Description	Determines whether the master will fire minion data cache events (minion/refresh/*). Minion data cache events are fired when a minion requests a minion data cache refresh. It helps to reduce the number of events published with the Salt Master Event Publisher and reduce the workload on Event Publisher subscribers.
Tune when	Large amount of minion/refresh/* events published in the Salt event bus, which in most cases are useless for the subscribers.
Value default	True
Value recommendation	False
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/tuning.conf
Example	minion_data_cache_events: False
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html#minion-data-cache-events

4.5.3.30. pub_hwm

Description	The maximum number of outstanding messages sent by salt-master. If more than this number of messages need to be sent concurrently, communication with clients slows down, potentially resulting in timeout errors during load peaks.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly and Salt request timed out. The master is not responding. errors appear when pinging minions during a load peak.
Value default	1000
Value recommendation	10000-100000
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/tuning.conf
Example	pub_hwm: 10000
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html#pub-hwm, https://zeromq.org/socket-api/#high-water-mark

4.5.3.31. zmq_backlog

Description	The maximum number of allowed client connections that have started but not concluded the opening process. If more than this number of clients connects in a very short time frame, connections are dropped and clients experience a delay re-connecting.
Tune when	Client count increases significantly and very many clients reconnect in a short time frame, TCP connections to the salt-master process get dropped by the kernel.
Value default	1000
Value recommendation	1000-5000
Location	/etc/salt/master.d/tuning.conf
Example	zmq_backlog: 2000

More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/master.html#zmq-backlog, http://api.zeromq.org/3-0:zmq-getsockopt (ZMQ_BACKLOG)

4.5.3.32. swappiness

Description	How aggressively the kernel moves unused data from memory to the swap partition. Setting a lower parameter typically reduces swap usage and results in better performance, especially when RAM memory is abundant.
Tune when	RAM increases, or swap is used when RAM memory is sufficient.
Value default	60
Value recommendation	1-60. For 128 GB of RAM, 10 is expected to give good results.
Location	/etc/sysctl.conf
Example	vm.swappiness = 20
More information	https://documentation.suse.com/sles/15-SP7/html/SLES-all/cha-tuning-memory.html#cha-tuning-memory-vm

4.5.3.33. wait_for_backend

Description	Determines whether the salt-broker service should wait for backend sockets to be connected before opening the sockets for listening for connections from salt-minions. When enabled, it helps to prevent collecting ZeroMQ messages with the internal buffers of the sockets and pushing them to the salt-master once connection is restored.
Tune when	Unstable connectivity between the Uyuni Proxy and the Uyuni Server.
Value default	False

Value recommendation	True
Location	/etc/salt/broker
Example	wait_for_backend: True
More information	**Specialized Guides › Salt › Proxies Connectivity**

4.5.3.34. tcp_keepalive

Description	The tcp keepalive interval to set on TCP ports. This setting can be used to tune Salt connectivity issues in messy network environments with misbehaving firewalls.
Tune when	Unstable connectivity between managed clients and the Uyuni Proxy or the Uyuni Server.
Value default	True
Value recommendation	True
Location	/etc/venv-salt-minon/minion.d/tuning.conf or /etc/salt/minion.d/tuning.conf, depending on the minion type.
Example	tcp_keepalive: True
After changing	Check **Specialized Guides › Salt › Minions Connectivity** for more details to fine tune extra keepalive parameters.
More information	https://docs.saltproject.io/en/latest/ref/configuration/minion.html#tcp-keepalive, **Specialized Guides › Salt › Minions Connectivity**

4.5.3.35. DISKCHECKALERT and DISKTHRESHOLD

Description	Environment variables that control disk usage monitoring thresholds for containerized deployments. DISKCHECKALERT triggers a warning notification when disk usage exceeds the specified percentage. DISKTHRESHOLD triggers a critical notification and causes the container health check to fail, which will automatically stop the container. In large deployments with multi-terabyte storage volumes, the default thresholds (90% and 95%) can leave excessive amounts of disk space unused. For example, on a 10 TB volume, 5% free space equals 500 GB, which is wasteful. Increasing these thresholds allows more efficient use of available storage capacity while maintaining adequate headroom for operations.
Tune when	Large storage volumes are deployed (multiple terabytes) and you want to use disk space more efficiently while maintaining adequate headroom for database growth and repository synchronization.
Value default	DISKCHECKALERT=90, DISKTHRESHOLD=95
Value recommendation	For deployments with 5 TB+ storage: DISKCHECKALERT=95, DISKTHRESHOLD=98. For deployments with 10 TB+ storage: DISKCHECKALERT=96, DISKTHRESHOLD=99.
Location	Systemd service override files: /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-server.service.d/diskcheck.conf and /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-db.service.d/diskcheck.conf
Example	See the procedure below
After changing	Monitor disk usage notifications and ensure adequate space remains for database growth, package repository synchronization, and temporary operations. Use df -h to verify current disk usage levels.

Notes	The disk check runs hourly. Both the server and database containers should use the same threshold values. When DISKTHRESHOLD is exceeded, container health checks will fail and the container will be automatically stopped. The database container only monitors /var/lib/pgsql/data and this cannot be overridden with DISKCHECKDIRS.
More information	**Administration Guide › Space Management**

Procedure: Configuring Disk Check Thresholds for Large Deployments

1. Create systemd override directories for both services:

```
mkdir -p /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-server.service.d/
mkdir -p /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-db.service.d/
```

2. Create configuration files with higher thresholds for the server service:

```
cat > /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-server.service.d/diskcheck.conf << 'EOF'
[Service]
Environment="PODMAN_EXTRA_ARGS=--env DISKCHECKALERT=95 --env DISKTHRESHOLD=98"
EOF
```

3. Create configuration files with higher thresholds for the database service:

```
cat > /etc/systemd/system/uyuni-db.service.d/diskcheck.conf << 'EOF'
[Service]
Environment="PODMAN_EXTRA_ARGS=--env DISKCHECKALERT=95 --env DISKTHRESHOLD=98"
EOF
```

4. Apply the configuration by restarting Uyuni:

```
mgradm restart
```

4.5.4. Memory Usage

Adjusting some of the parameters listed in this section can result in a higher amount of RAM being used by various components. It is important that the amount of hardware RAM is adequate after any significant change.

To determine how RAM is being used, you will need to check each process that consumes it.

Operating system

Stop all Uyuni services and inspect the output of free -h.

Java-based components

This includes Taskomatic, Tomcat, and rhn-search. These services support a configurable memory cap.

The Uyuni Server

Depends on many factors and can only be estimated. Measure PostgreSQL reserved memory by checking shared_buffers, permanently. You can also multiply work_mem and max_connections, and multiply by three for a worst case estimate of per-query RAM. You will also need to check the operating system buffers and caches, which are used by PostgreSQL to host copies of database data. These often automatically occupy any available RAM.

It is important that the Uyuni Server has sufficient RAM to accommodate all of these processes, especially OS buffers and caches, to have reasonable PostgreSQL performance. We recommend you keep several gigabytes available at all times, and add more as the database size on disk increases.

Whenever the expected amount of memory available for OS buffers and caches changes, update the effective_cache_size parameter to have PostgreSQL use it correctly. You can calculate the total available by finding the total RAM available, less the expected memory usage.

To get a live breakdown of the memory used by services on the Uyuni Server, use this command:

```
pidstat -p ALL -r --human 1 60 | tee pidstat-memory.log
```

This command will save a copy of displayed data in the pidstat-memory.log file for later analysis.

4.6. Monitoring Large Scale Deployments

You can monitor your Uyuni environment using Prometheus and Grafana. Uyuni Server and Proxy are able to provide self-health metrics. You can also install and manage a number of Prometheus exporters on clients.

Prometheus and Grafana packages are included in the Uyuni Client Tools for SUSE Linux Enterprise 12, SUSE Linux Enterprise 15, CentOS 7, CentOS 8 and openSUSE 15.x.

You need to install Prometheus and Grafana on a machine separate from the Uyuni Server. We recommend you use a managed client as your monitoring server.

It is recommended to monitor the Salt event bus in the large scale deployments with **Specialized Guides › Salt › Saline** to identify possible bottlenecks.

For more information on monitoring, see **Administration Guide › Monitoring**.

Chapter 5. Quick Start: SAP Overview

This guide shows you how to use Uyuni to install and configure an SAP cluster. It guides you through setting up a single Uyuni Server, preparing your client systems, and configuring the cluster using formulas.

- For more information about SAP, see the SAP documentation at https://documentation.suse.com/sles-sap.
- For more information about Uyuni, see the Uyuni documentation at https://documentation.suse.com/multi-linux-manager/.

5.1. Prepare Server

Before you start you need to deploy the Uyuni Server. The method for deploying the Uyuni Server varies depending on your hardware and environment.

Uyuni is deployed using the mgradm command. During the deployment process, when you are prompted for which product to install, select Uyuni Server. For more information about deploying the Uyuni Server, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › Container Deployment › Server Deployment Mlm**.

You need to do some configuration to set up the Uyuni Web UI. In your browser, navigate to the URL of the server, and configure your administration access to the Web UI.

Now you can use the Web UI to prepare software channels and activation keys for your clients.

On the Uyuni Server, add the appropriate SAP channels: From the Web UI, add SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 for SAP.

Synchronize the Uyuni Server with the SUSE Customer Center. You can do this using the Web UI. Add the new channel to your activation key.

To check if a channel has finished synchronizing navigate to **Admin › Setup Wizard** and select the Products tab. This dialog displays a completion bar for each product when they are being synchronized.



Software channels can be very large. The initial channel synchronization can sometimes take up to several hours.

When the initial synchronization is complete, we recommended you clone the channel before you work with it. This gives you a backup of the original synchronization data.

5.2. Preparing Clients

Your SAP cluster requires several client systems. Prepare your clients on physical or virtual hardware, and ensure you have SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 for SAP installation media ready. You cannot create an SAP

cluster without the SUSE Linux Enterprise Server SAP extension, as it provides tooling specific to SAP.

One of the key features of SAP is high availability of the cluster. Every component within an SAP cluster has redundancy and failover protection. When you are preparing your clients, ensure you have enough hardware and infrastructure to allow for this. For more information about hardware requirements, see https://documentation.suse.com/sles-sap/15-SP4/html/SLES-SAP-installation/cha-plan.html#sec-hardware

For more information about the clients you need to set up for an SAP cluster, see https://documentation.suse.com/sbp/all.

5.2.1. Register Clients to the SUSE Customer Center

Each client within your SAP cluster must be registered with the SUSE Customer Center. To obtain your registration code, navigate to https://scc.suse.com/login in your web browser. Log in to your SCC account, or follow the prompts to create a new account. Click the **[Subscriptions]** tab to see the registration code. When you install SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 for SAP the Unified Installer prompts you for the code.

For more information about registering Uyuni with SUSE Customer Center, see **Installation and Upgrade Guide › General Requirements**.

5.2.2. Configure the Clients for Clustering

Every client system must have all the other client systems listed in their /etc/hosts file. Open the /etc/hosts file on each client, and add the hostname for each of the other clients.

5.2.3. Create a Shared Storage Device

Each of the clients needs to be able to access a shared disk. The shared disk can be physical hardware connected by ethernet, or you can set up a virtual disk and access it with iSCSI.

If you use a virtual disk, consider hosting it on a separate system. Do not use a client machine to host the shared storage disk.

5.2.4. Download the SAP Installation Software

Download the SAP installation media and save a copy on each client. The software that you require differs depending on your environment. For example, if you are using HANA, you need the SAP HANA platform. If you are using Netweaver, you need different packages. These software packages are provided by SAP, not by SUSE.

Ensure you have saved the installation software in the same file system location on each client. Alternatively, save it to a shared NFS drive.

5.2.5. Configure Clients to Use Latest module.run

Each client needs to be configured to use the latest version of module.run. On each of the client machines, open the /etc/salt/minion configuration file and add or edit this line:

```
use_superseded:
  - module.run
```

Restart the salt-minion process to enable the changes:

```
systemctl restart salt-minion
```

5.2.6. Install Additional Disks for HANA

For the clients that are going to run the HANA database, you require an additional storage device. This device is used to store files required by HANA, which are located in the /hana/ directory.

We recommend that this storage device be at least 20 GB. For some installations, you might require more, and it is possible to use multiple disks to provide this storage. For comprehensive hardware requirements, see https://documentation.suse.com/sbp/all.

5.2.7. Register Clients to the Server

First of all, make sure you have an activation key that is associated with the SLE-Product-SLES_SAP15 base channel. For more information about activation keys, see **Client Configuration Guide › Activation Keys**.

In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › Bootstrapping**. Fill in the appropriate details, and make sure you check the Manage System Completely via SSH checkbox. In the Activation Key field, select the SLES for SAP activation key.

For more information about registering, see **Client Configuration Guide › Registration Webui**.

5.3. Configure Clients

Uyuni uses formulas with forms to configure your SAP clients. There are two formulas that you need to use:

- Hana to configure the HANA database
- Cluster to configure the clients into a cluster

The formulas are provided by packages that you can download with your package manager. You need to install the formulas on the Uyuni Server. When you have installed the package, you can use the Uyuni Web UI to enable and configure the formulas. As you go through the formula configuration process, provide details of the

clients that contain your SAP cluster, to set them up appropriately.

To install the formulas on the Uyuni Server, use your package manager to install these packages:

- saphanabootstrap-formula
- sapnwbootstrap-formula
- drbd-formula
- habootstrap-formula
- salt-shaptools



The order that you enable and configure the formulas is important. You must enable, configure, and apply the HANA formula first. Then you can enable, configure, and apply the cluster formula. If you perform these steps in the wrong order, your SAP installation fails.

5.3.1. Enable and Configure the HANA Formula

In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › System List** and click the client to use as the primary client in the cluster.

Navigate to the Formulas tab, locate the Sap Hana Deployment heading, and check the Saphanabootstrap formula in the list. Click **[Save]** and apply the highstate to activate the formula.

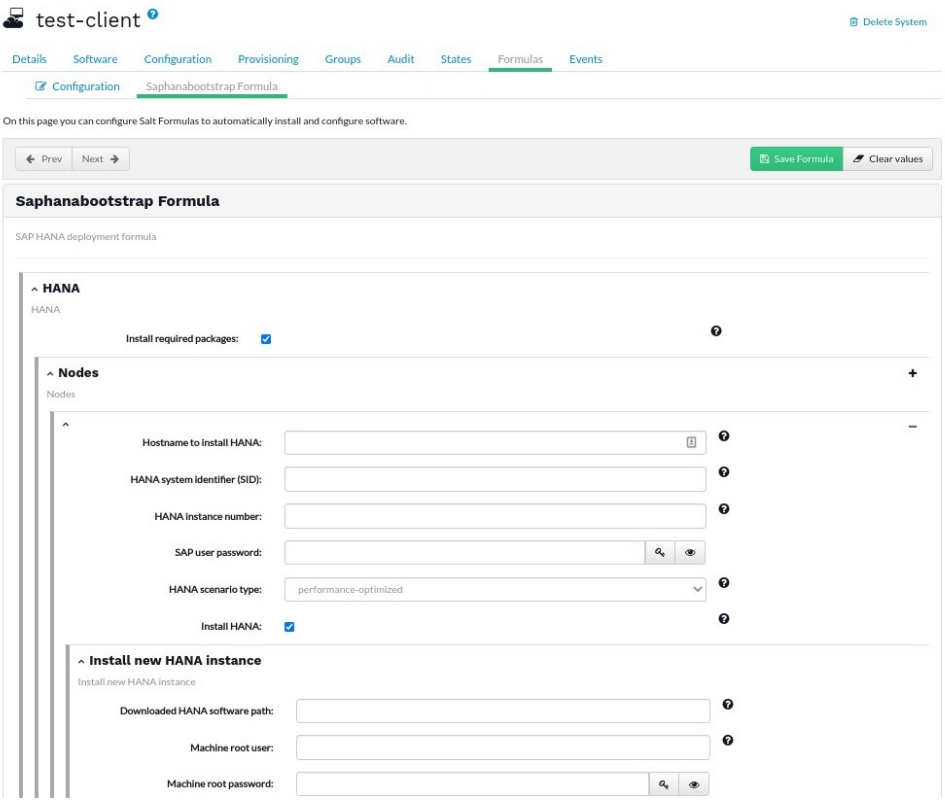
When the formula is activated, navigate to the **Formulas › Hana** tab, and complete the details in the form.

Make sure you check Install required packages to install everything you need on the client. In the Nodes sections, type the short hostname of the client to install the HANA database or the hostname you can retrieve on the command line with:

```
salt '<client-name>' grains.item host
```

Provide further details for the installation.

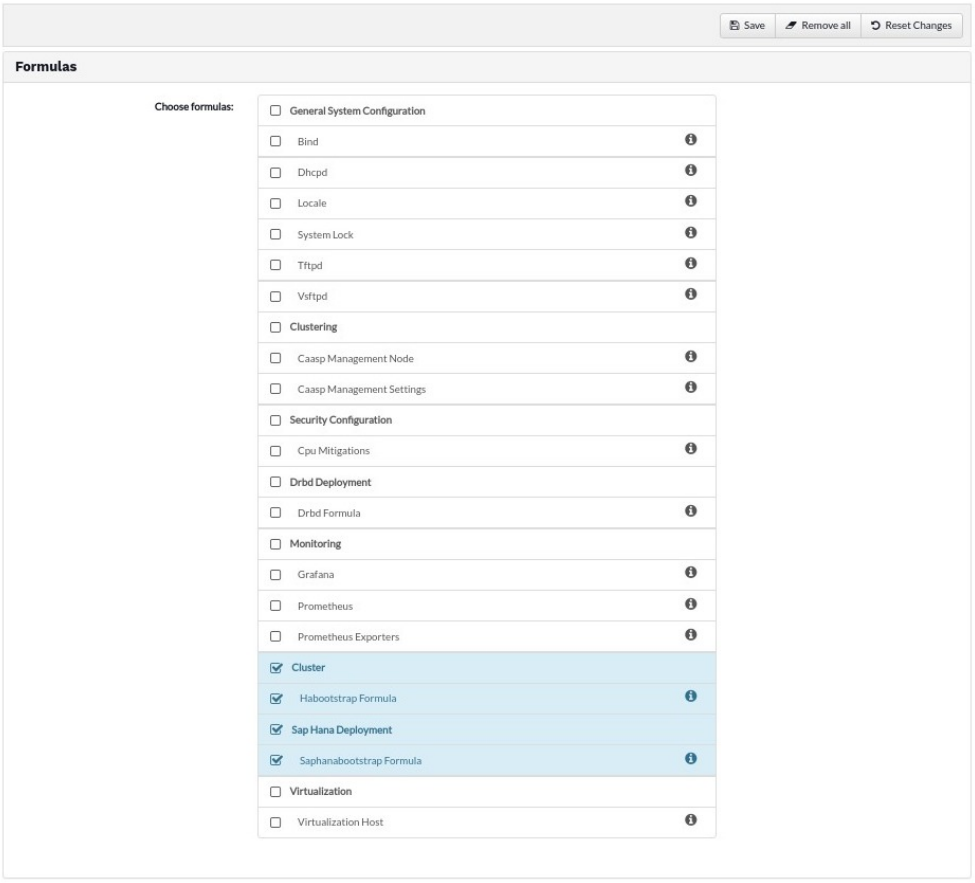
Complete the remaining details according to your environment, click **[Save]**, and apply the highstate. When the highstate is complete, you can go on to apply the cluster formula.



5.3.2. Enable and Configure the Cluster Formula

In the Uyuni Web UI, navigate to **Systems › System List** and click the client to use as the primary client in the cluster.

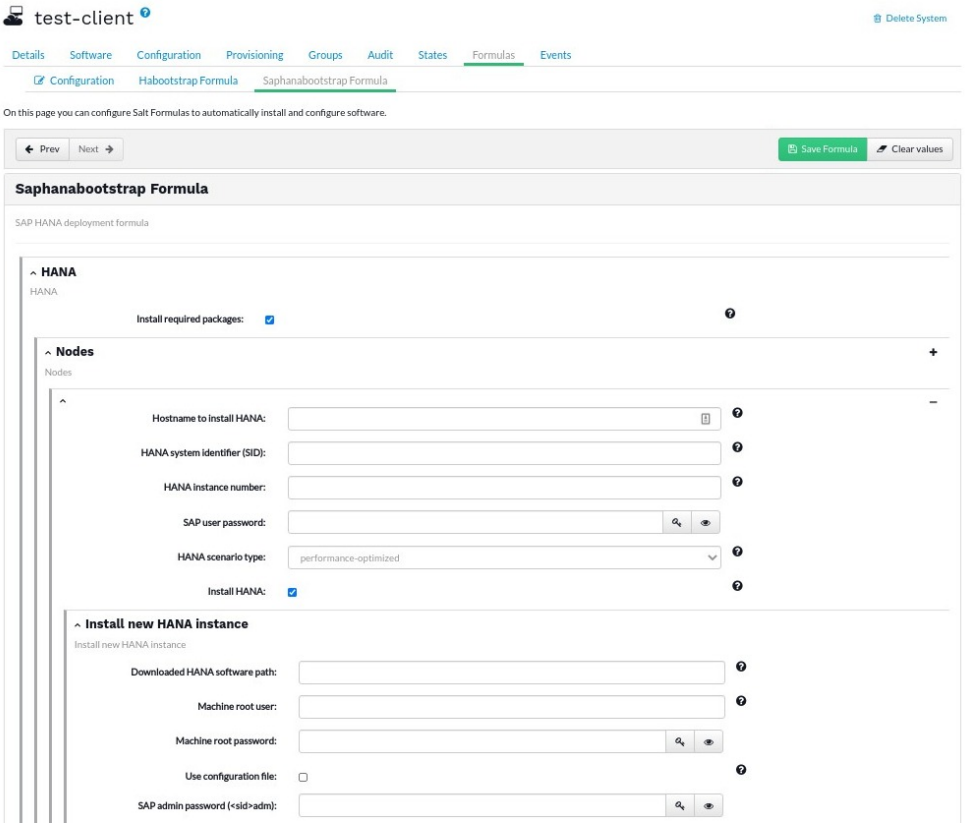
Navigate to the Formulas tab, locate the Cluster heading, and check the Habootstrap formula in the list. Click **[Save]** and apply the highstate to activate the formula.



When the formula is activated, navigate to the **Formulas › Cluster** tab, and complete the details in the form.

Make sure you check Install required packages to install everything you need on the client. Give your cluster a name, and specify the hostname of the primary client in the cluster.

Complete the remaining details according to your environment, click **[Save]**, and apply the highstate.


test-client
Delete System
Details
Software
Configuration
Provisioning
Groups
Audit
States
Formulas
Events
Configuration
Habootstrap Formula
Saphanabootstrap Formula
On this page you can configure Salt Formulas to automatically install and configure software.
Prev
Next
Save Formula
Clear values
Saphanabootstrap Formula
SAP HANA deployment formula
HANA
HANA
Install required packages:
Nodes
Nodes
Hostname to install HANA:
HANA system identifier (SID):
HANA instance number:
SAP user password:
HANA scenario type:
performance-optimized
Install HANA:
Install new HANA instance
Install new HANA instance
Downloaded HANA software path:
Machine root user:
Machine root password:
Use configuration file:
SAP admin password (<sid>adm):

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